

Reflective Teaching Practices: Criticality

Framing Reflection in External Constraints

- RP does not take place in a vacuum
- It occurs complicated social field with competing habits and constraints that naturally affect teachers in the school environment.

Reflective teaching practices need to be very critical if they need to be effective and what we want to do is look at different aspects of criticality in terms of reflective practice. One critical aspect of reflection of reflective practice is that we need to be aware of is that reflection does not happen in isolation. It happens within an external framework within an environment. Therefore, being critical about reflective practice means that we need to understand the environment and how those external constraints can affect the reflective practitioner and affect the outcomes of reflective practice.

Reflection with Action

The role the teacher plays within their schools and departments will have an effect on the reflective practice of the teacher.

- There will be certain rules of being a teacher, both written and unwritten, they will constrain or bias the reflective practice that occurs.
 - Teachers do not exist in a vacuum: all their experiences are different because of the school environment they exist in the colleagues they work with and their own habits they bring to their education are all different
 - The colleagues they work with and their own habits they bring to their education are all different.
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It's the colleagues that we work with, it's the biases we have, the expectations and biases that our colleagues have which come together in the environment which create the reflective practice environment. These actually become constraints or also they can become **empowerers** to the process of reflection.

- To understand teachers' reflective practice there must be an understanding of the social environment they exist in.

Reflective Teaching Practices: Criticality Critical Reflection= Critical Thinking

Critical Reflection and Critical Thinking

- Models of thinking and reflection involve three fundamental processes

Retrospection

- Thinking back about a situation or experience

Self-Evaluation

- Critically analyzing and evaluating the actions and feeling associated with the experience, using theoretical perspectives.

The next level of critical thinking is self-evaluation. For the reflective practitioner it is important to think analytically and in evaluative terms about experiences. Critical evaluation and analysis of our actions and also of the feelings that we have, our responses to experiences we have. It's important to understand all of these from theoretical academic perspectives and begin to make cognitive links **in the conceptual frames**.

Re-Orientation

- Using the results of self-evaluation to influence future approaches to similar situations and experience.
- Part of critically is to transform problems into constructive ideas

Critical Reflection Analysis

- Try to translate the processes of reflection into questions that challenging you further.
- Did the analysis look broadly enough?
- Is the issue recognized by students
- Does the improvement proposal address the original issue?
- Is the analysis and improvement specific enough?

Critical Reflective Enquiry: Critical Philosophy

Critical Philosophy

- From the critical philosophy perspective teaching practice is viewed as a form of social life in which different forms of domination, distortions and misunderstanding are possible.

Becoming reflective practitioner is important in terms of the processes that you engage with from a sort of research perspective in the classroom and what we can consider is Critical Reflective Enquiry in this regard an underpinning idea in relation to the reflective practitioner experimenting, investigating and developing from those investigations is to understand the philosophical underpinnings to reflection and criticality and in this regard we can talk about criticality philosophy or in other words the perspective of teaching that we hold and view as important and we as reflective practitioner can alter the experience of classroom, alter the perception of issues and problems as they arise and therefore the certain distortions and the effects that the philosophy we have can have on our critical reflection.

Hence any study of practice needs to incorporate an emancipatory focus through which social life can be freed from domination and distortions (Herbermas, 1984)

Critical Reflection has a number of key phases.

- Descriptive
- Reflective
- Critical/Emancipatory

Reflective phase

There is then a reflective phase and a product of reflection is our growing awareness of teaching role and the processes we have discussed many times that we engage with in order to do this reflective cycle analysis process.

Critical/Emancipatory Phase

- This phase, moving from the reflective phases, is oriented to correcting and changing and changing less-than good or ineffective practice or moving forward to future assimilation of new innovations emerging from practice.
- Assimilation of new innovations emerging from practice
- It involves discourses about the nature and sources of distortions, inconsistencies between

(a) Values/ Belief and practice**(b) Intentions and actions.****(c) Students needs and teachers actions, which have been identified in the reflective phases.****Critical Analysis**

- One way of deepening your ability to engage in critical reflection is to engage in complex analysis of incidents

There are different levels of analysis

Critical Analysis can occur at number of different levels.

Ethnomethodological Analysis

- Examining taken-for granted assumptions and rules of everyday social behavior.

Hermeneutic Phenomenological Analysis

- Reflecting on interpreting of both the learner's experience and the phenomena being experienced so as to move beyond the partiality of previous understanding.

Discursive Analysis

- Probing how speech and texts construct social truths.

Critical Analysis and RP Models

- Where models are presented, they should be offered in context and it should be emphasized that each is simply one of a range of tools.

Models to Trigger Broader Reflection

- Models should be used to trigger broader reflection rather than an ends in themselves.
 - We should not be presented with just one model, the implication being that this is the way reflective practice is done.
 - Teachers need to grasp that different model engage different levels of complexity and therefore need to be used selectively and carefully.
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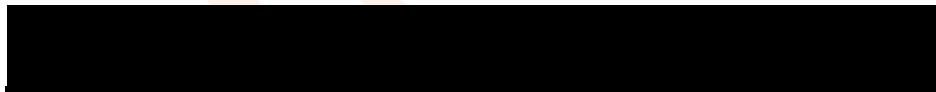
- Students should also be helped to see something of the strengths offered by the different models and methods of reflection

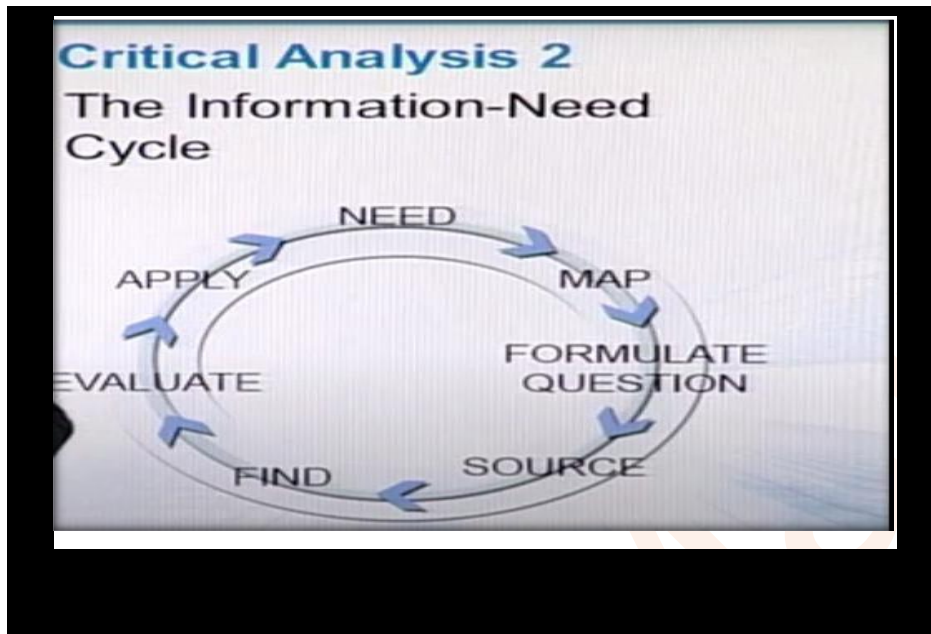
Critical Analysis

- Analysis involves breaking down information into its components parts and examining the relationship within these parts and with the whole.
- By doing this teacher shows the ability to differentiate and distinguish between components or elements of their experience.
- All critical analysis is formed around one basic assumption
 - Applying theory to practice
 - Theory and Practice

The information need cycle

Quite simply the critical analysis for the reflective practitioner can be viewed as a process of applying theory in practice. This is for the reflective practitioner is foundational principle of critical analysis. How to move theory into practical domain and this is viewed conveniently from a point of view of cycle of critical analysis and we can see below this cycle displayed.





First, we will talk about need that arises from an experience of a problem. By critically analyzing we are doing is trying to map, trying to look at the components, the elements of the problem and our thinking about the problem because from these elements we can formulate questions to challenge our conceptual frame. What important in terms of critical analysis is not only form those questions but also to understand to look for sources of evidence for those questions so, that we have some backup some foundation for what we are really doing in term of being critical and from this we are beginning to find to experiment with that thinking to begin to reframe the concepts we have and then to evaluate the change to evaluate how our thinking is changed before making the next application, before applying the change action in our teaching. As a cycle this brings us back to the action and experiences of that action how is the problem resolved or new problems arising.

Need:

- Determined by learning outcomes/ information

So, what we need to do from critical analysis perspective is to look at certain questions and try to refine those questions in terms of determining the outcomes of the information. We could ask a question for example on personal level

a) “I need something on smoking”

Some information, some evidence to work with the students in the classroom about the dangers of smoking. This could lead to another question of

b) “I have an assignment for which I need to find the best evidence to support an intervention”

“I have an assignment for which I need to complete for which I need evidence in order to support the suggestions that I have been making. Another question generating from this could be then that would be

c) I have an assignment for which I need to find research”.

“what research do I need to engage with? What research do I need to engage with? What evidence do I need to find?

Map:

- Map all the possible conceptual pathways to developing a question which will provide an answer.

In the cycle this is about mapping the thinking, mapping our conceptual understanding about the different routes we can take through resolving at particular issues, looking at questions to answer.

- This is a keyword generation, critical creative thinking and language skills.

Therefore, the mapping process is really about identifying the keywords that can drive our thinking that can support the way we are been creative and innovative and the way we are using language around describing issues and the process of reflection.

Formulate questions (the ability to give focus to questions):

- “I need something on group work” becomes
 - “I need information on the teacher role in effective group work”.
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Formulating questions is about being very critical in the way questions are formed. We have to look at the language, for example a question generated from bad experiences of managing group work, could be about looking at the strategies and approaches teacher is using.

Sources:

- Which information sources will provide the answer to my question?
- Involve critically choosing the appropriate information sources.

Which sources of information are you looking at as a reflective practitioner? In order to support the mapping process are you looking in the correct locations for the evidence?

Find:

- Require the development of a search strategy.
- Strategies will vary according to the information source but developed in line with a standard framework.

This search strategy will help you to develop the framework for reflection becomes much more critical how you are analyzing situations.

Evaluate:

- Does the information found answer the question?

The final part of the cycle is evaluation and application. Evaluation is doing the information; does the research I have done help me solve the problem help me answer those questions

Apply:

- How can the information be used to answer my question? What conclusion can I draw?

And when you are applying, what conclusions can you draw from that application?

Critical Analysis

Influences on Critical Analysis

Critical analysis will be influenced by:

- Level of support in the work environment
- Time for critical analysis
- Tools available for critical reflection

Critical Analysis Strategies

- Different forms of reflection in different context
- Busy practitioners might rely on reflection-in-action
- Work in a dialogical team context (to hear different perspectives)
- Use critical incidents, case studies, reflective journals, practical exercises

Competencies of Critical Analysis

Four competencies that characterize the critical thinker:

Clarification

- It means to identify the focus, analysis arguments, ask and answer questions of clarification, define terms, judge definitions, deal with equivocation and identify unstated assumptions

Basis

- Judge the credibility of a source, make and judge the observations.

Inference

- Deduce, judge deductions, induce, judge inductions, make and judge value judgements.

Metacognition

- Reason from premises, assumptions and positions with which one disagrees or doubts without inferring with one's thinking and integrating the other abilities in making and defending a decision.

Ways of Knowledge Generation: Nurturing Relationships

Nurturing Relationships

Becoming a reflective practitioner requires us to explore ways of generating knowledge. One way to do this through nurturing relationships that we have in our professional roles. Critical reflective learning is actually nurtured by relationships between teacher and learner, there for becomes a much more reflective process. What we need to consider is the nature of these nurturing relationships.

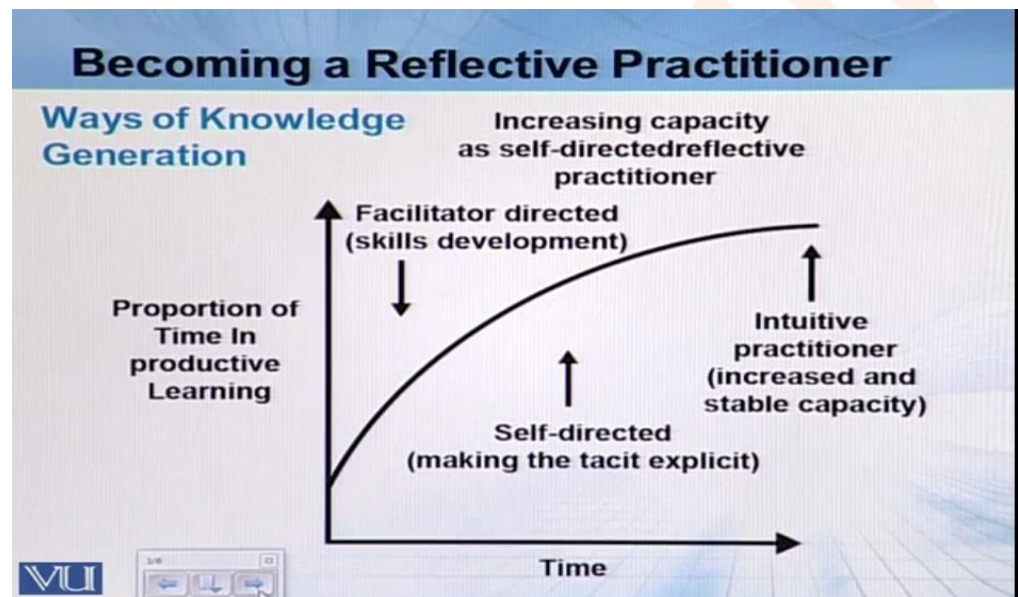
Key Aspects of Nurturing Relationships

There are some key aspects we will consider.

- **Mutual:** Any sort of positive constructive relationship is mutual for everyone involved, in other words everybody benefits from it.
 - **Open:** There is of-course open us in relation to way people are interacting with each other.
 - **Challenging:** Within the domain of reflective practice they also need to be challenging relationships, in other words critical but supportive.
 - **Contextually aware:** The relationships we have in order to help us generate knowledge also need to be representing properly in the context we have.
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- **Characterised by dialogue:** Perhaps fundamentally relationships are defined by the language we use, the dialogue, the context of the dialogue that we have with others.

We can look at this from the perspective of a simple chart



The increasing capacity of reflective practitioner to be more self-directed in terms of their reflected practice to develop **their** knowledge and to generate knowledge about their roles is in terms of the amount of time that they have within their roles and also the amount of time they give, they are able to give to the process of development to the activity of learning. For teachers who enter newly into the profession of teaching, we conceive that very much knowledge is much lower and therefore needs to be built. Therefore, the activities we have as reflective practitioner as teachers in the classroom is very much focus on the skills we need to survive in those environments. Therefore, it is very much directed by this particular need but with time and with experience and with opportunity to give to reflection and to learning the teacher becomes or can become much more self-directed. In other words, learning is moving from being tacit to much more explicit to being sort of very vague and be known to something we not know very clearly.

As we mature in our roles, we become much more intuitive in terms of the practice of teaching we are doing and this where we experience a level of emancipation as reflective practitioners. The amount of knowledge generation that we can engage with and the amount of knowledge we can develop become much greater at this level because we are not focusing solely on surviving and developing our skills but actually broadening and deepening our understanding of teaching learning. So, nurturing relationships is a very useful strategy for the reflective practitioner to engage with in terms of developing and generating knowledge.

With time nurturing relationships can actually help us to develop as practitioners and essentially the relationships **that** we have with our students and the relationships **that** we have with our colleagues in the work environment. These relationships can help us become much more self-directed as learners and self-directed as reflective practitioners and it really as we conceive from the job moves us from focusing things purely like skill development to be much more intuitive and much more investigations of the teaching that we are doing.

Self-Directed Learning

Self-direction is quite powerful. With self-directed learning we generate knowledge in a way which is responding to the learning needs and also is part of the responsibility of being a reflective practitioner.

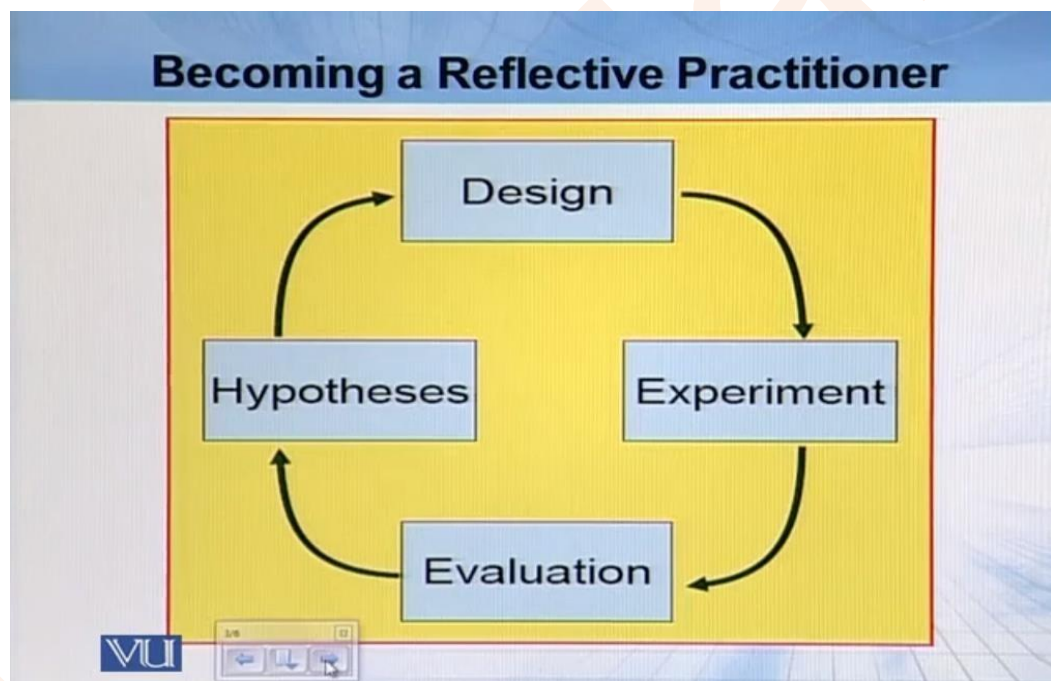
The individual teacher is when they are being very intuitive very self-directed is empowered to select what knowledge is powerful and useful and to manage that knowledge in terms of application in the classroom. Assessing the quality of that knowledge and how it is used. Perhaps the key thing to be aware of in terms of self-direction as a reflected practitioner is that motivation drives the whole process.

As a teacher, as a reflective practitioner if you are not motivated to learn, not motivated to develop then the reflection is not going to help that development at all. Therefore, independence is significant part of self-directed learning as well as the ability to set goals to define what is worthwhile to learn, teachers have to focus on the particular aspects of experiences in the classroom and then to look at those people who can support the process whether they are colleagues' or critical friends.

Ways of Knowledge Generation: Scientific Method

Scientific Method

A way of generating new knowledge for the reflective practitioner is through the scientific method. The scientific method has proved essential in terms of knowledge building through history. Essentially it is based on identifying certain hypothesis and trying to experiment in order to see whether these hypotheses stand up to experiment or fail in terms of the experiment. **It is possibly the single most important cognitive innovation in history and** we can look at the scientific method from a nice simple design where the reflective practitioner is abstracting thinking, designing their concepts and experimenting on these concepts.



Experimentation

For the reflective practitioner teacher this is looking at issues and experimenting to overcome those issues. From that experimentation we look at the results and we evaluate the effectiveness of the experimentation and then refer the evaluation back to the hypothesis. Is our hypothesis correct or is it false. If it is false, we need to re-hypothesis and re-design in order to experiment again and re-design and refine thinking about the

issues. This cyclic process which is very useful for the reflective practitioner although of course, it can be argued that teaching is not a scientific process but the scientific method is very useful in providing a structure for the experimentation where experimentation can be seen as trial-and-error process. The scientific method gives experimentation a much more scientific structure and a much more valued structure.

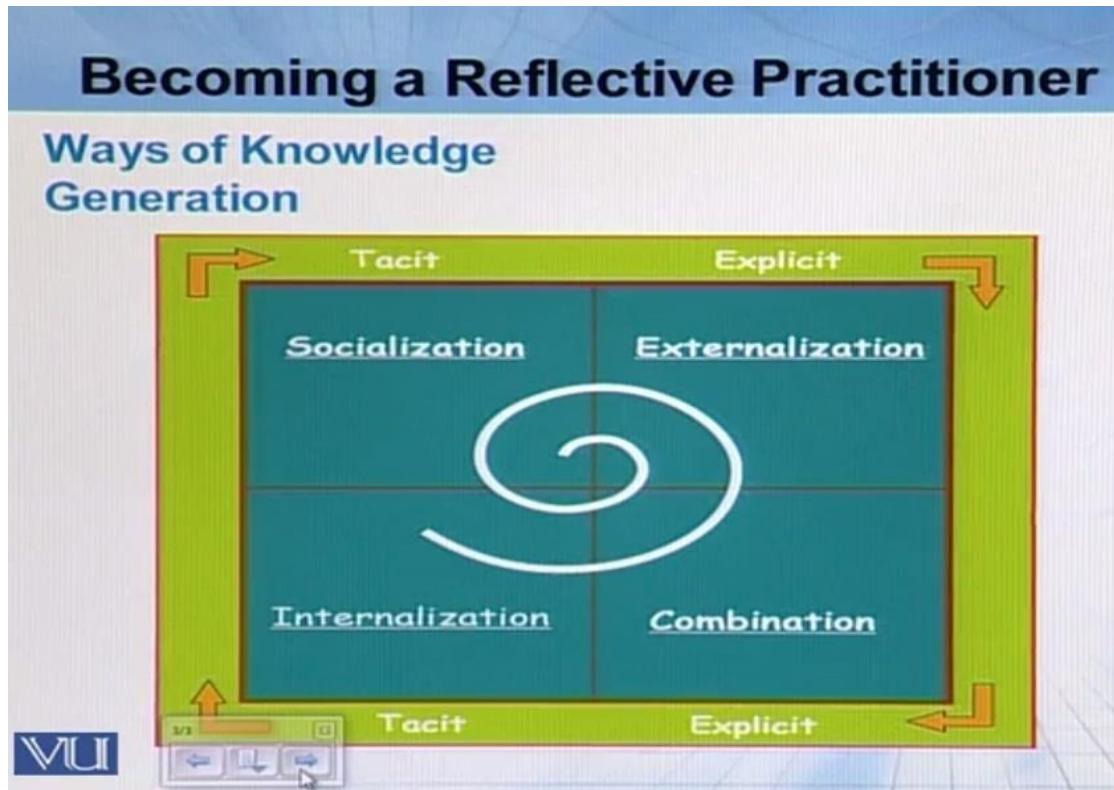
Statistical Analysis

What plays a important part in scientific method is analysis and what we bring to that is essentially is systematic evaluation of the information we are gathering. The analysis phase is very much about looking at the variables which we set in the hypothesis and then seeing if we can verify those variables, seeing if these stand up to the scrutiny and looking at the within the whole context of teaching. The data results that come from this is observation of reality is very much not about changing our experience but trying to be reflective about the experience without any change taking place. Statistical analysis from this scientific method perspective for the reflective practitioner is very much about possible to experiment in the classroom. To make that experimentation the object of the research, we had to remember that statistical analysis is quite key when dealing with human beings simply because working with variables constantly rather than fixed items we can catalogue.

Ways of Knowledge Generation: Cycle SECI

Cycle SECI

In becoming a reflective practitioner, we are looking at ways of generating knowledge. One way to do this through the SECI cycle. SECI cycle was developed by Hirotaka and Takeuchi. A way to generate knowledge by transforming it from tacit knowledge to explicit knowledge and then back to tacit knowledge. This is represented in the diagram where we can see that knowledge transforms through number of phases in a never-ending cycle



Socialization

Looking at this in more detail what we can see in model is that if we can look at the bottom left-hand corner knowledge is generated and internalized by the teacher by the reflective practitioner. As an internal process it's quite tacit and perhaps unknown to us, it's just acquired experience but through discussion with colleagues through further experience with the context of the work environment. The knowledge through socialization starts to become much clearer to us.

It is still tacit knowledge, it's still little bit unknown and vague but we are starting to realize that it's not just our knowledge but there are components that are shared by others in the context in which we work.

Externalization

From this the reflective practitioner through dialogue through the process socialization begins to externalize that knowledge. In other words, it becomes explicit within the context of the work. Externalizing that knowledge begins to make it more clear and helps us in understanding it in greater depth and detail and as we think more about it and externalize that knowledge through the socialization process, we begin to find points of comparison and contrast with that knowledge.

Combination

Comparison and contrast with theory and comparison and contrast with other people experiences. So, we start to combining pieces of knowledge together in a very explicit knowing way in order to rationalize the experiences we are having. From this process of combining the components of knowledge, we start to internalize into the conceptual frame so that it becomes much more tacit to our experiences.

Internalization

We do not think explicitly about this new knowledge, about this new learning instead we simply apply and understand what we have learned in a very intuitive way. This leads to new experiences, new internalizations which are again tacit but through the process of socialization we begin to develop tacit knowledge into much more explicit understandings. From socialization again we move to externalization where we are sharing that knowledge with others and others are sharing that knowledge with us.

Ways of Knowledge Generation: Modeling and Conceptual Innovation

Modeling and Concept Mapping

Another effective tool for the reflective practitioner is through Modeling and Conceptual Innovation. Modeling is used essentially for two key purposes and that is to confirm theories that we are building and also to make prediction about the results of actions that we are undertaking. We can look at modeling and concept innovational concept mapping. In the literature, there are different models we can look at for different

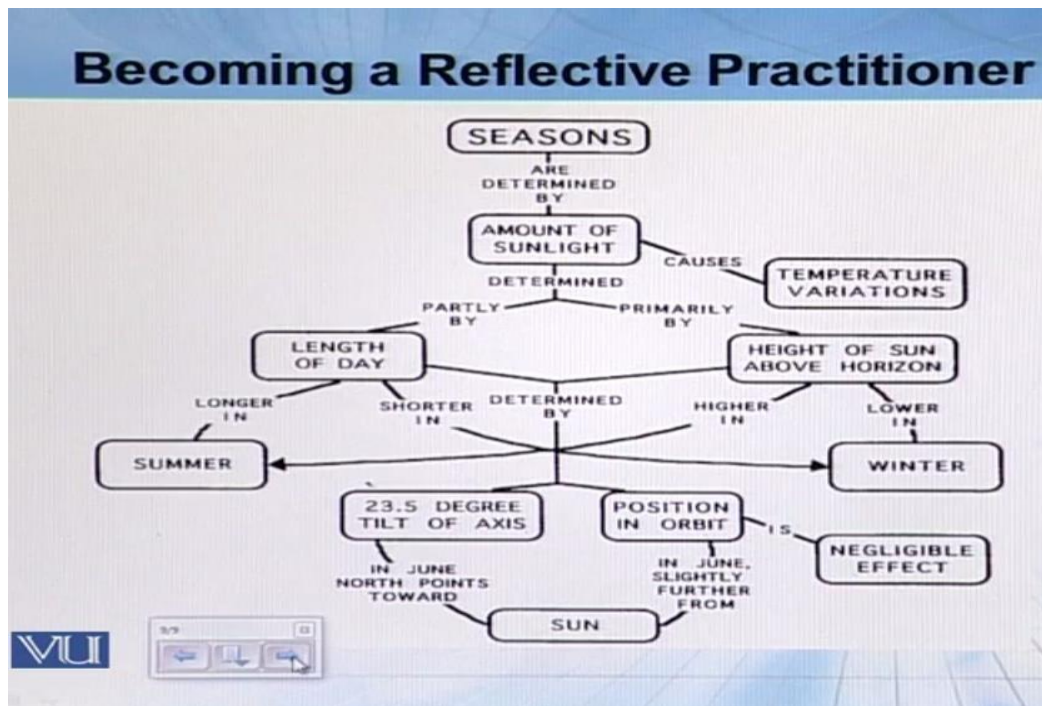
things from science through to nature. In “A New Kind of Science” and “Mathematica” Stephen Wolfram uses modelling for exploring patterns in nature.

For the reflective practitioner the notion of modeling and concept mapping is very new. Essentially modeling is something which is going to grow in the future, as a process of knowledge generation for teachers and as a process of generating knowledge the reflective practitioner is using models, using concept maps in order to build connections and to develop understanding between components of knowledge. In order to make sure that the knowledge is constructed and through this process of reflective practitioner is looking to build theories of practice from theories of teaching and learning and moving the theory into action.

Using Concept Maps

Concept maps are very graphic form for the reflective practitioner to use to represent the knowledge which they are acquiring and building over time. Concepts maps provide number of insights for the reflective practitioner into not only the concepts they have and the connections between those concepts. Concepts maps therefore are therefore comprised of two key components. The first component is the actual concepts that we are engaging with. The other component is linkages between those particular concepts. The linkages can be in form of linking words or linking phrases which connect one concept to another. Very much they are about the relationship, specifying the relationship the type of relationship between those concepts in the knowledge.

Model of Concept Map



We can see above a model of concept map for seasons. It's a very simple model to look at from the reflective practitioner point of view because it can help us to understand how a concept map can be use. **Essentially** a concept map can have a number of highlighted features of concepts that the reflective practitioner is dealing with. In this example we talk about amount of sunlight and temperature variations.

Ways of Knowledge Generation: Design

Design

Reflective practitioner can generate new knowledge through the process of design. Design is a way for the reflective practitioner to gather artifacts which are outcomes of experiences and use this overtime to build up bodies of knowledge. **Designs are artefacts that contain great amounts of knowledge embedded in them.** These artefacts automatically part of the design and then become huge amount of knowledge which the reflective practitioner is holding. The process of design is very much a dialogic process about reflecting with self through the reflective journal. It's also about dialoging with other colleagues, other stakeholders, **parents**

and also with students in order to build up the framework we are using for the design which is the **basis** of knowledge generation.

The design process therefore is very interactive and as an interaction process **between** the ideas we have, the values and beliefs embedded within those ideas and also recognition of the context in which we are working, the situation which influences those beliefs and ideas and of course the expectations and the impositions of the others involved in the situation, in other words the colleagues or stakeholders. So, design is a mean for these three components to come together to **interact and** inform **one** another. As such the knowledge generation process through design is very much about making visible the process of **generating** expertise. As a reflective practitioner it's therefore about experts and experienced practitioner sharing knowledge within the particular discipline. In order to create that design and also its sometimes perhaps complex it's a very detailed activity for the reflective practitioner to engage with to generate knowledge.

A key thing to remember here is that design as a way of knowledge generation is a socially constructed process rather than an individual process. It's through this explicit social process where perhaps the power of design really comes through. It is important **to remember** for the reflective practitioner to remember that the process of design for generating knowledge has a very key foundation and that key foundation is that the reflective practitioner is able to engage with conceptual frames for learning and be able to reframe concepts and reframe understanding in order for the knowledge generation to take place. Without reframing of concepts, without reframing of our understandings and reframing the way we approach our understanding; design cannot work as a means of knowledge generation. So, the key framing of reframing in terms of design is what will generate as a new knowledge for the reflective practitioner.

Theories, Knowledge and Practice: Teacher Professionalism

Teacher Professionalism

Becoming a reflective practitioner is a process of combining theories, knowledge **and practice** into coherent whole which is meaningful for the teacher and this all comes together to generate a **concept** which

we can think of as teacher professionalism. The fundamental question we have to ask ourselves here is good teaching is a direct consequence of reflective practice?

“Reflective practice is the habit of inquiring and investigating a problem situation in order to understand how to frame a solution”

Donald Schon, 1983

As we have seen reflective practice is very much a process of inquiring into a problem of investigation and understanding a problem in order to come to some sort of solution to drive processes to solve that problem. What this means is that we need to think of reflective practice from certain viewpoints in terms of professionalism. For example, we need to think of how reflective practice can boost teacher professionalism and improve and sustain teacher professionalism.

Assertion: Reflective practice Boosts Teacher Professionalism:

Caliber

One thing we need to look at here is the caliber of teaching, the quality of teaching. The caliber of teaching, the caliber of reflective practice is very much about challenging the assumptions we have about the practices of teaching about the pedagogical practices **that** we are using. Using these to establish for us the principles of good practice. In other words, to see teaching as an art and the process of reflection is to refine and to improve the quality of the art of teaching.

Discourse

Teacher professionalism through reflective practice is also about discourse. Discourse dialogue helps us to cultivate for ourselves **as professionalism** a level of confidence in our abilities and discourse also helps us to describe those abilities to others to articulate the level of knowledge, the level of expertise, the level of professionalism we have.

Knowledge Creation

We also know that teacher professionalism from the reflective practice standpoint is also about knowledge generation, knowledge creation because what the reflective practitioner doing is thinking and observing critically and using this criticality to frame changes in terms of our frames of understanding in order to develop for ourselves new models and theories of teaching.

3 Levels of Teacher Knowledge and Inquiry (cochran-Smith & Lytle, 1999)

We have got the level of Knowledge for Practice acquiring and generating knowledge for improved practice. We have also got Knowledge in Practice or in other words knowledge as applied in the classroom and also of Knowledge of Practice or in other words, our metacognitive processes in relation to the work we are doing.

What we can do with this is begin to think of a diagrammatic representation for this knowledge and practice generation.

1. Knowledge for Practice

This format we can see that knowledge for practice is the foundational stone of teacher professionalism. It's where the teacher is learning content and learning pedagogical knowledge from theories, from researches and beginning to apply this in practice and although we can consider it a very basic level of professionalism. It is rather a foundational level of professionalism equally important to any other level without it we cannot call ourselves professionals.

2. Knowledge in Practice

This is where teachers are acquiring practical teaching knowledge from the experiences they have of teaching over time. From the reflection of that experience and inquiring into experience from day-to-day basis. Knowledge in Practice is ongoing and forms perhaps the most significant part of teacher professionalism.

3. Knowledge of Practice

This is where teachers overtime developing skills sufficient enough to be able to generate knowledge which is coming from the experiences of the classroom and the school and whether teacher is seeing such contexts as places of learning for themselves, as process of inquiry into the process of teaching. It's a way for the teacher to make cognitive connections between theory and practice, between the issues that they are having personally with the bigger issues concerning education as a whole.

Knowledge of practice is therefore very much taking a very critical perspective not only of theories but also of experiences of others and their own experiences in order to bring these three things together into a new generation of knowledge and understanding. From this generation of knowledge that we have start to develop the profession and also to develop our own roles as a professional within the context in which we work.

So, the three levels of thinking here and knowledge generation fundamental to the process of professionalism. The foundational level knowledge for practice is not insignificant it's a foundational level and therefore as important of knowledge of practice which is generating knowledge over time.

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Theories, Knowledge and Practice: The Moral-Ethical Dimension in RP

Open-Mindedness

Our attitudes include things like open mindedness. This is important for the reflective practitioner because it underpins beliefs about the **diversity** of our students. The intellectual, the social and the other dimensions of diversity that we can be working with when we are in the classroom working with the groups of people. Another aspect of open-mindedness that we need to embrace as reflective practitioner is **humility**. We must remember that teaching for the reflective practitioner is the process which is not one way but two ways.

The reflective practitioner is learning from and with the learners and with the students as much as they are learning from the teacher. Therefore, this does require open-mindedness and humility in order to be honest with ourselves about the mistakes we are making and about the direction that we are travelling in. Another attitude which is significant for the ethical and moral dimension of reflective practice is that we are very caring about **our students** and we hope for them in terms of their learning and in terms of their future. What we are doing with them in the classroom is preparing them for their future for five years, for ten years, for fifty years hence. Therefore, that's a very great responsibility for us and part of the attitude which underpins the process of reflective practice.

Responsibility

Another attitude which is significant for the reflective practitioner needs to be aware of this moral and ethical dimension is the sense of responsibility that we have. As reflective practitioners we need to **consider the consequences** of our actions **in the classroom**. Our actions and experiments with our practices, the approaches and strategies we use are always for the good of students not for the sake of personal development. Therefore, the responsibility is that we are always looking at the consequences of our actions. The consequences should always be positive and good and there is also responsibility that we are developing from the experiences we

are having. We are **making meaning** from them for ourselves as professionals in terms of teacher learner interaction and how this comes together for the reflective practitioner as a professional.

Engagement (Whole-Heartedness)

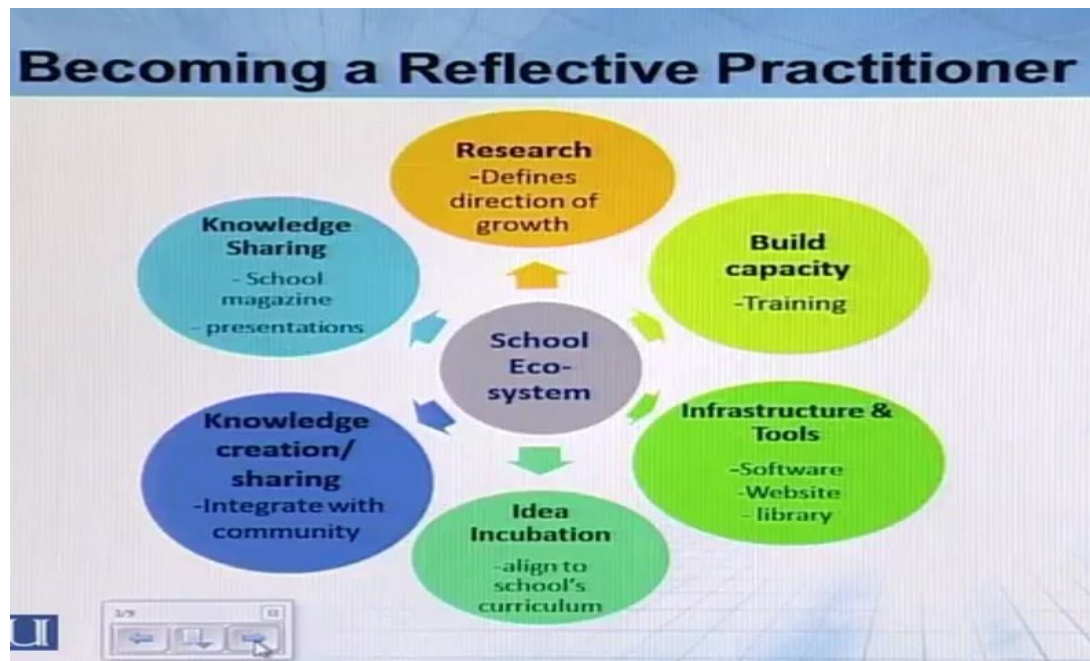
There is also an attitude of engagement or in other words whole-heartedness. Reflective Practitioner is somebody who is being very critical, asking questions about their role as teachers and what this means is that we need a certain bit **curiosity about subject** that we teach, our professional role, about the pedagogy of that subject **and about** the **impact of approaches on teaching and learning** and on students and therefore this whole-heartedness is part of the moral and ethical dimension of reflective practice. We need to remember for the reflective practitioner is that the teaching is very much an art individual to the teacher but is far reaching in terms of its impact. Therefore, it can be directed and guided in any particular way by the reflective practitioner so therefore it is something which is very much developed over time and evolves **along** with the teacher. So, this moral and ethical side of reflective practice realizes that the teacher the reflective practitioner is a growing and evolving practitioner.

Theories, Knowledge and Practice: Teacher Knowledge and Enquiry

Becoming a reflective practitioner then is about combining knowledge and theories and practice.

It's easy to think of this in terms of teacher knowledge and teacher inquiry. We know that the process of teachers in terms of becoming reflective practitioner is very much about thoughtful and reflective process and the purpose of this for the reflective practitioner is to be active contributors to community the work, the educational community. What we need to think about this is where this all comes together in terms of developing as a professional, developing as a reflective practitioner and we can look at this in terms of very simple model for becoming a reflective practitioner based on knowledge development.

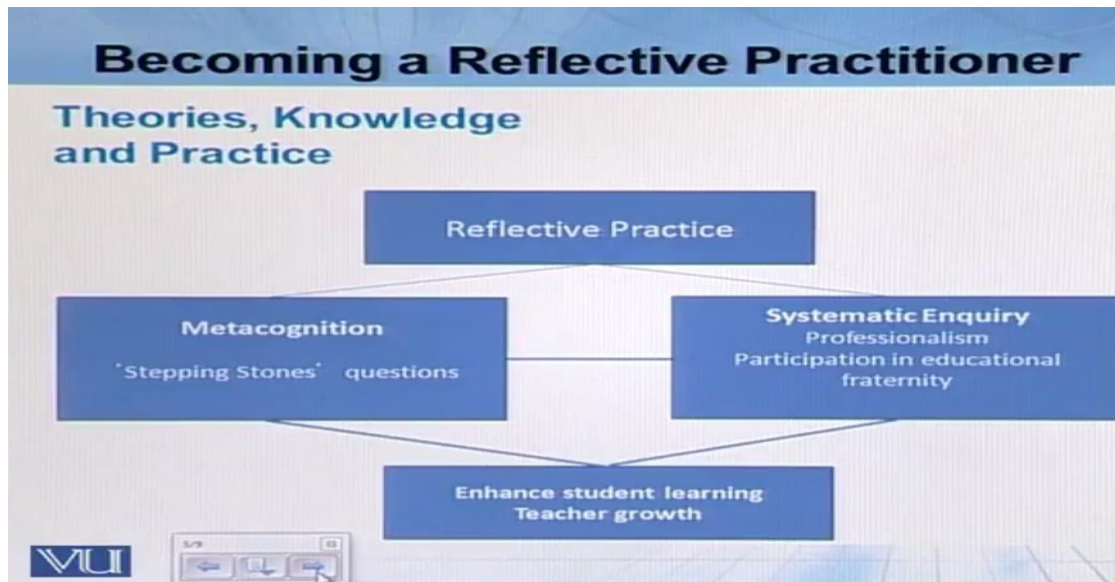
Approaches to build Professionalism



We as teachers are working within a community. We can think of it as an eco-system from this we can use different approaches in order to build knowledge and therefore professionalism. For example, we can look at research and this personal research defines the direction of personal growth. So, think of it in terms of training, capacity building and this approach very often taken by the schools in terms of building professionalism in teachers. We can also look at in terms of tools that teachers can use and infrastructure which schools provide and this could be things like internet access or libraries where teachers are able to access information.

Perhaps the new idea is thinking of school as an eco-system where people, professionals are working together to order to explore, define and re-define the components of teaching profession. In other words, it's like idea incubation where ideas are defined and tested and then built on and of course within a collaborative environment we can think of the school eco-system as a place where knowledge creation and sharing occur, where colleagues are working together. There are more pure forms of knowledge sharing through things like **school magazines** and presentations and so on. Within this model we have to think of over selves, where does

this reflective practice fitting to this knowledge acquisition process. We can look at another model define this, where reflective practice has two key components.



Systematic Inquiry

One component is about inquiry about investigation and its inquiry into professionalism in terms of teaching and its inquiry into have an individual is not only participating but contributing to the educational fraternity to the community as a whole.

Metacognition

The other component of reflective practice from this knowledge point of view is essentially metacognition or in other words how we are thinking about the process of professionalization and participation. The questions we are asking ourselves and challenging ourselves in order to move towards the professional identity.

It's these two things which come together within the profession to enhance student learning and promote teacher growth. So, we see that these two comes together what we can call Teacher Growth Model.

Teacher Growth Model

The Teacher Growth Model is therefore **multi-faceted** it comes from many perspectives from it in terms of knowledge creation and knowledge generation through the system, also in terms of becoming experts in pedagogy and the subject pedagogies which will move the profession forward in the 21st century. **Due to the multi-faceted nature of teacher's work, this implies that having a repertoire of strategies and content mastery is not sufficient for a teacher to be competent professional in the 21st century.** This Teacher Growth Model that we can talk about therefore is significant for teachers now to engage with because it's through this process of multiple mode of learning that the reflective practitioner actually through research, capacity building and through knowledge acquisition becomes a true professional in the 21st century.

Theories, Knowledge and Practice: Communities of Practice

Collaboration

Another aspect we need to think about from this point of view of this community of practice is the context, the domain in which the community occurs because the **context** very much provides the identity to the group. It actually drives the focus of sharing the experience and the insights the group engages with. Of course, part of **community of practice** is actual notion of practice or in other words the methods we applying, the knowledge about those methods and the notion that we bring to the community of practice of expertise and professionalism. These all provide the defining criteria in which the community of practice operates. The community of practice is really in order to bring **value** to its members. Value in terms of the quality of learning, the extent of learning and the depth of learning. Therefore, all members of community of practice are willing participants in the process of collaboration of working together in the process of contributing knowledge and sharing knowledge around those within the community

Why establish a community of practice in school?

We have to think about why establish a community of practice in the school.

- **A mechanism to promote rapid sharing of knowledge and expertise across diverse interest groups.** It's a very good mechanism; it's a very good means for developing rapidly because the individual teacher is not reflecting individually. In community of practice all reflective practitioners are going through the process of reflection and sharing, the experiences, the new insights and the new understandings with others. Therefore, knowledge and expertise grow rapidly in comparison to individual reflection.
- **Provides** a forum for exploring and testing ideas. The community of practice move the professionalism and the profession of teachers much more quickly towards good practice.
- Community of practice is a place where the new knowledge is more easily originated, where new understandings are created much more readily and explored and considered in more detail and therefore can develop much more strongly over time.
- Most importantly is that knowledge development for a reflective practitioner through a community of practice is very much responsive to the context in which teachers are working. The context will have unique issues associated with it, new problems arising all the time which are individual to the context. Therefore, the reflective practitioners within the community of practice have the opportunity to respond uniquely to those issues or problems as they arise within the context in which they occur.

Theories, knowledge and Practice: Communities of Practice

Communities of practice are useful for teacher becoming a reflective practitioner. Communities of practice support the individual professional's ability to generate knowledge and to manage **acquired** knowledge from experience.

Communities of Practices and Knowledge Management

- Communities of practice are knowledge management therefore is essentially about solving known problems **with** known solutions.
-

- A new teacher can present the problem to the community which is experienced by somebody else and therefore the solution to that problem is readily available. It's therefore about sharing about transferring know-how what we already know about the problems and how to solve them.
- It's very much about applying principles of good practice to what we are doing in the key areas of learning. The community of practice is a place where good practice has been stored and therefore can be transferred to the other shared and the community. Therefore, good practice by all members of the community everyday occurs.
- It's very much a process of sharing trust and building relationships with colleagues in order for this knowledge transfer and knowledge sharing to occur.
- It's a process of making knowledge acquisition much easier and because this is easier for the reflective practitioner for a teacher to find somebody else with answers to problems which they are experiencing.
- It's a very easy way to access that knowledge to organizational group intellect that available and therefore it's a very powerful tool for the reflective practitioner to use.

Types of Communities of Practice

There are different types of communities of practice and these are based on the strategic intents of the community of practice.

Helping

Helping in terms of its forum for helping an individual or individual solve problems and work with solutions that manage day to day classroom experience.

Best practice

It's very much about making sure that good practice becomes best practice. In school or some other educational environment, it is an opportunity to develop and disseminate to share around the best approaches,

the best strategies that are already known by others with those particular students with whom we are working. Therefore, we can say that this becomes the best practice **in that context** rather than good practice

Knowledge Stewarding

Another aspect of community of practice is about being custodian of knowledge, knowledge stewardship. In a community of practice knowledge is organized, managed by the group and held carefully like a repository where knowledge can be drawn upon by any particular member at any particular point and therefore a community of practice **becomes** a key point of knowledge input for the reflective practitioner.

Innovation

Another aspect of community of practice is innovation. It's a way to explore with other professionals' new ideas, break through ideas, new innovations to create and generate new practices which can **actually** become highly successful in terms of managing students learning.

Critical Success Factors of Community of Practice (CoPs)

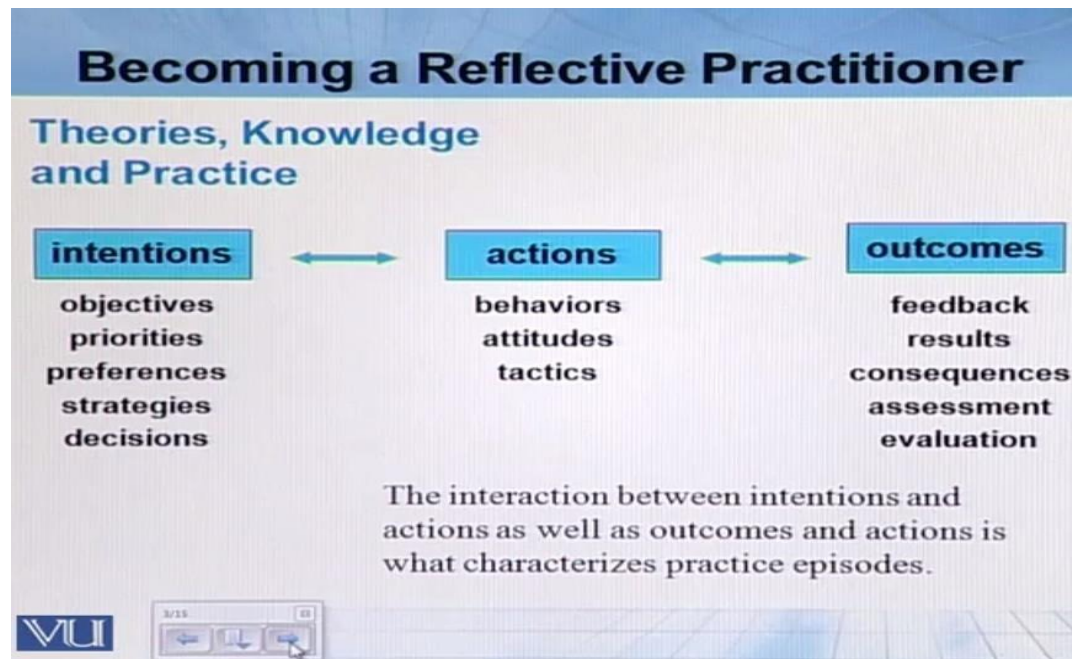
- The critical factors for the **success of the** community of practice are that it does reduce the numbers of hours that any individual needs to give in solving problems or issues that they are experiencing because answers may already be within the community.
 - It decreases the extent of the learning curve. Learning for reflective practitioner happens much more quickly, much more rapidly because of the knowledge which is being shared.
 - It cuts the amount of experimentation which is needed by the reflective practitioner. There is no need for re-working and re-inventing when somebody has already done that.
 - It's also about increasing the amount of innovation that can take place **because** innovation is supported by the community.
-

- Because the community is at to provide support, it means that the number of mistakes and errors that can occur will reduce because people will anticipate them and will have solutions for them.
- Because the community is there to support reflective practice. It means that any changes happen very quickly rather than taking time because of the reflective process.

Theories, Knowledge and Practice: Practice Episodes

Practice Episodes

Practice Episodes are a useful means of an individual to be a reflective practitioner. Practice Episodes are made of three components. Antecedents this is very much related to context in which the reflective practitioner is working. Theories of Practice that we are applying to teaching and something which we called practice episodes. Practice Episodes are comprised of three components. Our intentions within our teaching that action we can take and the outcomes of those actions. The intentions that actions and the outcomes form are a cycle that we can use as a reflective practitioner which brings substance which built the quality of the experience in the practice episode.



Intentions

We can see in this diagram the intentions that we bring in this practice episode. Things like our objectives, our priorities, preferences we have about the way we teach and the way we interact with students, the strategies we employ and the decisions we make in a lesson and about lesson. This interacts with the actions we take and the actions are based on our attitudes, behaviors and the strategies that we are directly applying.

Actions and Outcomes

The actions interact with the outcomes or in other words their consequences on the students learning, there results that comes out of the actions, their feedback we get and how we can use feedback for evaluation and assessment. The interaction between these components, between the intentions and actions, between the actions and outcomes is really what categorizes a practice episode. From this we can say that practice episodes are actually very much dynamic. This very much about the relationship between the intentions and actions on the comes. How the actions reflect the intentions and how the reality reflect the actions and of course how the intention reflect the outcomes, how these three things come together and interaction with one another.

Within this interaction which occurs within a specific context, practice episodes occur within a specific cultural context which is the antecedents' part of the framework.

Cultural Milieu (Antecedents)

The cultural context, the social context, the pedagogical context, the religious context the so many different contexts which provides background in which practice episodes occur. This context or antecedent component of practice episodes influences directly and quite powerfully the practice episodes that the reflective practitioner is engaging with. Therefore, we can understand the dynamism within the practice episodes not within the episodes but within the antecedents which impact on the practice episodes. Therefore, these can intrinsically affect the theories of practice in relation to the work that they are doing. So, practice episodes can feedback to a teacher understanding of theories as they are applied to practice. Understanding of the theoretical foundation that we are applying. Practice episodes inform us about the practice of theory. This is really not enough for the reflective practitioner. While integrating the theories of practice and the practice episodes, we need to do as reflective practitioner to add in the antecedents to this because they are powerfully influencing what we are doing and also incorporate all of this into decisions that we are making about the practice on the actions.

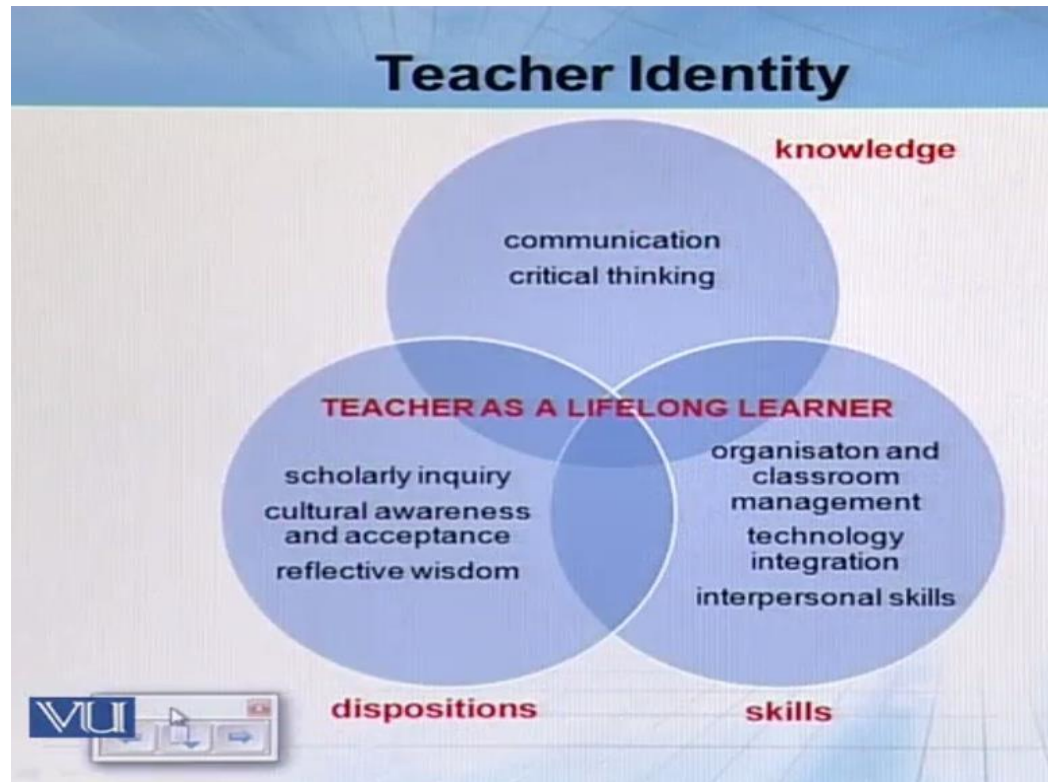
Reflective Practice

Therefore, we need to build antecedents into the model where the practice episodes and the theories of practice that we have interact with one another and the antecedents' than inform that interaction. In other words, we are getting information which we are feeding into the practice episodes from the antecedents which inform the interaction between the components of the practice episode. Therefore, it creates an opportunity for the development of professional knowledge for the reflective practitioner in the way we are linking facts and interpretations into a combined whole which we can call professional knowledge.

Reflecting and Connecting with Lifelong Learning: Teachers as a Lifelong Learners

Teachers as lifelong learners

To develop teacher identity, reflective practitioner needs to connect with lifelong learning. It's important for us to consider teacher as a lifelong learner. For reflective practitioners there are certain areas of learning that we need to engage with as a lifelong learner. There are certain proficiencies within these domains that we need to develop as reflective practitioners because they really guide us as lifelong learners. We can see here that the reflective practitioner is working with three domains of learning. Knowledge, skills and dispositions.



Skills

In terms of skills the teacher as a lifelong learner is working with classroom management and organization of management and technological integration for example, interpersonal skills within the context of working. In terms of the dispositions the reflective practitioner is someone who is working to develop certain wisdom in terms of reflective practice and to also a cultural awareness and acceptance of values within the school environment. As well as a confidence and a competence with inquiry into the process of teaching and reflection.

Knowledge

In terms of knowledge teacher identity is developed through communication and through critical thinking and through these three domains we can consider particular aspects of the process of reflection. Knowledge

definitely includes courses of education in order to develop us intellectually but also developing practical skills whether written or oral. Its written or oral communication which is a means of developing knowledge, quantitative literacy of what we are doing and also the ability to think what we are doing and also the approach to manage successfully as teachers. In terms of knowledge, we must be highly performing teachers very well versed in the subject we are teaching in the pedagogy of subject we are teaching. In essence we must be expert in the field and perhaps this is one of the defining characteristics of this domain of teacher identity. As reflective practitioner we must be able to demonstrate the ability to apply that knowledge to apply content and to also apply to apply the teaching of that content to the students and be critical about that within the educational setting.

The knowledge domain for the teacher is about possessing knowledge and the materials we need to acquire, the materials we need to find in order to access the knowledge especially within the subject we are teaching. There is the skills domain also which is very much focusing on the practical abilities that we are bringing to the roles of teaching and it can be very broad and expand across the school environment but can also develop from teacher beginning phases, teacher preparation through to experience practitioners. With experience skills domain become very powerful area for teacher skill development because through this our metacognition becomes significant through emancipation processes.

There are examples we can draw on in terms of the skill domain and what this means that we are looking at the skills within the context within the climate of the school. The micro politics within the school and the issues around the politics that occur and how this impacts our motivation to teach, the passion we have as teachers. This also generates for us the curiosity that we have about our professional identity and how we grow as professional selves.

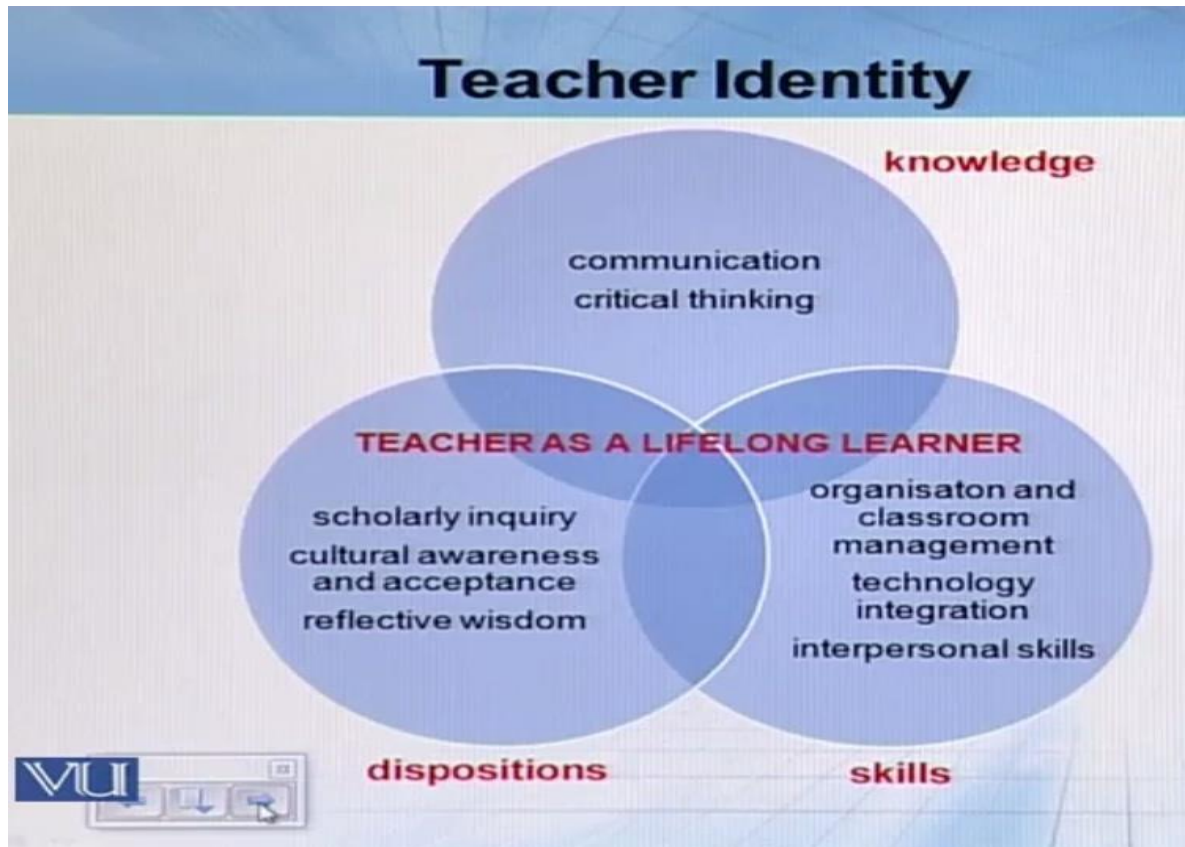
The skills domain is also significant for building confidence, confidence as teachers and confidence as experimenters in reflective practice. Experimentation involves certain amount of risk. We need to be confident to deal with risk. There is also an underlying premise for the teacher as a lifelong learner in the skills domain and that is we believe that all students can learn and learn very well and achieve well and this belief underpins the skills domain so that it becomes a key component of our identity.

Dispositions

So, the teacher as a lifelong learner is always extending his knowledge, the practical knowledge, the subject knowledge and the experiential knowledge they are acquiring over time. Through this teacher identity really evolves into something quite powerful and of course there is dispositions domain the attitudes, the beliefs and the assumptions that an individual reflective practitioner has about teaching and about the patterns of professional selves. The teacher therefore within this domain, the teacher who has grown identity is somebody who can demonstrate behaviors consistent with ideals of best practice and bring these to classroom in terms of fairness and openness and honesty so that all students have best opportunity to learn.

Reflecting and Connecting with Lifelong Learning: Teachers as Lifelong Learners**Teachers as Lifelong Learners**

We have seen that there are three domains of learning and there are certain proficiencies and we need to understand and explore these particular proficiencies within these domains



Knowledge Communication

In terms of knowledge domain there is communication, how the reflective practitioner uses communication skills effectively in terms of teaching and in terms of their reflective practice.

The reflective practitioner is using appropriate verbal and written communication, articulation of ideas in order to develop their practice and develop the practice of others and it's not about necessarily communication but it's about using language to build an understanding of ideas and to bring experience together with theory. Additionally, it's also about how the reflective practitioner uses different media different means to communicate ideas whether it's written to journal or through magazine a professional magazine or through other medium may be a blog or through other writing. Communication therefore brings clarity to the reflective process and it provide opportunity for feedback and developing ideas and goals for further development. This very much contributes to the ability to structure and restructure knowledge and to reinforce their learning.

Communication skills also allow the teacher to achieve the goals they have set for themselves because it is a means for clarifying those goals and therefore motivating towards the goals and therefore motivating towards the goals provide enthusiasm about the subject and about the learning of that subject. Teachers as lifelong learners are therefore continually in the process of using and refining communication skills with themselves with colleagues with students in order to develop the teacher identity

Knowledge: Critical Thinking

Another component of knowledge is critical thinking and the teacher specifically needs to engage specifically with critical thinking because this focus understanding of key aspects of professional practice and professional identity and informs the creation and generation of the skills for the profession in a very reasoned and logical and informed way which can be trusted by teachers and by communities of practice. Critical thinking is very powerful model for the teachers to use in terms of the process of thinking through teaching in the classroom and working with students and therefore, it does contribute to the context of teaching and even contributes to the wider society

Skills: Interpersonal Skills

In terms of domains of teaching interpersonal skills becomes very significant for the lifelong learner. The capacity to interact with people to sympathize with others to share sensitivity towards other people in the community and to work with both adults and children very productively very positively in caring and meaningful ways and therefore producing environments which are good examples of these qualities. Interpersonal skills we possess therefore in terms of the skills we need to foster in terms of peer collaboration. The teacher therefore must be willing to work with others to seek help from others and advice and guidance in order to develop themselves as lifelong learners. Therefore, interpersonal skills form a basis for this continuation process.

Skills: Integration of Discipline

Integration of discipline knowledge is very important. The discipline the subject we are working in is significant for lifelong learning because it's the subject we are teaching, we need to integrate the different perspectives of the discipline into our views of the subject and how we intend to teach that subject to the students and how the teacher brings all of these together actually helps with teacher identity.

Skills: Technology Integration

Technology integration in the classroom or in the school environment is useful for constructing knowledge because it's through this process which brings reflective practice into the 21st century

Skills: Organization and Classroom Management

Organization and classroom management is another proficiency that the teacher is engaging with, because classrooms are very complex environments. Teaching engages with very complex activities and therefore there needs to be very careful supports mechanism for the reflective practitioner in this regard with relation to reflective practice. We need to therefore adopt strategies which are very productive in terms of developing skills for classroom management and organization management and which support the organization as well as our own positive expectations of teaching and learning.

Dispositions: Scholarly Inquiry

Scholarly Inquiry is a very fundamental principle of reflective practice. Teachers need to be well versed with experimentation, exploration and also be knowledgeable about trends and issues which are emerging in teaching and how can we bring these to our own teaching through research and through experimentation within the academic environment.

Dispositions: Reflective Wisdom

Through reflection teachers gain more understandings of their roles and the knowledge they bring to the teaching and therefore this can help teacher become much more effective as a teacher, develop the teacher

identity and this is very useful for lifelong learning. Reflective wisdom is ongoing it's not something that we acquire. It is ever evolving and ever changing. It is something that the reflective practitioner will grow on continuously as a means of ongoing learning and development

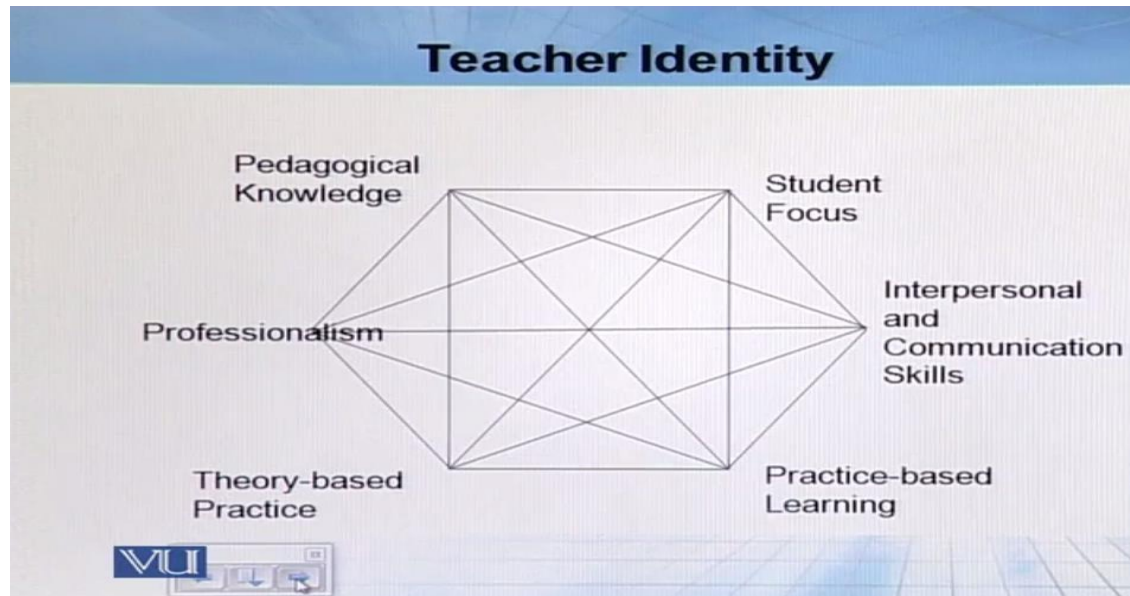
Dispositions: Cultural Awareness and Acceptance

And also, the cultural awareness and acceptance, the context in which the teacher is working and the diversity of personalities and experiences the teacher is working with. The teacher must provide educational opportunities for everyone, themselves and the students they are working with and their colleagues because this will strengthen everybody's appreciation through the diversity of what is potential and what is possible.

Reflecting and Connecting with Lifelong Learning: Competency Framework for Lifelong Learning

Competency Framework for Lifelong Learning

To develop teacher identity, we can look at the competency framework for lifelong learning. This is a framework which enables the reflective learner to consider components of their practice which will help them develop their identity as teachers. The competency framework which is about lifelong learning is a framework which is continuous and supportive and most importantly it is also impairing for the individual. The competency framework therefore evolves overtime. It can be added to and is used long term. It lasts for the life span of the teacher. It is not theoretical; it is very much an applied framework for the teacher and is useful in terms that it builds confidence within into the teacher identity development process. Any competency framework that you use is very useful for the reflective practitioner because it helps define not only the components of teacher identity but also the interaction between those components of teacher identity.



For example, in this framework we can see that interpersonal and communication skills form parts of teacher identity as well as learning from practice and the theory-based practice. These are three components of framework for competence. Also, another component which we can think of in terms of professionalism as well as pedagogical knowledge the knowledge we have about teaching the particular subject and then the final component of the competency framework could be something like our focus on the learners we have and the students we are working with. So, we see a number of components of teacher identity and there can be connections between any of these components. For example, how does interpersonal skill interact with professionalism? How does interpersonal skill interact with pedagogical knowledge? We are not only identifying the components of framework but how these components interact with one another. So, the competency framework then is very much about active participation in the process of teaching and the process of reflection. It very much helps us define the goals and how to accomplish those goals for teaching. It helps us set goals which are very specific, very measurable that we can define and realize the outcomes of our actions. They can set the timeline that we are working with in terms of development and also help us to identify the resources we need in order to help us develop as reflective practitioners. It's also senses about defining the goals, setting the goals. We need to consider that the particular goals can be set in terms of teacher identity as a reflective practitioner.

Essential Goals

There can be essential goals, dictated perhaps by the school community or by wider society.

These are goals that are essential for us that we do not have a choice about.

Problem-solving Goals

We also have problem solving goals. We experience issues in the classroom, problems in the classroom and therefore we have goals which we set to overcome those problems.

Innovation Goals

Then we have innovation goals. Goals which are about change, development and about professional growth which all come together to lead to professional teacher identity and we can look at this in terms of smarter framework

RP and the Socratic Method

- Socratic method aimed at understanding.
- Socrates questioned and examined and cross-examined his fellow citizens, not to convey a new truth to them in the manner of an instructor but only to point out the path along which it might be found.

A useful strategy for developing teacher identity through reflective practice is the Socratic method. The Socratic method is essentially aimed at developing understanding. Socrates developed an approach to questioning reality based on a thorough understanding of skills for questioning and exploring or cross-examining evidence in order to arrive at the truth of a situation.

The Socratic method:

- Questioning in order to reveal the ‘not-knowing’ (Socratic attitude).
- Gathering of examples from ordinary life.
- Reason from examples to most general presuppositions.
- Planned investigation into concepts.
- Investigate the concepts as such (definitions).
- Make yourself think.

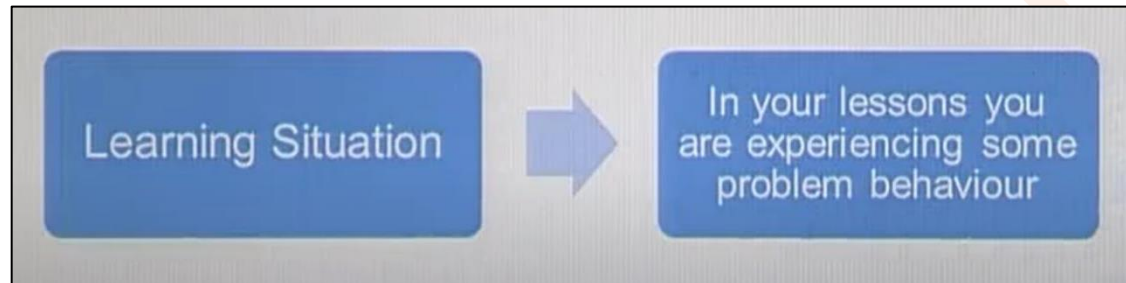
Six Steps in Socratic Questioning

The six steps in Socratic Questioning are:

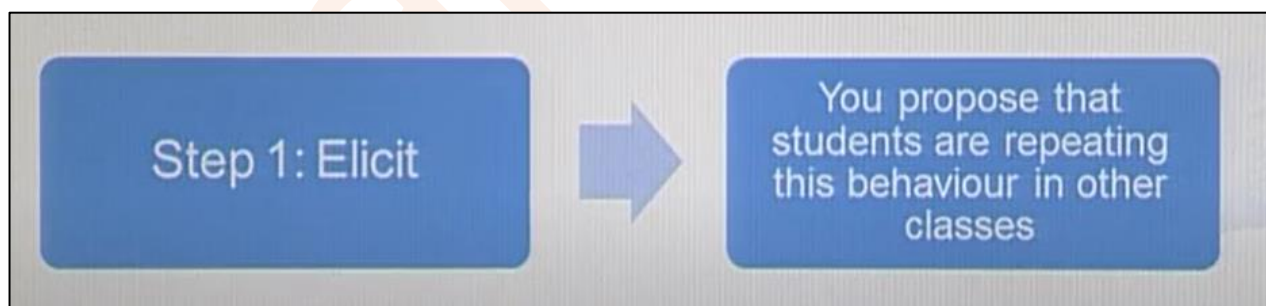
- Choose a topic and a question
- Give examples from own experiences
- Which example suits the topic best?
- Write out the example in detail
- Examine underlying principles
- Generalize answer (regressive abstraction)

The 4 Steps of the Socratic Method

- The ultimate goal for the Socratic Learning Method is not to help you to come up with a proposition that you can rest safely with.
 - The true goal of the Method is to help you examine your own beliefs and new information you encounter.
 - In frequently exerting the Socratic Learning Method, you should become independent as a reflective practitioner with curiosity and sensitivity toward new information, and gradually develop a mental habit of active inquiry and vigorous thinking.
 - The four steps of the method can be represented diagrammatically:
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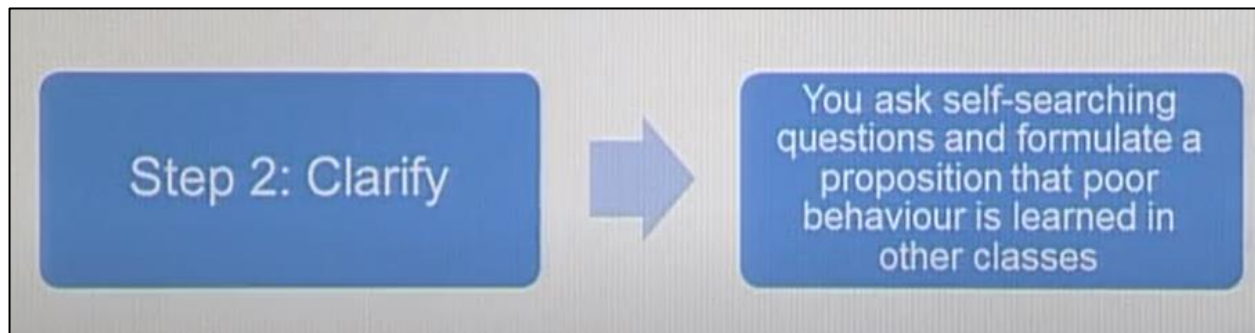


Here we can see that the Socratic method is defined as a sequence, moving from a situation to a decision. Let's look at an example: the Learning Situation in terms of the Socratic method, it might be that you as a teacher experiencing some problem behaviour in the classroom, note how this is framed differently not as a problem, not as an experience, but as a learning situation, and this is quite key for the Socratic method. The experiences that we have, the problems that we're experiencing are not spoken of in terms of problems, but in terms of potential for learning.

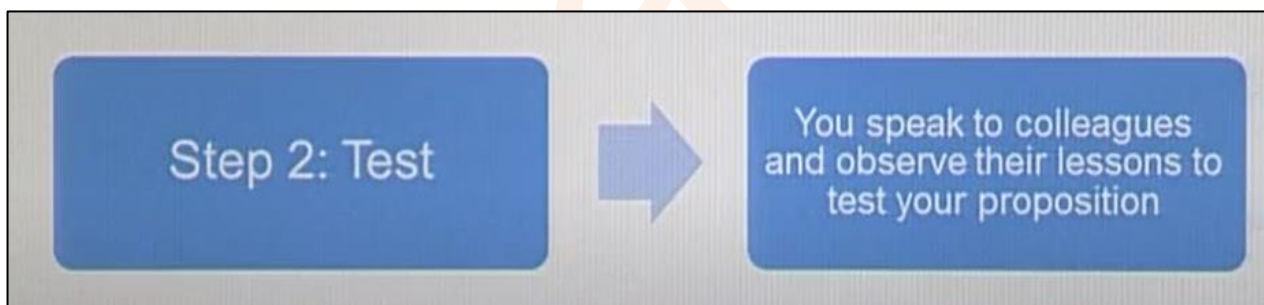


The **first step** in the Socratic method is to **elicit** meaning and to elicit the detail from the learning situation. And in the example which we are looking at, it could be that the teacher might propose that the students are

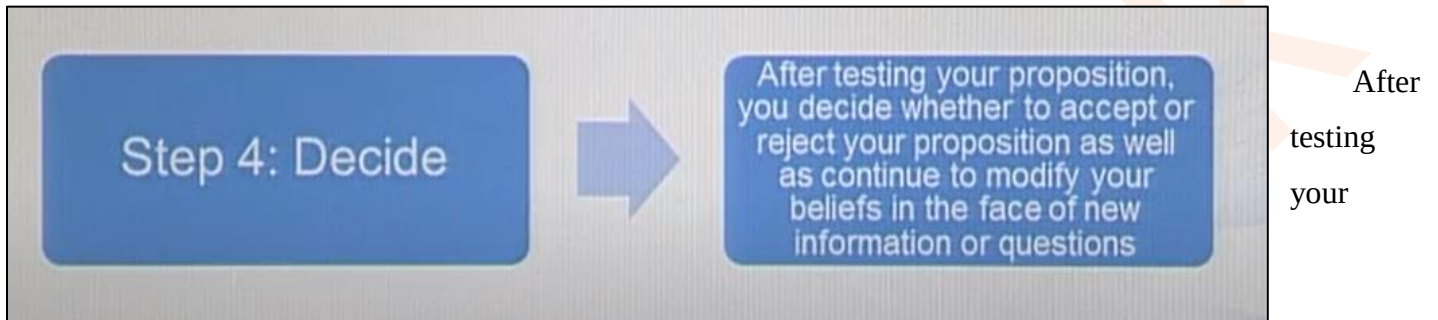
misbehaving in all lessons and not just in their own lesson, and that might be a starting point for further questioning and further exploration.



The **second step** is for the reflective practitioner to **clarify** the learning situation to get a better appreciation of the components which are creating the learning situation. So, at this point the teacher may be asking some questions about their own role in relation to the students' behaviour, and trying to come to some sort of proposition about why the behaviour is occurring. It might be for example that the students are misbehaving in all of their lessons, and therefore, this is some sort of learned behaviour which is carried through the whole of the school day.



The **third step** is about **testing** the propositions, it could be speaking with colleagues, it could also be about observing behaviour in the other classes, just to see for yourself whether the proposition about poor behaviour across all of the lessons is actually true.



proposition. You decide whether to accept or reject your prop

The **fourth step** is making a **decision**. Deciding whether the proposition is true and whether the experience needs to be questioned further. At this point, you're actually testing whether what you believe is true and making a decision to either accept the proposition or to decline it. And therefore, to rethink the initial idea about what is the cause of the problem, in order to then begin questioning again to find a better solution.

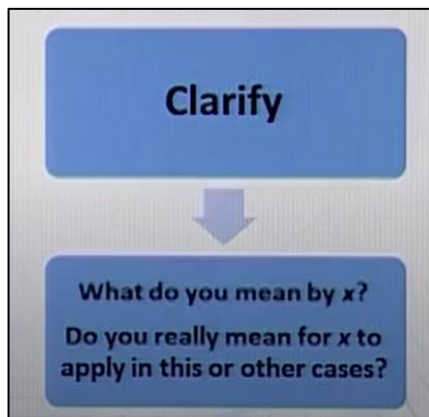
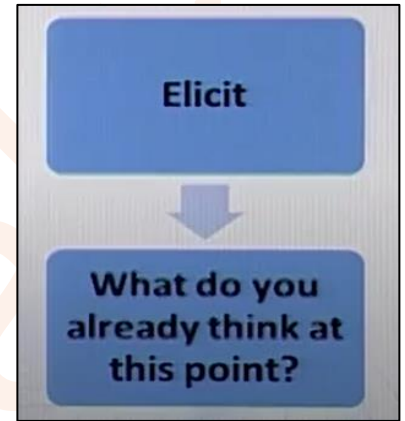
RP and the Socratic Method: Questions for Each Step in the Socratic Method

Questions for Each Step in the Socratic Method

- There are some questions you can ask yourself for each step of the Socratic Method.
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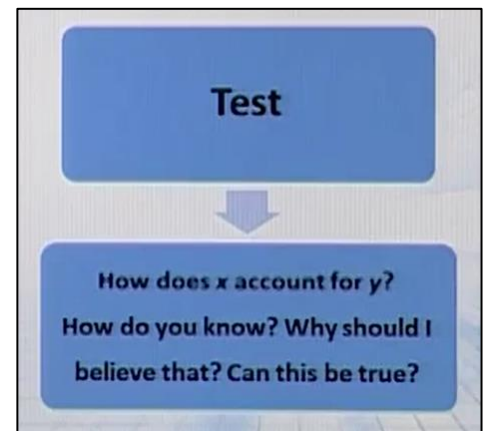
We have explored how the reflective practitioner can use the Socratic method to develop their identity as a teacher, and we will look at the questions that can be applied to the Socratic method. What is useful at this point is to explore specifically the questions for each step of the method.

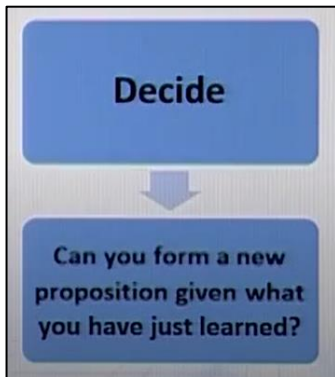
The first step of the Socratic method is called elicit: Elicitation of facts and understanding from a situation. And a question that the reflective practitioner can ask themselves at this point is what do they already think about the situation, what are they already know about the experience, and what other experiences are informing them at this point.



The next step of the Socratic method is clarifying understanding about a situation or experience. So, questions which are useful to ask at this point is: what do I mean by X, what do I mean when I say this thing, what do I really understand about the situation as I experience it and as I perceive it.

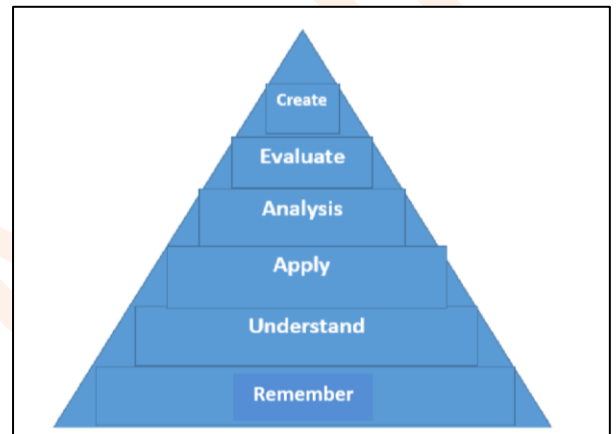
The third step of the Socratic method is testing our understanding, testing the assumptions and the presumptions that we are building as reflective practitioners. So, questions like: how does X relate to Y, how do I know what I'm saying from this experience, can it actually be true and can it really be true what I'm saying is happening, or is there another way of saying this is another reason.





And then **the final step of the Socratic method is decision making** for the reflective practitioner. So, the questions like: can the reflective practitioner form a new proposition, a new understanding of the situation based on the questioning process.

- **Link your questions to Bloom's Taxonomy**
- **Move from lower-order questions to higher-order questions.**
 - **Remember:**
 - 'Description',
 - 'Interpretation',
 - 'Outcome'



RP and the Socratic Method: Questions for Each Step in the Socratic Method

Questions for Each Step in the Socratic Method

Question Types

- Questions of purpose force us to define our task.
 - Questions of Information force us to look at our sources of information as well as the quality of our information.
 - Questions of Interpretation force us to examine how we are organizing or giving meaning to the information.
 - Questions of Assumption force us to examine what we are taking for granted.
 - Questions of Implication force us to follow out where our thinking is going.
-

- Questions of point of view force us to examine our point of view and to consider other relevant point of views.
- Questions of Relevance force us to discriminate what does and what does not bear on a question.
- Questions of Accuracy force us to evaluate and test for truth and correctness.
- Questions of Precision force us to give details and be specific.
- Questions of consistency force us to examine our thinking for contradictions.
- Questions of Logic force us to consider how we are putting the whole of our thought together, to make sure that it all adds up and makes sense within a reasonable system of some kind.

RP and the Socratic Method: Questions for Each Step in the Socratic Method

Questions for Each Step in the Socratic Method

- The mnemonic PAPER CLIP can be used to construct a sequence of questions which stimulate deeper thinking.
- Three types of questions are often used: exploratory, spontaneous and focused.
- Exploratory questions show us how much we know and may be used to explore a new topic or review past discussions that may relate to the current issue.
- Spontaneous questions can be used to explore our beliefs and assumptions; they allow us to reflect on the issue at hand.
- Focused questions narrow the discussion, stimulating us intellectually.

Questions are perhaps the most useful component of applying the Socratic method to reflective practice, and we've seen how questions can be used. There's a very simple mnemonic that we can use to help or guide the questioning process, and that mnemonic is **PAPER CLIP**. This helps move thinking from low-order to higher-order, and uses questioning to guide that process.

There are three types of questions: exploratory, spontaneous and focused. **Exploratory questions** are those initial questions helping us to understand the situation. **Spontaneous questions** are about our response to a situation. **Focused questions** help us get detail from the situation.

Exploratory questions are very much about the reflective practitioner using the Socratic method, and using this particular mnemonic PAPER CLIP to get a thorough understanding, gather all the information required to get very much clarity about an experience of they're having.

Spontaneous questions which are very much related to the immediate response, and the teachers' assumptions in relation to the situation that they're experiencing.

Focused questioning where we narrow down the discussion from a broad topic and get more clarity, or in other words, we are moving from broad ideas to very specific and detailed ideas.

So, using the mnemonic PAPER CLIP can help guide this questioning process.

P	Precision questions .Can you be more specific?
A	Accuracy questions. How could we test that?
P	Perceptive question. Is there another point of view we could examine?
E	Equity Questions. What conflict of interest exist here?
R	Relevance questions. How does this relate to the problem?
C	Complexity questions. What make this difficult question to answer?
L	Logic questions. Does this all make sense tighter?
I	Importance questions. What is more important issue on which to focus?
P	Perspicuity questions, - What do you mean?

The mnemonic PAPER CLIP identifies particular types of words to ask at any particular point. Using PAPER CLIP, we start off with **precision questions**, or in other words, questions which are helping the reflective practitioner become more aware of the situation and the details in the situation. For example, as a reflective practitioner you might ask yourself: can you be more aware of what is going on, can you be more specific about what is going on.

Accuracy questions: how could you test that particular assumption, how could you get a better understanding of whether the assumption is true or false.

The next letter in the mnemonic is about **perspective questions:** is there a different way of seeing the situation or the problem, is there a different perspective that you can use to examine the situation.

Equity questions: what are the conflicts of interest, or what are the biases that may exist within the situation which can affect the way it's being perceived.

The **'R'** in PAPER CLIP stands for **relevance questions:** how does this relate to the problem, how does X relate to Y, how is all of this understood as a logical whole.

The **'C'** in PAPER CLIP stands for **complexity questions:** what makes this a difficult question to answer. Remember, as reflective practitioners, we're always working in messy situations, and always trying to set unsatisfactory questions, so that we're always questioning rather than just finding solutions.

The **'L'** in PAPER CLIP stands for **logic questions:** does this all make sense, how does all this come together, how do all the component fit together into a logical whole.

The **'I'** stands for **importance questions:** what is the most important issue here, what is the most significant component of this situation.

And then the **'P'** letter in PAPER CLIP stands for **perspicuity questions**, in other words, what does this mean to me, what does this actually mean as a whole, how is all of this translated and perceived by all the actors in the situation.

So, we can see that this mnemonic **PAPER CLIP** provides a very sound structure, a list of trigger words that we can use to question a situation from the perspectives of description and through to a decision for the reflective practitioner.

Socratic Questioning and Critical Thinking

- Thinking is driven by questions: No questions mean no understanding.
-

- The key to distinguishing *Socratic Questioning* from questioning is that Socratic questioning is always systematic and deep, focusing on complex concepts, principles, theories, issues or problems.
- Socrates was fundamentally concerned with the soundness of reasoning, with getting closer and closer to the truth in any given situation. He was more interested in the process of learning – the questioning process- than in reaching conclusions.
- The Socratic method involves two primary processes- the destructive and the constructive process.

- **The Destructive Process**

In the destructive process, ideas formerly held are shown to be illogical or otherwise unsound. In other words, the practitioner comes to recognize the flawed nature of the reasoning.

- **The Constructive Process**

In the constructive process, the practitioner is encouraged to replace the flawed thinking with logical or justifiable thinking.

- **Critical thinking and Socratic questioning both share a common end.**

Critical thinking gives a comprehensive view of how the mind functions and Socratic questioning takes advantage of that overview to frame questions essential to the quality of that pursuit.

- **Critical Thinking**

The goal of critical thinking is to establish an additional level of thinking to our thinking, a powerful inner voice of reason, to monitor, assess and re-constitute in a more rational direction- our thinking, feeling, and action.

- **Social Discussion**

- Socratic discussion cultivates that inner voice through an explicit focus on systematic, deep, disciplined questioning.
- The Critical Thinker considers the elements of thoughts.

The goal of critical thinking is essentially to establish levels of thinking about our thinking, and creating a questioning reflective, in order to take the situation re-constituted in a very meaningful way for ourselves, develop a much deeper understanding and understand our responses to that situation.

And in a way, Socratic discussion is a process of dialogue, whether it's dialogue with self or dialogue with others in relation to a similar explicit, and deep appreciation of the experience that we're having.

The critical thinker is looking at particular elements not only of the situation but elements of thought, which is also part of the process of Socratic questioning. What we can end up with at this point is a sequence, a cycle of thinking and questioning. When we bring these two things together, we are looking at the goals of

the process of thinking, where exploring issues through questions, gathering information, eliciting deeper understanding to make interpretations and inferences about the experience. Then

from this, we're divining concepts, bringing clarity for ourselves about theories and principles which lead to assumptions for ourselves as reflective practitioners, and which help us develop new

frames for thinking, and this ultimately leads to new goals and objectives as part of the reflective practice process. So, we can see that critical thinking and Socratic questioning share very common processes and very common goals.



How to be Reflective

- For the busy teacher, it can feel like there is not enough time for RP.
 - There are many tools to assist you.
 - **Feedback**
 - Feedback is central to the process of reflection.
-

- Can be written or verbal.
- We receive feedback about our behaviour, our skills, our values, the way we relate to others.
- Key question: “How do I know that I have accurately perceived what I have seen and what I have heard?”
- We can ask others for clarity.
- We should ask others how they see us.
- Ask this simple question: “will you give me some feedback on what I did?”

Who you should ask?

- Someone you trust.
 - Someone with more experience than you.
 - Ask more than one person.
 - Be as specific as possible and request specific feedback.
- **What I have learned?**
 - Ask yourself regularly, “what I have learned today?”
 - This is a positive approach to processing information.
 - **Valuing Personal Strengths**
 - Take time regularly to review all the things you have achieved.
 - When you think of something that needs improvement, think of 5 things you have achieved.

Viewing Experiences Objectively

- Recall an incident.
 - Imagine the incident on a stage with you watching in the audience.
 - Look carefully to see what is happening and what people are saying.
 - This is called a ‘participant observer’ of your own experience.
- **Empathy**
 - Try to see, hear and feel what the other person is experiencing.
-

- **Keeping a Journal**

- Keeping a journal to log your reflections.

When you read your journal, ask yourself: “what do I see when I do this review?”

Who Can We Reflect With?

- Personal or individual reflection
- Shared reflection (with colleagues)
- Families
- Students
- **Personal or Individual Reflection**

Some critical reflection is deeply personal and would not be shared until some time has elapsed and you feel ready to talk about what you learned about yourself.

- **Shared Reflection**

Critical reflection cannot be just by yourself. Just saying something out loud to someone else can help fill in holes and can sometimes help you to find answers.

Facilitating shared Reflection

Conversation and debate with:

- Colleagues
- Other professionals working in the same setting
- Professionals working in another setting
- A professional network (peers on a course)

Reflecting with families on:

- Their values, culture and traditions and what that might mean for practice.
-

- Their understanding of their children's interests, strengths and abilities.
- Their priorities or aspirations for their children and how a teacher can support these goals.
- Their children's progress.
- Their perspectives on play and learning.
- How they and professionals can work together to progress the children's learning and development.
- How they experience the school.
- Opportunities for learning in everyday experiences.

Using reflecting questions with students.

- Reflective questions are open, requiring answers other than 'yes' or 'no'.
- Can motivate them to persist as well as encourage them to try new strategies and experiences.
- Displaying or documenting children's work can help to make children's reflection visible by including their words about how they learned, what they learned and who or what helped them to learn.

The Practice of Reflection: Bloom and Professional Careers

Bloom and Professional Careers

- **Recognizing Bloom's Domains of Learning;**
 - Cognitive domain: knowledge based
 - Psychomotor domain: skills based
 - Affective domain: attitudes, feelings

We've been looking at how to support reflection especially when teachers are very busy. A useful scaffold for engaging with reflection is 'Bloom's Taxonomy'. Bloom's taxonomy is divided into three domains. The first domain is the **cognitive domain** which is knowledge-based, the development of an acquisition of knowledge for the reflective practitioner. The second domain is the psychomotor or the skills-based domain, the third domain is the **affective domain**, or in other words, their feelings, attitudes and values that the reflective practitioner has.

- **Cognitive Domain:**

- Lowest level-Knowledge- recall of data
- Comprehension
- Application
- Analysis
- Synthesis
- Highest level-Evaluation-critiques, judgements about the value of ideas.

- **Relevance to Career Path- Employers look for self-reflective people with:**

- Skills of analysis
- Interpersonal skills
- Self-development
- Critical reflection on performance

Setting Objectives

- An objective is a clearly defined target that has the following characteristics:
 - Specific
 - Measurable
 - Action-based
 - Realistic
 - Time-Bound

The Practice of Reflection: The Professional Development Plan (PDP)**The Professional Development Plan (PDP)****What is PDP?**

- A way of recording, reflecting on and writing about the practical outcomes of experiences.
 - A personalized record of one's career or experiences.
-

Why keep a PDP?

- It provides you with a record of your professional development.
- Useful as a means of updating a Curriculum Vitae.
- It personalizes learning by encouraging the teacher to own and value their development and achievements.
- It enables the individual to demonstrate coherence in their professional development and plan for the future.

Example of a PDP

Becoming a Reflective Practitioner	
The Practice of Reflection	
Example of a PDP	
What am I good at?	What am I not so good at?
What practices I want to continue?	What areas I wish to improve in?

A simple format for the professional development journal is to use a framework of questions. An example here of questions in a PDB could be: 'what am I good at' that would be a good starting point for the reflective practitioner in terms of identifying strengths and interests, and in connection with this it would also be good to ask: 'what am I not so good at'. To identify those **development needs**, **another simple question to add into** a PDP could be: what practices do I want to continue, what ones do I want to develop in more depth and detail, and in contrast to that what areas do I wish to improve in, what weaknesses do I need to overcome. So,

we can see that a professional development journal can provide a very simple framework for reflection, and engages a reflective practitioner in a well-defined process which can be very efficient and supportive.

The Process

- How are you going to develop the skill?
- What is the time frame for this development?
- How are you going to check whether you have been successful at developing this skill?

Reflecting on your PDP

- Do you feel you have succeeded in your personal/academic development? If so, why? if not, why not?
- What changes would you make to the Personal/Academic Development Plan if you had to do it again?
- What is the main thing you learnt from the process?
- What other things have you learnt from the process?
- What ideas have you had for developing other areas of your own practice?

Why Be a Reflective Practitioner?

- To enable professional development:
 - The 'knowledge' economy.
 - Undertaking continuous professional development is a requisite of working as a teacher.

To maintain quality

- Reflecting on what went wrong and why=improvement.
- Reflecting on what went well and why=good practice.

It's important to be a reflective practitioner because as a very simple process, it enables us to ensure the quality of what we're doing, and we can focus on why things are going wrong, and why they're going wrong, and this gives us a focus for improvement. And at the same time, we can focus on why things are going well, and

how we can not only maintain that good work but also develop that expertise. In other words, it enables us to achieve what we would call good practice.

- Reflection then includes hard systematic thinking and a soft initiative insight, leading to a plan of action based on critical evaluation of all the available evidence.
- Do not just think about what went wrong/well and why – also plan to improve skills if necessary, or to use those skills in future events.

So, the reason why we reflect is not just to reflect on what went well and what went wrong, but actually to look at the whys and the hows of these questions, and to begin to really think about these things within a broader context, and that broader context is about quality and about improvement.

- Enhance your self-awareness
- Develop creative answers to difficulties
- Enhance your problem-solving skills
- Enhance your ability to evaluate
- Enhance your ability to action plan for success
- Make you an effective manager

Ghaye's Process of Development

- Good evidence is important
- Carefully selected
- Represent the standard
- Demonstrate competencies of standard
- Personally meaningful
- Paired and relevant
- Insightful and relevant

A level of the reflective process is about looking very closely and internally at our own experiences what Ghaye calls it '**Navel gazing**'. This is simply about being honest, and developing our self-awareness, and

considering the process of reflection as about improving on what we've done and learning from the experience, and learning from that improvement. It's about finding connections and re-assembling what we're doing to make more sense adjusting and manipulating it. It's about developing an individual identity and not just fitting in with what everybody else is doing. It's something which is part of the reflective practice process and in a way therefore, it supports the reflective practitioner in finding justifications for their actions in the classroom

Another level of the process is about understanding and learning from the day-to-day experiences which Ghayle calls as **'Learning from the day's chaos'**. This leads the reflective practitioner to do things like: to find reason through the experiences, and to find connections. And in this way the reflective practitioner is developing their work awareness and becoming more **aware** of their role and other people's role in the experience. It's therefore based in things like questioning of self and questioning of others, and this can lead to increase in confidence of the reflective practitioner in the classroom which ultimately leads to professional growth.

The third level of Ghayle's process is **'Talking about you do with others'**. This level is about sharing and learning from collaborating with others, and so at this level, the reflective practitioner is describing, remembering the experience, and seeking feedback which can be constructive in terms of the reflective practitioner's development. And so, the reflective practitioner is understanding feelings, understanding their personal response to experiences and where their response may be influencing the outcomes. And so, it might be about focusing on mistakes, but this is from a very developmental and improvement focused point of view.

- A 'reflective practitioner' is someone who does something and is automatically reflective.
 - Reviews what happened and asks 'why', 'how', 'where', 'what'?
 - What skills can you take forward/need to improve/develop?
 - How will I do this?
 - The best practitioners are constantly learning, evaluating and refining their practice, even after years of experience.
 - The next stage is to apply what you have learned from one situation to the next.
-

The Nature and Purpose of Professionalism

- There is great importance placed on teachers meeting a wide set of professional commitments and obligations.
- What values and practices should we reflect on which comprise 'being professional'?
- For reflection purposes, we need to think about 'professionalism-in-action'.
- What is it?

Professionalism-in-action

- Relating to pupils
- Relating to colleagues
- Relating to other professionals
- Relating to parents
- Relating to the school in its particular context

Teaching happens within a context, and so part of professionalism-in-action is the reflective practitioner relating their professional skills and their development of professional skills to the school context in particular.

- The professional role of the teacher is multi-faceted.
- There are different dimensions to this role that require reflection.
- The teacher's pastoral role.
- The teacher's academic (subject) professionalism.

This leads to the teacher:

- Reflecting on the reasons behind poor performance (for example).
- Reflecting on planning to integrate isolated/shy students into group activities.

The Nature and Purpose of Professionalism

- In addition to the academic and pastoral roles which need to be reflected on, different teachers may also have an underlying tendency towards a preferred mode of professionalism.
- This point is illustrated in the following diagram.
- Here we see the locations of two teachers (T1 and T2) on a matrix, where the horizontal axis measures degree of academic focus and the vertical axis shows degree of pastoral focus.
- Teacher (T1) tends to emphasize the pastoral aspects of the teaching role, whereas Teacher (T2), while mindful of the pastoral dimensions of teaching, tends to stress rather more its academic focus.
- The ability to be flexible and to adjust your own preferences to circumstances and requirements is an important skill to develop. It is a complex and subtle skill, however, and one which will continue to be developed as you continue to reflect on your professional role.
- Finally, your reflections on your professional role as a teacher will also encompass your contributions to extra-curricular activities, to whole-school initiatives and to the corporate life of a school.
- The idea of living out the ethos of a particular school, and helping to shape it, is at the heart of the rather special role of being a reflective practitioner.
- What is central to this distinctiveness is the idea that the reflective practitioner identifies and adheres to a code of professional values and practice.

Reflecting on Professional Roles: Reflecting on Notions of Professionalism

Reflecting on Notions of Professionalism

- **Reflecting in order to develop subject expertise is not sufficient.**
- **Other things are also vital:**
 - The imaginative mediation of content
 - Varied activities
 - Concern for all pupils
 - Fairness

We can look at the reflective practitioner's focus areas when exploring their professional roles and identity.

Reflecting on Professional Roles: The Reflective Practitioner-Professional Relations with Pupils

The Reflective Practitioner - Professional Relations with Pupils

- What is regarded as 'professional' must be linked with the in-action responsibilities and reflective practice of the teacher.
- Reflective practitioners must be seen to treat pupils with respect, fairness and consistency, that is from an unconditional positive stance.
- This requires you to operate with a knowledge of pupils' cultural and social backgrounds, their experience and their interests.
- This is not simple since the knowledge we possess of any pupil is partial and it may be the next piece of information we get about them that makes a difference to our interpretation of a situation and how to tackle it.

These concerns direct our focus as reflective practitioners onto key roles we have with students:

- Teacher as mentor
- Teacher 'in loco parentis'
- Teacher as observer
- Teacher as carer

For the professional, this leads reflective practice into an area of focus for reflection, and what we need to be doing in terms of our professional relationships with students is reflecting on particular roles that we take on. One particular role is the teacher as a **mentor**. A mentor is somebody who is working alongside students in the classroom, supporting and encouraging whilst challenging and cheerleading the successes of the students.

The teacher is also within a professional role **taking on some responsibilities as a parent** in the classroom. The teacher with students in the school environment must realize and also reflect on their responsibilities of care, nurture and support, that they have within that parental role in the classroom.

Another role is teacher as a professional in the classroom need also to work as a **participant observer** of their own practice. In this way, their professionalism can grow and their objectivity about their professional role can support the professional relationships that they have with students.

Also, there's the teacher as **carer** in the classroom. The professional relationship that we have with students is such that we are not simply there to teach the students a subject or for the students to show that they have achieved certain facts and figures, but we need to care for the students on a personal level as well as a professional level, and caring for students leads to better learning process.

Reflecting on Professional Roles: The Reflective Practitioner-Professional Relations with Colleagues

The Reflective Practitioner-Professional Relations with Colleagues

- When you are in school, you are not on your own, you are a member of different teams in the school.
- You need to reflect on how you are regarded as team-player in all these different teams.

Your professional relations with colleagues are an opportunity to extend your thinking.

- This is in contrast to solitary reflection.
- Reflecting with colleagues opens up a world of possibilities.

We can see that the professional relationships that we have with colleagues open up a number of worlds to us, open up our professional roles to opportunities that we have in terms of working with others. These opportunities are many and varied in terms of how we can develop our professional roles. We can think of our professional identity in terms of colleagues through any number of approaches and relationships, for example, things like **specific interest groups (SIGs)** are very useful to build up in a school environment working with colleagues, sharing with colleagues and working with others.

We can also think of contributing to the school and contributing to our colleague through things like **working together**. So, we're always therefore building the relationships that we have within the team, and learning from each other and sharing with each other as part of a team.

From a very simplistic point of view, we can think of their professional relationships we have with colleagues in terms of **staff meetings**, and even informal meetings that we might have in the classroom or in the school at any particular point. So, we can see that there are many different ways that we can engage professionally with colleagues, and with other professionals in the school.

Reflecting with colleagues is very important for us because it not only help us integrate into the school and feel valued with other professionals in the school, but it really is an opportunity to grow professionally with support and encouragement from others.

Reflecting on your Contribution to the School

- **Contributing to the life of the school is an indicator of a vibrant, inclusive school, generating gains for both skills and community.**

Reflecting on Your Contribution to the Life of the School

The definition of contribution includes:

- Cross-curricular activities
- Participating in projects
- Contributing to the distinctive ‘presence’ of the school.

School effectiveness can be viewed in terms of outcomes:

- Attendance
- Student attitudes
- Student behaviour
- Scholastic attainment

Reflecting on Your Contribution to the School

- The reflective practitioner needs to reflect on their role in uncovering what makes the school effective.
- How do you contribute to the 9 characteristics of high-performing schools:
 - A clear and shared focus
 - High standards and expectations for all students
 - Effective school leadership
 - High levels of collaboration and communication
 - Curriculum, instruction and assessments aligned with highly regarded standards
 - Frequent monitoring of learning and teaching
 - Focused professional development
 - A supportive learning environment
 - High levels of family and community involvement

Another characteristic to look at in terms of a high-performing school for the reflective practitioner to focus on is the curriculum, the quality of the curriculum, the instruction and the assessment associated with the curriculum content and the curriculum objectives, and these all need to be **aligned** together in terms of high-performing standards.

The Impact of Organizational Dynamics: What are teams?

Groups of two or more people who interact and influence each other are mutually accountable for achieving common objectives and perceive themselves as an social entity within an organization.

Groups vs teams?

- All teams are groups
 - Some groups are just people assembled together
 - Team has task interdependence whereas some groups do not (e.g. group of teachers enjoying lunch together).
-

Types of teams?

- Team-based department
- Team-based organization
- Quality circles

Temporary teams

- Task forces
- Temporary teams that investigate a problem

Some teams are temporary which tend to be very short-termed and are focused on achieving a particular goal. We can see the impact of organizational dynamics by looking at the categories of organizational dynamics. For example, the teams operate within an environment and the teams creates its own environment, its own identity. And therefore, they are imposing factors on the reflective practitioner from this category. For example, how communication occurs between teams and the organizational space and structure for the team and its work there is also the team design how big is the team and people involved in the team. This is another category that the reflective practitioner need to be aware of because of its potential impact that the team processes are very important to be aware of. The team processes can affect the functionality of the team and automatically all of these lead to team effectiveness and in other words how the goals are being achieved to what extent the objectives of the team are being met.

Teams' elements to reflect on:

Task characteristics

Better when tasks are clear

Easy to implement

Task interdependence

Share common inputs, processes of outcomes

So, we can see from this that the impact of teams and the impact of dynamics of teams for the reflective practitioner can be quite considerable from both a positive and negative point of view. So, there are certain characteristics to be looked at in terms of the impact of teams. The characteristics for the reflective practitioner are that the task should be accomplishable and it should be relevant to the team. And the reflective practitioner within the team can actually consider these imposing factors.

Team size

Smaller teams are better but large enough to accomplish task

If the team is quite small but large enough to complete a task this can have an effect on how the reflective practitioner is undertaking their role and undertaking the activity of reflection.

Team composition

- Members
- Motivated/competent to perform task in a team
- Environment
- Team diversity

Team composition is who are the people who comprise the team are they specialists or are they an accumulation of different specialized skills.

Homogeneous Teams**Heterogeneous Teams**

- Higher satisfaction
- Less conflict
- Faster team development
- More efficient coordination
- Performs better on simple tasks

- More conflict
- Slower team development
- Takes longer to agree on norms and goals
- Better knowledge and resources for complex tasks
- Tend to be more creative
- Higher potential for support outside the team

So, what this leads to is an understanding that teams are really homogeneous or in other words their people are supporting each other working together and developing as an entity in their own right there's a higher degree of satisfaction in teams than there is in groups and considerably less conflict whereas in a group of individuals who are not functioning as a team we're potentially looking at more conflict and also a slower pace of development. So, the reflective practitioner can look at these two components and understand whether they are a team or a group and. This is important in terms of reflective practitioner to understand the impact that working within an organization and the dynamics of the organization can have on reflective practice.

The Impact of Organizational Dynamics: RP and the Stages of Team Development

While we're looking at the impact of organizational dynamics on the reflective practice, we need to understand that a group of people working as a team go through different stages of development and functioning, **We can represent these stages diagrammatically.**

Here we can see that the group dynamics of a team go through different levels of functioning, at the initial stage of functioning is something called **forming**.

This is where the group comes together and starts to get to know other members of the group. This is the first stages of team development and essentially sets the tone for how the work occurs within the group.

The next stage of the group is called **storming**. This is where there can be conflict arising in the group because people have different ideas about how the work of the group should be achieved. Different people could try to lead the group towards achieving those goals. This can impact on the effectiveness quite severely of the group.

Once the group gets past the storming stage this point of potential conflict the group is known to move into a stage called **norming**. This is where the individual group roles are very clearly defined and people are undertaking those roles efficiently and effectively supporting each other in those roles. This is where the group of people starts to become a functioning team to the point where the team ultimately starts to perform at a high level.

At the **performing** stage everybody supporting each other working together and understanding how that work supports the achievement of the goals.

In permanent teams these four stages can be transitioned through backwards and forwards the group can always go back to storming after it's been performing some for different reasons. It could be that a new member joins the group or there is some change in the functioning of the group. It's certainly not a one-way road. It is a journey backwards and forwards potentially that the group goes through.

If it's a temporary group then there will be a point where the individual members leave the group. The task is completed and this is known as **an adjourning stage**, at this stage the group members are leaving each other the work is completed. There's no reason for them to see each other or to be involved with one another again.

Team norms

- Informal rules and expectations used to regulate behaviors.
 - Norms develop through-
 - Critical events in team's history
 - Explicit statements
 - Initial team experiences
 - Beliefs/values teachers bring to the team
-

Reflecting on team norms

- How to introduce norms when forming teams
- Selecting members with preferred norms
- Discuss counterproductive norms
- Rewarding of behaviors representing desired norms
- Dysfunctional norms

Reflection on group Stages

- How to move the team from 'forming' to 'performing'
- How to deal with 'storming'
- Your role in helping the team 'perform'
- What do you observe are the causes when the team slips backwards?
- What ideas do you have to the team move forward?

The Impact of Organizational Dynamics: Team Cohesiveness and Performance and the Reflective Practitioner

There are a number of causes/influences on team cohesiveness:

The reflective practitioner needs to consider the members of cohesive teams (including themselves):

- Want to remain members
- Are willing to share information
- Have strong interpersonal bonds
- Want to support each other
- Resolve conflict effectively
- Are more satisfied and experience, less stress

Team performance

The reflective practitioner needs to also consider the performance of the team and their role in the team.

What do you need to reflect on?

- Individuals better/faster on some task
- Cost of developing and maintaining teams
- School does not support best work environment for team dynamics
- Social loafing

Conditions for social loafing

- Low task interdependence
- Individual output not visible
- Routine, uninteresting tasks
- Low task significance
- Low collectivist (group) values

Reflect on the school and your role/others' roles in the school.

The Impact of Organizational Dynamics: Task Interdependence

- Where do you as the reflective practitioner, fit into the team?
- What are you reflecting on when you are part of a team?

Task interdependence

What is task interdependence and where is the reflective practitioner in this?

- As teachers we are all dependent on each other for our work.
- You can reflect on how interdependent the team is and your role in supporting this

Team composition

- Effective team members must be willing and able to work in the team.
 - Effective team members are good at the 5 C's:
-

- Cooperating
- Coordinating
- Communicating
- Comforting (psych, support)
- Conflict resolving

Team interdependence depends on:

- Interpersonal knowledge and trust
- Understand roles
- Appropriate behaviors
- Learning to coordinate with each other
- The team and your role within it is a reach area for the reflective practitioner.
- Remember, you may be reflecting on yourself but you work within a context and with others – this also needs reflection.

The Impact of Organizational Dynamics: Behaviour in Organizations

- The behavior of groups/ teams in organizations can become a barrier for the reflective practitioner.
- The mode of thinking that persons engage on when concurrence seeking becomes so dominant in a cohesive group that it tends to override realistic appraisal of alternative courses of action.

Symptoms of “Groupthink”

- An illusion of invulnerability
 - Collective construction of rationalizations that permit group members to ignore
 - Warning or other forms of negative feedback
 - Unquestioning belief in the morality of the group
 - Strong, negative stereotypes views about the leaders of ‘enemy’ groups.
-

- Rapid application of pressure against group members who express even momentary doubts about virtually and illusions the group shares.
- Careful, conscious, personal avoidance of deviation from what appears to be a group consensus.
- Shared illusions of unanimity of opinion.
- Establishment of ‘mind guard’ – people who ‘protect’ the leader and fellow members from adverse information.

Impact of structure on behavior

Each school/organization has structure that:

- Define the unique ways that people are divided
- The behavior of groups/ teams in organizations can become a barrier for the reflective practitioner.
- How specialist roles and functions are coordinated
- How information flows among people and groups
- How the system of controls (task measurement, evaluation, and change) is to work
- Structure is only one of the forces that affect behavior. Others include peer group pressure, group norms, social and technical aspects of work tasks, and internal and external cultures.
- The reflective practitioner is someone who works within organizational structures whilst simultaneously reflecting on those structures.
- The reflective practitioner will reflect on function as well as dysfunction.

The Impact of Organizational Dynamics: Reflecting on Motivation

Reflecting on Motivation

- The Hawthorne experiments demonstrated how work places are predominantly social institutions.
-

- Assumptions about behavior can be self-fulfilling prophecies.
- However, public organizations have difficulty developing coherent philosophies because of conflicting goals and objectives.

Self-Reflecting for Motivation

- In motivation, choice (especially autonomy and control over situations) does not have to be central to reflection.
- Self-regulation requires some degree of choices/ intentional selection of strategies designed to help you achieve a goal.

Self-regulated teachers

- Self-regulated teachers therefore people who are aware of their strengths and weaknesses and this is something the teacher to reflect on.
- Self-regulated teacher is also able to think about the way they are thinking and look at the why they are learning and reflect in a metacognitive sense on their role in the team or in the school strategies: e.g., questioning one's learning and monitoring one's learning, to approach academic tasks.
- Self-regulated teacher also has certain attribute around success or failure, and this affects how much control they feel they have over their work role.

Self-Regulation as a Process

- Self-regulation is a cyclical process. Teachers who are motivated to reach a certain goal will engage in self-regulatory activities they feel will help them achieve that goal.
 - Self-regulation promotes learning, which leads to a perception of greater competence, which sustains motivation toward the goal and to future goals.
-

Dimensions of Self- Regulation

Researchers identify three critical dimensions or characteristics of self-regulation:

- Self-observation
- Self- judgement
- Self- reactions

Self-observation

- Refers to the deliberate monitoring of one's activities. Self observation may take the form of recording frequency, duration or quality of a behaviour.
- Self-observation aims at being very critical to the regulation of performance.
- Self observation may also lead to higher motivation.

For example: If you realize your preparation habits were causing you to perform poorly, you may adjust the way you prepare, leading to higher satisfaction and more motivation to continue to improve your work habits.

Self- judgement

Self- judgement refers to the extent to which you can evaluating one's current performance levels compared to the goal level.

Self- reactions

Self- reaction refers to one's behavioral, cognitive, and affective responses to self-judgments. Self- reactions can be motivating if you believe you are making progress towards your goal.

Models and Mentors: Peer Mentoring

Peer Monitoring

- A shared relationship, involving both giving and receiving.
- It is an equal relationship between two people who value and respect each other and believe each can enrich the other.
- The effectiveness of these relationship is because of unrestricted openness, trust, commitment, sense of responsibility for each other and mutual accountability
- Which is already present in good friendships. It can be developed further when there is an agreement to be more purposeful.
- Unfortunately, this is so readily available, and most effective form of mentoring is overlooked by many or not developed to its full potential.

What is important for the peer mentoring is a professional relationship and not just two friends talking.

- Begins with a friend
- Set aside regular times to be together
- Maximize your times together
- Maintain a balance in your relationship
- Seek to be transparent with each other
- Focus on major areas of concern
- Ask good questions
- Be mutually accountable
- Show mutual respect

The Best Peer Mentoring is Characterized by:

- Honest, two way exchange
-

- Respectful debate on differencing views
- Critical assessment of ideas
- A leveling of the power gradient
- Mutual and unconditional acceptance
- Respect for limits and boundaries

Benefits of Peer Mentoring

- Creates sense of belonging and support
- Contributes to work success
- Contributes to relationships/networking
- Contributes to sense of community
- Contributes to culture of success
- Builds awareness of resources

What does a Research say about Peer Mentoring?

Ferrari (2002)

- Improved academic performance
- Improved academic self-efficacy
- Improved satisfaction with academic programs

Brown, David and McClendon (1999)

- Ability to make a career choice and increased persistence to achieve goals
-

It also has been shown that peer mentoring helps people develop sense of autonomy in terms of choice and this leads to increased persistence to achieve goals (Brown, David and McClendon, 1999).

Sosik and Godshalk (2005)

- Improved interpersonal communications
- Improved psychosocial support

Making Good Use of Your Peer- Mentor

The Roles of the Mentor are to:

- Listen to the reflective practitioner
- Share experiences and understanding about practice
- Work together to mutually develop skill for teaching and working in school building
- Work together to develop network around the school environment
- Be one of many influences.

Reflective Practitioner Roles

- Active participant
- Retain critical faculties
- Seek new capacities, not just knowledge
- Remain open to multiple influences
- Own responsibility for success

Models and Mentors: Mentoring Skills**Mentoring Skills**

A mentor is important for a reflective practitioner because:

- Helps provide professional development
- Demonstrates the employer's recognition of knowledge, skills and abilities of the mentee.
- Usually helps to advance career more quickly
- Increases confidence
- Develops creative and independent thinking
- Helps acclimatize a new staff member to his or her job and school culture more quickly
- Helps teachers feel more in touch socially and professionally
- Results in a greater awareness of organizational politics and culture
- Provides an appreciation and effective use of networking
- Develops proactive approaches to tasks and projects
- Movement toward "expert" status

What Can You Expect from a Mentor?

- In the role of coach, a partnership with an colleague is developed in order to strengthen and expand the reflective practitioner's skills in specific areas of job performance.
 - *Trust*- the glue of all relationships. When we work in a climate of trust, we know that we can predict the positive actions and attitudes of another person.
 - We know that she/he cares about us and support our efforts.
 - *Feedback*- positive recognition of a job well done or the constructive criticism of a skill or task which could use improvement.
 - *Learning* about desired behaviors- the actions or skills that provide the most effective completion of a task.
 - Learning about replacement behaviours- new behaviours to replace ineffective or inappropriate behaviours.
-

What to Expect from Constructive Criticism?

- Is specific and focused on the behaviour, not the person.
- Describes the significance of behaviours for the team or team goals.
- Remains calm
- Listen to your perspective of the behavior and/or situation.
- Identifies the benefits of improving the behaviour.
- Balances positive and negative feedback.

Models and Mentors

- The hierarchy gap (“speaking truth to power”)
- Political correctness (over compensating)
- Same words/ different meanings
- Avoid exploring own feelings, attitudes and values
- Problem denial

Clarity of Purpose vs Rapport



Models and Mentors: The Skills of Dialogue

The Skills of Dialogue

- Managing stereotypes
- Permission to explore
- Fearless questions
- Analyzing assumptions, behaviors and values
- Achieving clarity
- Valuing the insights from different perspectives

Four Key Issues Relating to Difference in Mentoring

There are 4 key issues relating to difference in mentoring which will impact on the level of dialogue and the quality of dialogue between mentor and reflective practitioner. These four issues are:

- **Perspective:** the ability to realistically look the environment
- **Networking:** ability to make connections between the individuals may be departments within the organizations.
- **Power:** sense of power between the mentor and reflective practitioner there should be an equal relationship and one person is more powerful.
- **Dependency:** mentoring relationship is very supportive, but it must be clear that the reflective practitioner should not become dependent on the mentor for that work.

How the Reflective Practitioner Views Differ in Mentoring?

Issue	Same group	Different group
Perspective	More empathy	Wider perspective
Career	Less likely	More likely
Network	Sharing same concerns	More influential
Power	Easier rapport	Insight into politics
Role modeling	Occurs more naturally	Promote wider range of responses.

The Value of Difference in the Mentoring Relationship

- Encourages RP to set and work towards ambitious career goals, increasing their confidence.
-

- Provides RP with visibility and influence and senior levels and with insight into management thinking and organizational politics
- Encourages RP to recognize their value and enhance their self confidence
- Stimulates more effective and wider networking.

Your Mentor Should:

- Establish confidence by beginning with work- related issues.
- Identify common interests and values
- Make efforts to learn about each other
- Show empathy
- Be clear about needs and expectations
- Avoid stereotypes and untested assumptions
- Provide ‘risked discomfort’ to make the relationship work

Areas of Dialogue for the Reflective Practitioner and the Mentor

- Universalism v particularism
- Individualism v communitarianism
- Affective vs neutral
- Specific vs diffuse
- Achievement v ascription
- Sequential v synchronous
- Internal v external control

Reflective practitioner and the mentor have the certain areas of dialogue to consider:

- In terms of content the dialogue between the reflective practitioner and the mentor it can focused on very general/ universal aspects of working in an organizational setting or it could be focused a particular minute area of practice.
- It could also be related to the individual is settling working in group environment or it could be focused on team community within a school.
- The dialogue can also be quite neutral in terms of description, explanation, and analysis but it also focused on emotion, feelings, and reactions. The dialogue goes on between reflective practitioner and the mentor can be very specific or can be quite nebulous, diffuse, and varied in terms of ground covered.
- It focused on achievements or ascribing standards to the work that the individual is doing.
- The dialogue can be on going its synchronous with the work of reflective practitioner it could be in response to after an event, in other words sequential to the work of reflective practitioner.
 - In terms of control dialogue can go between internal control in other words autonomy of reflective practitioner as well as external control or in other words control by the school or by line manager so the dialogue between the reflective practitioner and the manager can vary between extremes in whatever area the two are looking at.

Models and Mentors: Situated Learning

Situation Learning

- Seeing to integrate formal and work place learning
- ‘Learning to teach’ and ‘teach to learn’ (Loughran, 2006).

Learning and development for the reflective practitioner does not happen in isolation and there is a notion around modeling and mentoring in school where learning is situated. This is in a sense looking at formal integration of learning from the workplace. We can think of it as ‘learning to teach’ and ‘teaching to learn’ (Loughran, 2006).

- Student as teacher and learner (think critically, question practice and explore new principles) (Taylor, 2008).

Teacher is not only teacher but also a learner and as such learning to think critically, question practice and to explore new principles (Taylor, 2008).

- ‘Transfer of Learning’ an inadequate metaphor
- ‘Becoming’ -within a transitional process of boundary-crossing (Heger & Hodkinson, 2009).

The Reflective practitioner and Situated Learning

There are certain stages that considered about situated learning that support reflective practitioner.

Stage 1: Implicit modeling of strategies and values at this point the individual is practicing and behaving certain ways and through their behavior expressing values which are reflective in an organization.

Stage 2: Explicit modeling of reflective learning and change in practice.

Stage 3:

- Linking practical wisdom to abstract theory

Stage 4:

- Reconstruction by teachers in the classroom

Reflective Practitioner as teacher and learner

Situated learning focuses in a holistic way on teacher learning-enabling teachers to think critically and originally about the work they are engaging in, question existing practices and exploring new principles -this has resonance with Loughran’s learning to teach and teaching to learn. We can look at this as a powerful tool for the reflective practitioner.

Models and Mentors: Social Learning Theory: Elements of Social Cognitive Theory

Elements of Social Cognitive Theory

- Social learning theory influences the mentoring relationship and the process of reflective practice in an educational environment.

Social learning distinguishes between the acquisition of knowledge (learning) and the observable performance based on that knowledge or (behavior).

- Both internal and external factors are important because they are interacting in the process of learning for the reflective practitioner.
- There is an idea of reciprocal determinism. An explanation of behavior that emphasizes the mutual effects of the individual and the environment on each other. In this sense the distinction between enactive and vicarious learning.
- Enacting learning is learning by doing and experiencing the consequences of your action.

Consequences are seen as providing information about appropriate actions, creating expectations, and influencing motivation.

Distinction between enactive and vicarious learning

- Vicarious learning is learning by observing others. Emphasises the powerful effect that modeling learning and imitation can have on learning.

The emphasis is on other's modeling, behaviors and attitudes and therefore the reflective practitioner imitating those behaviors and those values and learning occurs through this imitation.

Learning by Observing Others

Two main modes of observational learning for vicarious approach are:

- First, observational learning can take place through vicarious reinforcement.

vicarious reinforcement is important because it happens automatically.

- Second imitates the behavior of a model even though the model receives no reinforcement or punishment while the observer is watching.

The second notion is that learning by observing others imitates particular models (behavioral models) even though the models receive no reinforcement. Just by watching we learn and we can take on particular behavior.

Second, learning by observing others imitates the behavioral model that even receives no reinforcement or punishment while the observer is watching.

- Observation can be a very efficient learning process.

The other aspect of observational learning is that observation can be a very efficient learning process there is no effort in terms of having right it just understanding and observing.

- Social cognitive theory distinguishes between acquisition and performance of learning.

Four important elements to be considered in Observational Learning

- **Attention**-pays in watching a role model
- **Retention**-understanding and learning from that observation
- **Production**-individual putting in practice what has be learned
- **Motivation and Reinforcement**- reflective practitioner uses his observations to motivate themselves and to reinforce new behaviors.

Observational Learning for reflective practitioner has five possible outcomes.

1. **Teaching new behaviors.**

- It teaches new behavior. Modeling can deliberately be applied to practice once it been explored. And this can be very powerful for the reflective practitioner.

2. **Encouraging already-learned behaviors.**

If you can see another teacher already doing the same things that you so that reinforces, encourages the behavior you engage with.

3. **Strengthening or weakening inhibitions. The ripple effect.**

4. **Direct attention**

5. **Arousing emotions.**

In OL you may develop emotional reactions to situations you have never personally experienced.

The Dialogic Process in RP: Dialogue as a Self-Assessment Tool

Dialogue as a Self- Assessment Tool

To assess knowledge

To assess practice

To evidence reflection on practice

To assess professional learning

We have seen that reflective practice can be a dialogic and as such dialogue process and as such dialogue can be self-assessment tool for the reflective practitioner. It is useful assessing knowledge as well as practice but in terms of evidencing reflection and development for reflective practitioner.

Characteristic elements of dialogue for reflection

Trust: empathy, honesty, sincerity, openness, learning, self-awareness, growth, mutual responsibility, listen, challenge, interrogation, inquiry exploration, reflection and critique, shared knowledge, process, multiple levels of communication.

There are some critical elements to the dialogic process in terms of reflection and these aspects of trust; empathy; understanding and openness to learning and in terms of reflection taking responsibility and challenge to develop.

It involves exploration as well as critique of experience and is a process of communication at many different levels from a very descriptive level through to an analytical and evaluative level.

Defining Dialogue Reflection

- Conversation with a purpose
- It has to involve moving forward
- Learning should emerge for all
- Care should be given to the different purposes of dialogue

What we need to do then for the reflective practitioner is trying to define what would be included in terms of dialogue for reflection it is indeed conversation with a purpose it is not just general conversation, and it involves the reflective practitioner in moving forward professionally. It is learning which should emerge over time dialogue helps learning develop rather than just become instantaneous and therefore the reflective practitioner needs to take care in terms of the professional dialogues that takes place.

- There is an inherent power differentiated due to the different roles

There is of course an inherent power differential in any dialogue that a reflective practitioner engages with and this power differential can be quite useful but needs to be fully understood by the reflective practitioner.

- Assessment involves: quality of dialogue, evidence of understanding
 - Process verses product, exposing of the process
-

- Assessment for learning

And there is an understanding that there for the reflective practitioner should access the quality of the dialogue that is being engaged within the evidence of the understanding that's growing from that and as a tool for the reflective practitioner to use. It is about process as product it's as much about learning evolving over time from engaging in dialogue rather than just outcomes of the dialogue.

- A shared purpose
- Genuine questions to seek unknown answers

Dialogue has a shared purpose it's not just one way it is a two-way street and there are genuine questions which are based in experience and develop the reflective practitioner to higher level of performance.

- Formative for the participant (backwards and forwards)
- Power relationship is two-way

For the reflective practitioner it is formative in the sense that dialogue can move backwards as well as forwards reflecting on previous experiences as well as looking towards the future and the power relationship the two-way power relationship enables this backward and forwards movement as part of the learning process.

- Consideration of influence of assessment criteria/ learning outcomes
- Dialogue is about learning evolving
- Assessment is about summative element

Consider that criteria especially assessment criteria learning outcomes for teachers may have on the dialogic process they may influence or guide the dialogue, and this affects the quality of the dialogue and can be beneficial to reflective practitioner.

- Dialogue involves complex interaction, compare with monologue
-

- Mutuality, turn taking
- Different expectations can be an issue

The dialogue is quite complex and involves complex interaction with another. There are not only needs to be speaking but also listening. Effective dialogue in terms of professional conversation engages in turn taking a mutuality in terms of sharing information and working with understanding and there of course is based on different expectations and intensions for the dialogue.

- Notion of process is critical
- Emphasis is on growth
- Would students know when dialogue is in process?

Reminder: Dialogue as a Self-Assessment Tool

The Dialogue Process in RP

Reminder: Dialogue as a self-assessment tool

- To assess knowledge
 - To assess practice
 - To evidence reflection on practice
 - To assess professional learning
-

The Educational Environment	
Written Reflection	Dialogic Reflection
Static, superficial, write to order	Multi-layered Flexible
Writing reflectively	Easier to reflect
Emergence of values	Engagement easier to show and explore
Word limit	Opportunity to probe, question
Limited opportunity to probe, question, explore	Depth of learning
Evidence all present	Natural when talking about self and practice
	May need back-up evidence

The Outcomes of Dialogic Reflection

The outcomes of dialogic reflection include:

- Assessment of informal professional learning

An assessment of informal learning which is engaged within the school environment and from experiences in the classroom.

- Creation of a learning space

It is useful because it creates a space for learning between individuals and regularity in terms of reflection and therefore learning and because it is a process of interacting with others.

- Re-profiling ideas of a teaching professional
- Reconfiguring teaching and learning

It is a way of revision approve and professional roles and refiguring notions about teaching and learning.

- A career development and CPD tool
-

Dialogic process is very useful as a professional development tool and a career management tool for individual teacher.

- Means of organizational change

It is a process of sharing and working with others and it is useful means for an organizational change and development.

Asynchronous Discussion-The Theory

- Content based (theory oriented): Asynchronous discussion (AD) allows teachers to have more time to reflect on and produce their contributions.

The dialogic process for reflective practice can be asynchronous. Asynchronous dialogue occurs sometime after experience and between experiences. Asynchronous discussion tends to be very theory oriented and allows teachers to have time to reflect and to produce their collaboration and contributions with others.

- AD enables teachers to develop higher order thinking skills (e.g. to gather, apply, analyze, synthesize and evaluate information).

Asynchronous discussion enables teachers because of the time to think and reflect and to be critical to develop higher order thinking skills for the evaluation and synthesis and creation and these add to the reflective practitioner our bags of skill.

- AD allows students to conceptualize a topic/issue/theory from multiple viewpoint.

Asynchronous discussion allows the reflective practitioner to conceptualize ideas and issues and theories from different viewpoints to understand different perspectives in things.

- Asynchronous discussion promotes collaborative learning – the act of collaboration is an act of shared creation and /or shared discovery (Schrage,1995).

Theoretical Framework

Vygotsky's sociocultural learning theory

Learners' experiences at the sociocultural level (i-e; experiences communicated and shared with a community of professionals) and this essential for the internalization of knowledge. There is a constant interplay between social processes and individual cognitive development.

Dewey's experience-based learning theory

Experience is shared and reconstructed through reflection. Reflection is the heart of the knowledge-constructing process. A reflective practice is framed by a perplexing and confused experience initially and a unified or reserved situation at the end. In this sense it is very much about integrating deliberation and action.

Halliday's social-semiotic perspective on learning

Language simultaneously performs three macro-functions: ideational (experiential), interpersonal and textual functions in terms of how people are interacting. Language's use is a socially shaped and shaping action but also shaping our experience and there is an interplay between language and dialogue.

Asynchronous Discussion- The Practice

- Asynchronous dialogue needs to be designed
- Designed by the other (mentor) asking the teacher to reflect on how the theories they have learned about teaching.

Asynchronous discussion as a process of dialogic reflection needs to be designed it does not happen instantaneously and it can be designed by some other individual perhaps a mentor rather the reflective practitioner. It is very much about asking teacher to reflect on how the theories they have learned about teaching is being understood and explode/ applied in different situation.

- Asynchronous discussion (dialogue) occurs over time rather than spontaneously providing time for thinning about events.
 - Can be via email/text
-

- Care needs to ensure that the level of interaction remains high.
- Monologic discourse compared to dialogic discourse.

Asynchronous discussion (dialogue) between people dialoging occurs over time rather than spontaneously, providing time for thinking about events. It can occur via email/text of course and this remains high for asynchronous discussion because their time lag is involved in that written exchange, but care needs to be taken by the reflective practitioner that the dialogue remains as a dialogue and not a monologue they should be a two-way exchange of information and understanding.

Interpersonal discourse:

It is about showing/giving admirations, understanding, compliments, supports, encouragement, appreciation, eager for success, consoling people about difficulties and finding solutions, agreements, offering suggestions, clarifications, invitations for more discussion.

Asynchronous discussion is a process of questioning but engaging symbol tenuously, expressive, but responsive, skeptical but respectful and challenging but supportive.

- The other may need to model or explicitly “teach” desired discourse used in asynchronous discussions.

Fabro and Garrison (1998) revealed the established presence of a ‘significant other’ in dialogic discourse.

Dialogic Diaries

- Dialogic diaries are a type of reflective journal in which teachers (reflective practitioners) reflect on their learning and a ‘significant other’ writes a response.
- The diary process regularly between the two.

Stage 1: Uncertainty- At the initial stage of writing a journal is uncertainty. At this point reflective practitioner is engaging in maintaining a dialogic diary. There is uncertainty about what to write and how to write it the quality of that writing is good enough for reflection. It helps individual develop their practices through reflection and then this moves us to another stage the process which is about enthusiasm.

Stage 2: Enthusiasm –Once the level of uncertainty has been overcome the reflective practitioner can find that writing in a journal and sharing the journal with another who also writes in it responds to those reflections become quite an engaging process and can develop a lot of enthusiasm by the reflective practitioner.

Stage 3: Lack of Enthusiasm- Once the dialogic diary has been engaged with for some time it becomes a little bit habitual and therefore it can lead to a sense of apathy or lack of enthusiasm for maintaining the writing and indeed at this point journal writing for the reflective practitioner could just become things like simple words rather than reflective and explorative sentences and paragraphs however if this stage is overcome it does become a habit and learning can develop very easily very quickly from that habit.

Stage 4: Habit and Learning- This requires motivation and for reflective practitioner its worth at this point mentioning being aware of this and mentioning this to the significant other. It is quite a powerful tool because learning can be ongoing, and the process can continue because the habit is there to maintain it.

There are certain issues with the dialogic diary process which we become aware of in terms of maintaining a diary:

Time:

- For teachers to write the diaries?
- For 'the other' to respond?
- For the diary writing process to continue?

Time is needed for the individual to write in the diary and significant other to respond to reflections in the diary. And needed for the diary writing process to continue long-term. This is a very significant factor because over the long term of lack of enthusiasm can take hold and therefore diary writing starts becoming unproductive.

- Writing:
 - Writing v. Drawing
 - Blogosphere?
-

It could be via the internet or maintaining a blog and teachers interacting with each other; the blogosphere and of course it does not have to be about illustrations and drawings.

Ethics:

- The ethics of 'diary writing'

Shared writings we are discussing issues may be delicate or sensitive we must be aware of the ethics of putting this into permanent form.

- Political process (writing about roles)

Writing reflections is a political process in the sense it does raise questions about roles and responsibility that we have in the classroom and in the school.

The Dialogic Process in RP: The Academic Portfolio**The Academic Portfolio**

- A fundamental feature of the (self-evaluative) academic portfolio is the intentional focus on learning and assessment.

The academic portfolio can also be used for engaging with the dialogic process. It is self-evaluative mechanism which has an internal focus for the reflective practitioner focusing on learning and assessment.

- The deliberate and systematic attention not only to teaching but also action research skills.

Therefore, it is very deliberate and systematic attention not only to but also action research skills in terms of reflecting on experiences in the classroom.

- A fundamental feature of the (self-evaluative) academic portfolio is the intentional focus on learning and assessment.
-

This focus is very different to things like dialogic writing the academic portfolio is an evolving collection of experiences and experiments over time.

- To a teacher's self-reflective, meta cognitive appraisal of how and more importantly why learning and teaching.

It is very much about the teacher's self-reflective, metacognitive stance on their stance appraisal of how and more importantly, why learning and teaching from their experiences.

Benefits of the Academic Portfolio for Dialogic Reflection

Increased understanding of

- How you learn and what are your learning outcomes.
- What you have and have not learned)

There is an increased understanding of how we are learning and what are our learning outcomes from reflection. Also, about what we are not learning.

- What do you value?
- Role in learning how to articulate in writing one's thoughts and ideas.

With increased understanding we can explore what aspects of our work and our professional role we do value. The role in learning how to articulate in writing those values and our understanding of those values.

- How others view your work?

Another benefit of the academic portfolio there is an increased understanding of how others view the work that we do what their ideas are about our professional role.

Enhanced ability to make corrections.

- Among courses thought and in the context of teaching 'without boundaries'.
 - Among research experiences and research collaborations.
-

- Increased sense of learning over time.

What to include in the Academic Portfolio?

- Documentation of steps (analogous to keeping a log for lab research)
- Commentaries (as for solutions for math problems)
- Evolution of a course, of a speech, or of a paper.
- “History” of a piece of artwork.

It also evolves over time like a speech on paper and there is a history to it you will be able to look back months and see progression of your learning and the journey that you have been on.

Four Basic Processes for the Creation of an Academic Portfolio:

What we need to consider then is their certain processes involved in constructing an academic portfolio.

- **Collection:** Firstly, we must consider what we are collecting in terms of material to include should enable us to explore and to reflect not just inclusions for the sake of putting them in academic portfolio.
- **Select:** we need to select those materials quite carefully because part of creating of portfolio is to consider who will read it and who will benefit from it and purposes for which they will be reading.
- **Reflection:** we need to understand that the academic portfolio is a tool for reflection and therefore we need to make sure that the inclusions are there to help us learn until develop our teaching and we are simply part of research of experience that we engage with.
- **Connections:** Finally, the academic portfolio a mechanism that contains materials that enable us to make connections between different aspects of our professional role.

A Document that Evolves Over Time

- Remember: the portfolio is a living collection of documents and materials which change overtime.
- New items are added, others are dropped.

Teachers Collaborating

Every teacher is an active participant in their reflective practice and there are definite benefits from collaborating with others in a process of continuous learning and we can see that continuous learning through teacher collaboration actually forms part of a cycle focused on particular aspects within the process of observation and we can see that step-3 of this 5-step cycle. It is about observing and collecting of evidence and this is the key point where teachers collaborating come together. It's at this point where evidence is collected of processes and practices where observation is used as a means for that collection, and it continues until the end of the cycle as part of the process of reflection and evaluation.

Principles of brief

There are certain **principles of brief** that we need to consider in terms of collaborative observation as process for reflective practice and these are that **observations** must be frequent so that learning is always **ongoing**. They must be **focused** on aspects of practice rather than just general observational. They must be **varied** as well as so that they do not fall into a habitual process. They must include **useful and timely feedback**.

Collecting Evidence through Observation

What can happen in observation is that we take notes as reflective practitioner and focus on particular aspects of the teaching using a quick shorthand to explain or define aspects of our observation and it's through this shorthand that we get focus through the writing on things that we need to consider.

Here the RP has been used abbreviations such as: T for teacher, S for student, FFL for focus for learning, LD for lesson delivery, as well as time stamps at the bottom.

Getting Feedback from others on Observation:

Focused: helps focus attention on the content of that paraphrasing so teachers collaborating is a means for the reflective practitioner to get feedback.

Evidence-based: It is important that feedback is focused on aspect of the observation it also needs to be evidence-based. It should be grounded in what has been observed in the evidence for that.

Constructive: Feedback should reinforce effective practice and identify areas for continued growth.

Timely: feedback should be provided shortly after the observation so the connections can be made with the information from the feedback process and the activity in the classroom.

Collaborative Observation and Feedback: Peer Observation

Peer observation

There are number of benefits to the reflective practitioner of using peer observation:

- ✦ Peer observation helps the individual maintain and enhance teaching quality and therefore improving the quality of students learning experiences.
 - ✦ It is a process of building awareness for an individual about variety of practices that they can be using in the classroom.
 - ✦ It is a way of reflecting on the various aspects of their approach and their teaching practice that they are aiming to master.
 - ✦ It recognizes and identifying good practice in relation to others.
 - ✦ It is reflective of development needs for an individual practitioner's
 - ✦ It as a process provides evidence of quality teaching practice for promotion applications.
-

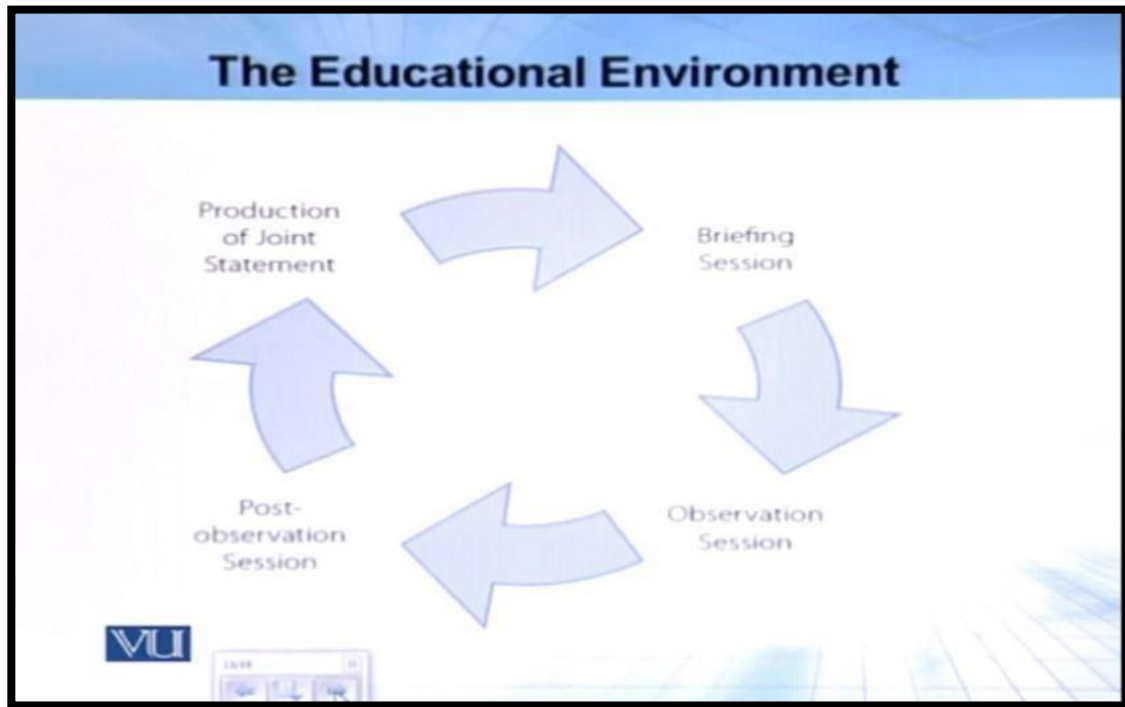
- ✦ As a means for development, it identifying and promotes good practice and innovation in teaching and learning.
- ✦ In this way it can help reflective practitioner deepening understanding of the work of colleague in and across teams, departments, and faculties.
- ✦ Because peer observation involves our colleagues in the process reflection then it is good opportunity for networking and developing connection with colleagues to discuss various learning and teaching issues.
- ✦ Increasing the sense of collaboration and enhanced trust through allowing colleagues that we have in schools **in order** to help build the practice that we have the ability to observe and comment on other people's teaching becomes very powerful here.

The Process of Peer Observation

For the Reflective practitioner process has four main stages:

Briefing session before observation where a focus is given to the observation then the **observation** followed by post observation. In **post observation** there is reflection and feedback from the observer and then there needs to some recording of the observer.

We look at reflective cycle where the briefing session occurs before observation which leads ultimately through a statement a record observation which can lead then into another pre-observation session in terms of development. This becomes very useful very simple approach to peer observation linking it to reflective practice.



Briefing session: the reflective practice being observed will set out the context of the observation and draw the observer's attention to anything that they particularly want comment on.

Post-Observation session: this is a collaboration reflection (practitioner and observer) and will involve appraisal of the session by the teacher who was observed and comments from the observer

Collaborative Observation and Feedback: Peer Observation

Peer Observation

There are four key focus areas for peer observation:

- Planning/Organization/ content
 - Teaching Strategies/resources
-

- Presentation/management
- Assessment/monitoring

Planning/Organization/ content

- Focuses on the teaching purposes are clear and stated in appropriate term, such as aims, objectives and outcomes.
- Teaching purposes are appropriate to the needs, experience, and abilities of students.
- In terms of observing their planning and content it would be good for observer to look at how the lesson is structured in term of introduction and content development of ideas and learning how the lesson is concluded and evaluated.
- Content is appropriate for the levels, abilities, needs and interests of students.
- Content is well researched and up to date.

Teaching Strategies/resources

- Observer is checking that the methods are appropriate to purposes of session.
 - Methods are chosen about students' abilities, needs and needs of students.
 - Methods are chosen to gain interest and participation.
-

- Class management is effective and appropriate in terms of the number of people in the classroom and the activities they are engaging with.
- Resources are used effectively and complement content, methods, and purposes they support clearly the aims and outcomes.

Presentation/management

- Observer is looking for things like effective communication skills and presentations of ideas and concept
- Individual teacher is questioning students and asking effective questioning to monitor and promote understanding.
- Student contributions and participation are encouraged in a conducive atmosphere.

Assessment/monitoring

- The observer wants to see that individual teacher is monitoring learning throughout the individual lesson and also looking at a suitable method are used to identify and monitor students' progress.
- Part of this aspect of teaching of course is about the teacher continual use of feedback to the students in a constructive way so this enhances learning.

Collaborative Observation and Feedback: Peer Observation

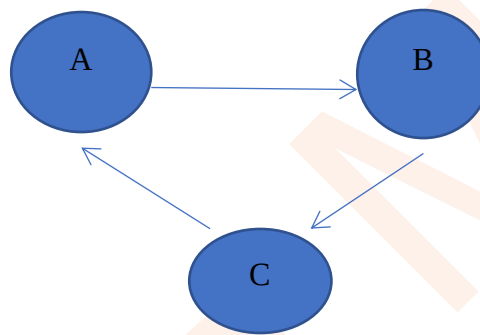
Peer Observation

The process of peer observation of teaching (POT) can be undertaken in several different ways:

Buddy System

We can consider it does not just have to be with two people it can be with more, but with two people involved in this process of observation it is important to agree to act as observer **and the one being observed** and share these two roles.

Circus



We can also consider observation in terms of several people observing for example there could be three teachers three reflective practitioner engage in the process of observing each other and we can call this appear observation circus this is where colleague A would observe colleague B , colleague B would observe colleague C and colleague C would observe colleague A, and this can go around the group continually and can be in reverse order so that all participant observed each other. It not only builds a sense of team work, but it does mean that an individual gets observed by two different practitioner and more practitioners involved in a peer observation circle you can get more feedback perspectives.

When you are the observer:

- You need to make sure that you discuss all aspects of the activity with the person being observed and ensure that feedback is structured around this and provides the sense of exploration that the observer needs.
-

- It should be very efficient and not be too time consuming and should be very clear in terms of instructional value.
- During observation don't be distracted by the content if you are there to observe teaching strategies, for example, it could be looking at teaching strategies and rather than resources.
- You should also allow the one being debriefed to say something about the observation before you give your feedback.
- Focus comment on the behavior not the person in the classroom rather than products.
- In terms of feedback, it is very important that the observer follows a very simple strategy and that it should be clear and owned, balanced, brief, and specific.
- The important thing to remember is for you as an observer to give feedback as soon as possible after the observation otherwise any feedback you give can lose its sense of urgency it makes it very difficult for the observer to make connections between what is your experience and their experience in the classroom.
- What you want to do in term of giving feedback is to priorities your comments. Focus first on what is most important and then work down from there to what is not so important, and this gives much better focus to the feedback from the observation.

Collaborative Observation and Feedback: What is Lesson Study?

What is Lesson Study?

Lesson study is another collaborative observation technique that the reflective practitioner can use. Lesson study is a professional development process that Japanese teachers engage in to systematically examine their practice.

The goal of lesson study is to improve the effectiveness of the experiences that the teachers provide to their students.

The core activity in lesson study is for teachers to collaboratively work on a small number of

“study lesson”. These lessons are called “study” lessons because they are used by the group to examine the teachers’ practice.

Working on a Study Lesson

1: Research and preparation: The group of teachers jointly draw up a detailed plan for the study lesson. The lesson plan is not constructed by an individual but by the group.

2: Implementation: A teacher teaches the study lesson in a real classroom while other group members look on.

3: Reflection and improvement: The group after the lesson delivered comes together to discuss their observations of the implementation of that lesson.

4: Second Implementation and reflection: This is optional but after first discussion and reflection phase and the teacher may go back and teach the lesson again or another teacher may teach that lesson.

The Lesson Plan is the Backbone of the Study Lesson

The lesson plan supports the lesson study process by serving as a:

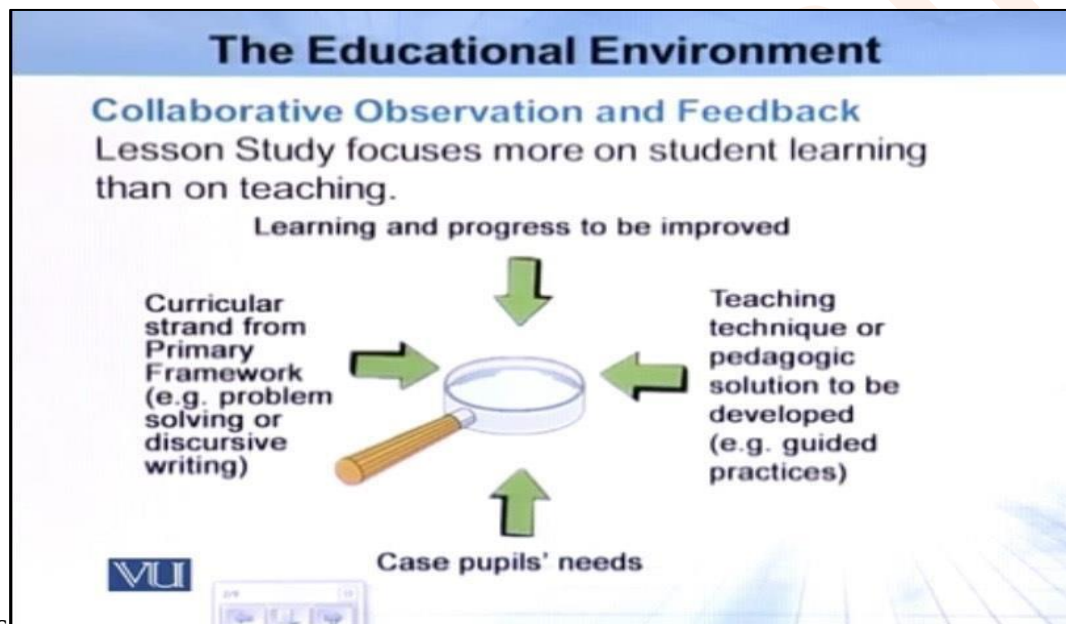
- Teaching tool—it provides a very well define script for the individual teacher to follow in terms of activities and resources used in the lesson.
- Communication tool—it conveys to other members of the group, the thinking of the teacher who planned the lesson.
- Observation tool—it guides what to look for in the lesson; it is a place for the observers to record/share observations.

And so all together this process is very collaborative very systematic and can lead to high levels of reflection and development

Collaborative Observation and Feedback: How do RPs Share Learning form Lesson Study?

How do RPs Share Learning from Lesson Study?

Lesson study is a powerful tool of collaborative observation for the reflective practitioner and what is important to think about is how the reflective practitioner shares what is learned from the lesson study process. There are number of ways for it, it could be very formally through things like **reports and publications** but perhaps it could be more informal through **lesson study open house** or **rotating teachers** through different grade **levels** or just through informal mechanism like **structural supports for teachers** in the school.



What we can do is focus on the passing on of that knowledge by remembering that **lesson study focuses more on student learning** than on teaching. What are the outcomes of teaching and in this sense the lesson study has several imposing factors which is down to do like students' needs as well as the pedagogic approaches used to respond to student's needs?

There is of course a demand from the school in terms of the content that needs to be taught on the timetable that an individual teacher is working to. So, the lesson study is a collaborative process for the teachers focusing on students learning as a center of reflection.

Sharing the outcomes of lesson study can be very formal like in things like:

Reports or publications- what is important to remember is that this type of sharing of knowledge is not just about including materials or lesson plans but there needs to be some sort of reflection there are of the discussions around the construction of those lessons plan. The motivations and the goals behind those on the intended achievements even challenges that were expected **behind each lesson study process.**

Outside observer- It can be useful for the lesson study group to use an outside observer. There are three basic benefits to using an outside observer:

1: an individual can give a different perspective when reacting to the lesson study.

2: an outside observer can provide **additional** information about content/new ideas.

3: observer share the work of other lesson study groups.

Open House- In Japan they use something called open house this is where individual teachers can share their lesson study work with other schools. **So that good practices share around the system.**

Rotation of Teachers- Teachers can be rotated through grades levels within their schools. **It help people understanding the issues that the group is experiencing.**

Structural Supports for Teachers- There can be structural support in the school itself teachers in terms of sharing the learning from lesser study.

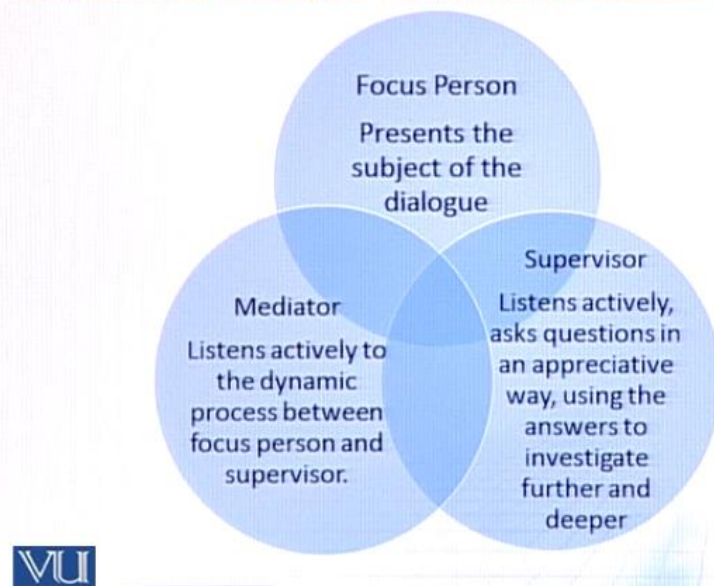
Collaborative Observation and Feedback: Group and Peer Supervision

Group and Peer Supervision

What we need to consider are **roles and approaches** to supervision **as part of collaborative supervision.** Within collaborative observation there is a **focus person** the reflective practitioner and a **mediator** and **supervisor.**

Looking at these three roles and how they combine the focus person is the subject of the dialogue essentially, they provide the subject of discussion within the group.

Collaborative Observation and Feedback



The supervisor is the individual who listens actively to the dialogue, ask questions in an appropriate way to build confidence and selfesteem and supports the individual, using questions to investigate further and deeper in terms of their experiences.

The mediator is one who listen actively to the dynamic process between the focus person and supervisor and work to support the process of dialogue.

The Roles

There are particular roles which each individual in the process of collaboration take on:

Focus person: Clearly defines theme and subject of the dialogue.

Supervisor: Is the individual who asks questions about what has been seen and heard in an investigative, exploratory, and appreciative way.

Mediator: is the individual that keeps a check on the dialogue and gives feedback on the process of the dialogue, its structure and depth to the focal person. Mediator listens carefully and then sums up the content and the process of the dialogue between the two.

We can see that the three together make a reflecting team. The reflecting team is made up of the mediator the supervisor and the focus person working together regularly over time.

The Role of Reflecting Team

- The role of the reflecting team is about listening to the dialogue without interrupting so that full understanding can be required.
- Reflecting team take notes on the dialogue to record the content and to give a focus to the individual concerns.
- And notes will also help the reflecting team finds connections between experiences and to understand the associations between different aspects of the process.
- The reflecting team will discuss what they have seen in a very non judgmental way and supervisor can make suggestion on proposed questions to help the focal person understand better the experience and get more clarity about how to move forward.

Group and peer Supervisor: The Rules

There are rules that should be followed:

- The roles within the group need to be very clearly defined theme structured by the focus person.
 - The approach should be very appreciative of the focus person rather than constructive.
 - The feedback needs to be clear and precise.
 - Supervisor should engage in useful questioning technique which help to develop depth and detailed.
-

- The whole process should be about building confidence for the individual.

Constructive Feedback

- ✦ For the reflecting team constructive feedback should be respectful to the focus person and acknowledge the insights of others reflecting team, their values, opinions and their ideas.
- ✦ Show understanding and recognition of the other's feelings and views within the group.
- ✦ Help all members of the team but particularly the focal person to be better understanding, strength, weaknesses, and potentials that they have.

Questioning technique is an important part of group supervision and its important that open question are used as these promote examination and exploration for example question like can you give me more details about? And questions to make the other elaborate and argue; like why use this activity...? Why did you do this thing...? this get the focal person to really think critically about what they have done and questions by the supervisor should also challenge the focus person; like What did/do you intend the students to learn?

Questions can also be used to **Direct** (which resource are to be used in this activity?) attention to particular area of the lesson but **In Direct** (how do you think the students will interpret the result?) also to get the focal person to reflect on other person expectations and experience.

Using close questions as part of the reflecting team for validation and interpretation so for example supervisor could say something like Is it correct when I understand this particular thing? because the answer is yes or no and that's provide clarity in terms of reflection.

Supervisor can ask particular probing questions (what exactly?) and funnel questions can make the other focus.

Developing Dialogues

The process of collaborative observation where there is a focus person, and a supervisor has a number of dimensions to, it can be used to inform the group to particular aspect of practice and of course, it can be used to influence practice or the focus person and there can be very linear assumptions about the practices which are being employed as well as circular assumptions or in other words the ability to look back and then to change practice from what has been going on.

So, there are particular roles to be taken on within the process of collaborative observation for example the focus person and supervisor can see themselves as detectives focusing on facts and looking for future understanding can be as an advisor looking for solution in relations to issues and problems. It can be about just exploring , understandings and getting much better appreciation, or it can be about looking better perspective from different viewpoints facilitating understanding.

The Rules:

The rules which need to be follow are very precise but the supervision of a focus person as part of collaborative observation is a very useful technique for reflection on practice.

- A clearly defined theme
- Appreciative approach
- Clear feedback
- Questioning technique
- Confidence

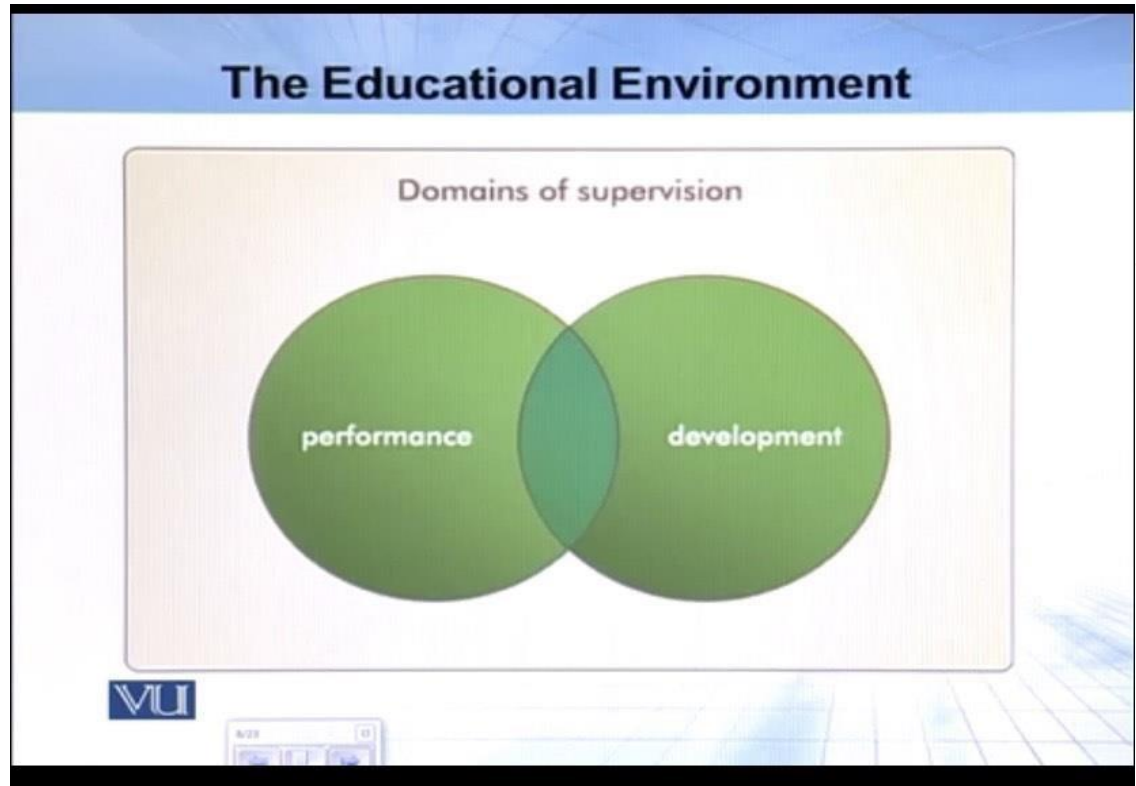
Collaborative Observation and Feedback: Supervision: What Is It?

Supervision: what is it?

Supervision in education is made up of collaborative observation and feedback and both of these aspects are important and relevant to varying degree in supervision, depending on the context in which they are conducted. It can be helpful to think about supervision both in terms of development (which related to ongoing professional learning) and performance (which is related to clinical governance and standard setting.) of and individual in an organization.

Domains of Supervision

We can look at this diagram as domains of supervision in terms of performance and development think about some different context in which supervision can occur in school, it could be through things like; peer supervision, team teaching, multidisciplinary team meetings. Therefore, it's worth considering in which part of the diagram these supervisory conversation can take place, are they taking place in performance domain or are they taking place in development domain? Although many aspects of supervision are common across all context, in the critical setting it is useful to tease out some of the specific aspects of reflection and teaching; not least because there is an emerging distinction being made in education between the two closely related and overlapping activities of critical and educational supervision.



So, in which part of the diagram do these supervisory conversations take place? Because in this diagram it is very useful to **understand this as much as possible** and these domains interact with one another performance and development, so they are interlocking characteristics of the domain.

Principles of supervision

- Be clear about why there is a need for supervision and who has asked for it.
 - Set a time frame for the supervision session; even a few minutes of focused time can be worthwhile.
 - Protect the time and space where possible and appropriate; try to ensure there will be no interruptions and that there is privacy.
 - Ensure that there is confidentiality.
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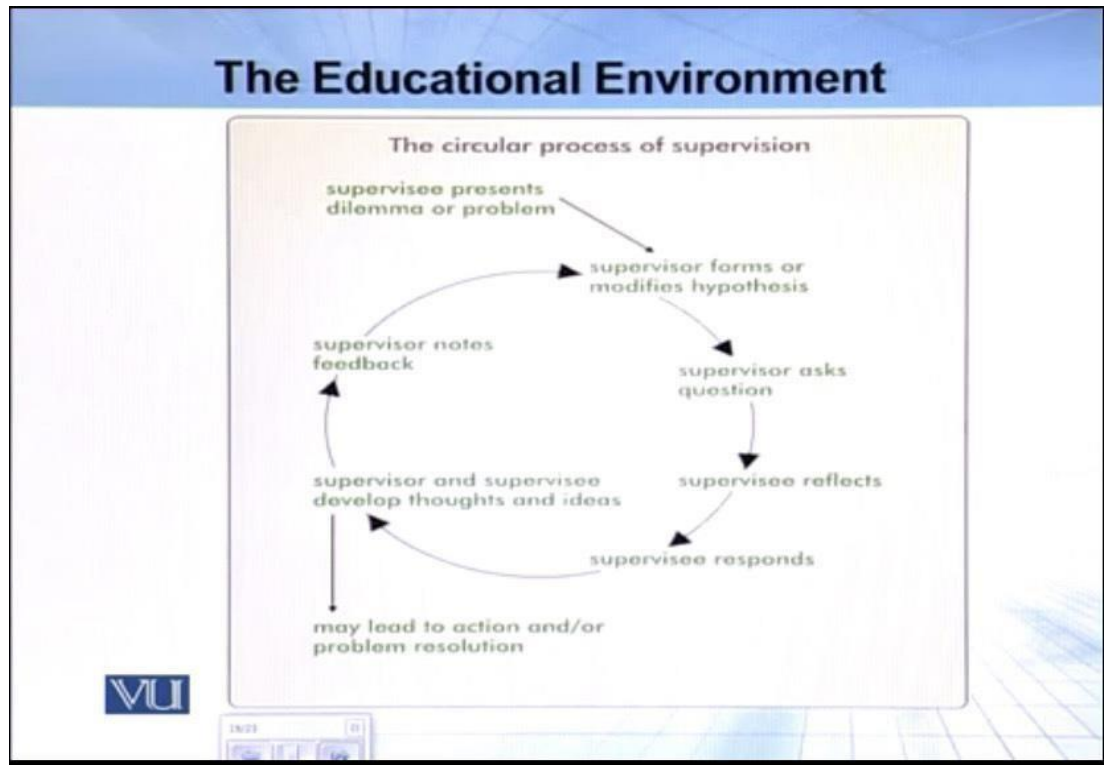
- Be transparent about the extent to which the supervision is about development or performance; this may need to be renegotiated or stated during the session.

What is Supervision For?

Essential for improving experience of students it also available for improving performance within the context. It is also about ongoing development for the teacher especially in terms of career development.

Using question in supervision

- The RP is given the opportunity to reconstruct their view of a particular issue or difficulty. This is achieved by the supervisor asking them questions. They are trying to help them see things from different perspectives and in different context.
 - To help the RP come to conclusions and solutions, the supervisor may wish to refrain from giving any advice until towards the end of the supervision conversation.
 - To identify those solutions, we can represent this as a circular process.
-



Supervision occurs within an ongoing cycle rather than as a linear process beginning to the end. The supervisor and supervisee meet and identify issues which need to be questioned. The question helps the reflection of the process to which they are responses, it can lead to thinking through and development of ideas around issues which may lead to action or a solution of a problem and this then needs to be recorded by the supervisor and then this can actually lead into new notions of change and development, new question can be raised.

Constraints and Barriers

In terms of supervision there can be particular constraints and barriers to supervision being effective.

- The most obvious barrier would be amount of time that supervision would take.
 - They can also be worries about the possible enormity of the problem, opening a ‘can of worms’,
 - There is also need for experience or training to carry out supervision.
-

- Embedded cultural attitudes within the school about the process of reflection, for some teachers there is a tradition of working alone.
- Fear of showing areas of weakness or need.
- Anxiety about professional revalidation.
- Attitudes about policing the profession.

Collaborative Observation and Feedback: A Question-Based Approach to Supervision: The 7C's

A Question based Approach to Supervision

To conduct supervision, we can look at a model which is describe as the 7C's model of supervision:

1. Conversation

Within the question-based approach this implies that language and conversation itself is the working tool. Effective conversation can creates new understanding, both for the focus person and supervisor, it s a way of understanding, unpacking reality and getting much more components of reality through “rethinking” and reconstructing stories in order to make sense of them.

2. Curiosity

This is used to develop story about students, colleagues, and oneself. It involves paying close attention to both verbal and nonverbal language. This approach of supervision is very useful because it's holistic.

3. Context

The reflective practitioner is working in a very particular environment and therefore both the supervisor and the reflective practitioner should understand the network, some cultures, faith, values, history and beliefs, community and how these affect teaching. All of these can play a significant part in unpacking the experience.

4. Becoming more interested in interactions

Becoming more interested in interactions/patterns between people and enjoying the process of supervision and benefiting from that process in a very personal way by exploring the richer stories

5. Creativity

Finding ways to create an account of reality that make sense. It implies the creativity process of jointly constructing a new version of the story of process of supervision.

6. Caution

Looking for cues from teaching. It involves working with a level of challenge. So, in order to conduct effective supervision it is important that a lot of care is taken so that challenge is not too much, because too much challenge can actually become stress.

7. Care

This encompasses being respectful, considerate and attentive. It means ensuring reflective practice is carried out within an ethical framework. Therefore, the whole supervision cycle and certainly the work of the supervisor need to be conducted in a way which is very ethical and considerate and understanding the confidentiality.

Collaborative Observation and Feedback: Differentiated Supervision

The Premises

Using supervision for reflective practice is a useful tool. What we can also consider is the notion of differentiated practice and there are certain understandings and premises that we need to explore in order to use differentiated supervision.

- There are lot of very good teachers in education.
- Teachers are the best determines of their own professional development needs rather than school or any body else.
- Not all teachers need to be observed continuously and this is the idea of differentiated supervision that some teachers will need more supervision.
- Therefore, a collaboration and professionalism can breed from creativity and motivation from differentiated supervision because it becomes much more flexible for the individual in terms of how they use it.

Four modes of differentiated supervision

There are four modes of differentiated supervision:

- **Focused Assistance** which is very much directed at meeting very specific needs.
 - **Technical Supervision** around some practical aspects.
 - **Peer coaching**
 - **Self-directed professional development.**
1. **Focused Assistance:** To solve a very specific problem it identifies that problem and then helps provide direction for teachers in order to solve that problem. It is very useful as a supervisory approach for those just entering in teacher profession.
 2. **Technical Supervision:** Teachers not in focused assistance can choose this form of supervision. All reflective practitioner benefit from participation in this phase. Technical supervision will focus on specific aspects of work and therefore , it's not just for new teachers for also those teachers who are teaching from some time to improve habits or develop new approaches.
-

3. **Peer coaching and self-directed professional development:** Teachers not in focused assistance can choose either of these options for continued professional development.

What is Peer Coaching?

It is where two teachers working as a team to collaborate around individual development goals in a non-threatening supervisory model.

What is the Process of Peer Coaching?

- To select a partner, somebody who have think you can learn from and you can help them in their professional development.
- Set goals for practice which meet both of your interests and needs.
- From this goal setting process, you both operationalize those goals, you put into practice certain activities in order to achieve those goals.
- Then develop and collect data to look at the impact of changes in relation to those goals.
- Therefore, the process of peer coaching will incorporate things like observation as well as sharing data from individual teaching practice and also modifying practice then looking at the record of those modifications.

Collaborative Observation and Feedback

Challenges of Inter-Professional Working for Reflective Practice: Drivers of Inter-Professional Learning

There are certain challenges for reflective practitioner in terms of professional working. What we need to consider are the driver of interpersonal learning is:

- Need to create some changes to modify attitudes and perceptions.
-

- For making change remedying certain aspects of the teaching practice between professionals in the learning environment.
- To reinforce collaborative competence to secure collaboration.
- To implement policies
- To implement new services
- To effect changes
- To enhance job satisfaction and ease stress.
- To create more flexible working conditions
- To counter reductionism and fragmentation as the teaching profession proliferates in response to technological advances
- To integrate teaching approaches and changing learning preferences
- Economic drivers also support Inter Professional Learning. This is especially for teachers who are working in rural/remote areas where resources are quite sparse.

Therefore, these situations can create environment where inter professional learning can be effected and therefore, economic consequences, the resource allocation, the funding for resources can be a key driver for the reflective practitioner.

Collaborative Observation and Feedback

Challenges of Inter-Professional Working for Reflective Practice: Principles of Inter-Professional Learning

When we are looking for the challenges of inter-professional learning for the reflective practitioner, we need to consider certain principles involve in IPL.

Principles of Inter-Professional Practices:

- Improves the quality of teaching
-

- It helps the reflective practitioner to focus their attention on the needs of students
- Encourages professionals to learn with, from and about each other.
- Respect the integrity and contributions of each professional. It enables an individual teacher to feel a part of professional community.
- Improves professional satisfaction and begin to recognize their developing professional identity.

Principle of IPL

There are principles that we really want to look at in detail:

- **Improves the quality of teaching-** IPL underpins the reality of the complexity of education. Individual professionals working in isolation does not develop expertise.
- **Focus on the needs of students-** IPL puts the needs and interests of students at the center of the practice. Therefore, provide a very strong focus not only for their approach to the work they do but also their metacognitive processes about the professional and teaching as a whole
- **Respect the integrity and contribution of each professional-** participants in IPL are seen as equal learners.
- **Increase professional satisfaction-** This is achieved through mutual support and guidance and encouragement or the work they do. It is through this process that the individual teacher can discuss with others about their roles and responsibilities and benefits about collaborative practice.

Challenges of Inter-Professional Working for Reflective Practice: Effective Inter-Professional Team-Working

- Effective schooling requires coordinated and concerted efforts from teachers
 - Effective care requires the concerted and coordinated activities of multiple professionals
 - Team work can contribute to job satisfaction
 - Teamwork can assist in the development and promotion of inter-professional communication.
-

- A clear understanding of one's professional identity, likely role within a team and the ideas about teaching as a profession are tested and developed.
- The perceptions of one's own professional identity and others assumption about the professional identities of other groups may not align.
- There is an expectation that in professional settings a grouping of individuals will have the capabilities required to adjust their own practice.

Differences in career histories

And interestingly in terms of working in a team all teachers will have different experiences in their professional role and in other words different career histories and these provide a foundation for exploring different approaches and different successes and different failures people have had in learning from those.

Varying levels of preparation, qualifications and status

And what therefore is possible to see from this is that the reflective practitioner is able to use all of these aspects of working within the team to improve what they are doing to work in a way which helps them develop their professional status and improve on the qualification that they are developing as they go and this helps lift the quality of teaching within the school environment.

Collaborative Observation and Feedback: Communities of Practice and IPL

The learning that comes from being involved in a community of practice (COP) is often not formalized and usually unacknowledged by the workplace as a legitimate way of learning.

Inter-professional learning from team work can help the reflective practitioner become a part of community of practice. A community of practice is a very significant body for the reflexive practitioner to be involved with and it is often not a formalized process but is actually very informal but very collaborative and supportive and the Idea of a community of practice has been acknowledged as very significant in the school environment to manage the quality of teaching and for the individual to manage what they do.

The concept that learning is a social phenomenon (Wenger) leads to informal learning experiences which occur at all levels within a work environment.

The concept of community of practice was developed a number of years ago and relates to the informal learning that an individual that a reflective practitioner can gain from being within a team, being within a community of practitioners. Learning not only from their insights but also from their experiences and this can occur at any and all levels within a school.

New knowledge allows teachers to act as change agents as they find new ways of doing things and have the opportunity to challenge practices, which ensures that best practice is incorporated into the workplace on an ongoing basis.

A community of practice then is a way for teachers to consider knowledge to build new knowledge from experiences from insights and ideas and work with these ideas and insights, work with the new knowledge to explore the quality of it, to use the opportunity but also to challenge existing practices so that constant improvements can be found constant change can enable the reflective practitioner to reach heightened levels of quality in terms what they do.

If the working environment allows and encourages this type of learning experience, opportunities for professional and practice development are greatly increased

If the working environment therefore promotes the idea of teachers sharing experiences and learning from other people's experiences opportunities then the opportunity for developing practice is very greatly increased and so community practice for the reflective practitioner is an extremely powerful supportive tool to manage the quality of what they do.

A community of practice can be described as a group of people who work together to achieve a common goal.

So community of practice is significant for inter-professional learning and a community of practice we have seen is actually very informal and the boundaries of the work of a community of practice are somewhat fuzzy undefined in terms of the normal structures and hierarchies that we experience in organizations and however there is a common goal for people involved in the community of practice and that common goal is about developing skills and experience developing knowledge and by sharing working together and collaborating.

The process of working together and sharing knowledge and resources can lead to an enriched learning experience as people are exposed to new ways of thinking and problem solving.

And collaborating the process then of working together and sharing knowledge and also sharing resources is an opportunity for teachers to enrich not only the quality of their teaching but enrich the learning experience of the students and of course it also enriches the learning experiences of individual teachers as they progress in the development of their skills and the progress in the ways of thinking around activities that they undertake in the classroom it's also of course a means for reflective practitioners to find supportive and new ways to deal with those interesting and significant and a problematic issues that we face in the classroom

We have seen that a community of practice has a specific criterion which makes it so. There are differences between a CoP and, say, an informal network.

So we can see that community of practice then has some specific criteria and it's these criteria which define the community of practice and which make a community of practice different to a team of people working together in an organization even if that team is working quite uniformly

Communities of practice share three specific domains

- **Knowledge – a common body of knowledge within the community.**

Community of practice share certain attributes and the first key attribute for the reflective practitioner is about knowledge sharing for reflective practitioner practitioners within the community of practice knowledge becomes a shared commodity there is a body of knowledge which is contributed to by all members of the community and is therefore a benefits to all members in equal portion

- **Community – commitment to forming a group for networking.**

Another key criteria that helps us define what is a community practice is the fact that it is a community and the community exists because there is a commitment to not only learning from others but learning with others and maintaining the lines of communication and networking between people within the community and there's also a commitment for the reflective practitioner and to share practice what this means is that all teachers are learning from their experiences in the classroom.

- **Shared practice – sharing of ideas, resources and strategies**
-

The community of practice is a forum where teachers can come together share those experiences, share understandings and knowledge which is developed from those experiences even come together to share resources and materials which are developed over time and also strategies which are useful and strategies which have been shown to fail in the classroom all become part of the content of what the community of practice aims to engage with and this extreme engagement with all aspects of the experience that teachers have is what provides the community of practice with real strength in terms of supporting learning and supporting the reflective practitioner in that teaching.

The RP ensures that IPL is effective at many levels: The level of the curriculum (its design and balance of activities); timetabling; allocation of resources; relationships between different academic groups; selection of activities for IPL.

So what is the role of the reflective practitioner in inter-professional learning the reflective practitioner ensures that into professional learning is effective at many levels in the organization for example at the level of the curriculum which is being used in terms of its design and the balance of activities which take place the reflective practitioner is ensures that inter-professional learning happens at the level of the timetable and allocation of resources within the timetable and curriculum. The reflective practitioner is also concerned about the relationships between individual groups are within the organization and the selection of activities also which support inter-professional learning.

Once higher-level decisions have been made to implement IPL activities, the RP is also responsible for what goes on in the learning environment itself – the micro- culture of the classroom.

So once a decision has been made that inter-professional learning can occur in an organization, the reflective practitioner is responsible for being involved in terms of what goes on in the learning environment itself but also within the micro culture of the classroom where they put into practice the skills and knowledge that they are developing.

Guidelines for School Management of Inter-Professional Groups

- Encourage learning from ‘rather than learning with ‘one another.
-

There should be an encouragement for individuals to learn from each other rather than just learning with each other the idea about teachers attending workshops or courses is that they will be learning with one another, from some expert the idea of inter-professional learning is that people are learning in collaboration with one another and learning therefore from experiences that people are requiring a knowledge that they are building up over time.

- Make sure there is adequate, diverse and equal mix of experience.

The reflective practitioner needs to make sure that within the group there is a sufficient diverse experience to be drawn from a way there is a wide breaths of knowledge and experience and this adds to the quality of learning within inter-professional groups.

- Ensure the majority of collaboration has relevance to all.

It is important to make sure that collaboration within the group occurs for everyone and is relevant to everyone in the group so that everyone benefits and everybody feels the value in sharing.

- Utilize the skills, knowledge and expertise of all the participants.

It's important to use all of the skills all of the experience and expertise which is built up all of the knowledge which has been acquired by people over time and to benefit the group and benefit all participants within the group.

The Role of the Reflective Practitioner in IPL: Learning Theory

- The rationale for IPL is also underpinned by learning theories.
 - Various theories focus on effective learning happening in the gap (or disjuncture) between what someone thinks they know and what they think they need to know. So, the rationale behind inter-professional learning is really based in learning theory and there are a number of theories which identify learning as occurring within a that gap in knowledge and experience and the idea is that learning occurs when we tried to close the gap between what we think we know and what we actually know
-

In theory, slightly unfamiliar contexts, such as IPL, create disjuncture, revealing learning needs and motivating RPs to close the gap.

And therefore, inter-professional learning is an opportunity to look at that gap and for the reflective practitioner to be motivated by the need to fill that gap in knowledge or their skills

Skillfully facilitated and planned IPL can utilize constructive friction, creative conflict and the learning edge 'to promote change, stimulate debate and discussion, and promote professional development.

And inter-professional learning is used productively where it's planned and it's structured it is an opportunity for the reflective practitioner to identify gaps in knowledge and experience and skills and to see these as opportunities for constructively managing learning in a sense it's a conflict or a difficulty which the reflective practitioner wants to close and wants to promote some sort of change and this gap which needs to be closed and can stimulate this debate and discussion within the group and it's this debate and discussion collaborating and learning with people where professional development occurs.

What is Grounded Theory?

Focus on generating theoretical ideas (or hypotheses) from experiences rather than having these specified beforehand. Grounded theory is inductively derived from the study of the phenomena it represents.

Grounded theory is a way for a reflective practitioner to focus on generating ideas theoretical ideas or in other words hypotheses based on their experiences rather than having these pre-defined in texts and by others and therefore grounded theory is derived inductively by the reflective practitioner or simply by looking at the phenomena and trying to understand experiences from a cognitive and metacognitive point of view.

Core Elements of Grounded Theory

- Inquiry shaped by the aim to discover social & social psychological processes **with in the school.**
 - Create analytic codes and categories from the data **therefore helps us to drive the theory that explain the processes would be using.**
-

- Data collection and analysis proceed simultaneously.
- Analytic process employed prompts theory discovery and development rather than verification of pre-existing theories. In this sense grounded theory is an Inductive process.
- Theoretical sampling refines, elaborates and exhausts conceptual categories.
- Systematic application of grounded theory analytic methods will progressively lead to more abstract analytic levels.

Data analysis begins o develop theories(explanations) that suggest further cases to sample.

- Use these to elaborate and refine emerging theoretical categories
- Develop properties until no new ones emerge
- Involves comparison of people, places, events, conditions, settings etc.

Purpose

- To develop theory about phenomenon of interest which are grounded or rooted in observation
- Allows the reflective practitioner to take a researcher role in order to seek out and conceptualize latent social patterns and structures through constant comparisons. As teachers we are always seeking new knowledge and conceptualizing our understanding around occurrences and around patterns of behavior that we experience in the classroom.

Constant Comparisons

- involve comparing one segment of data with another to determine similarities and differences
- provide abstract conceptualisation to avoid descriptive interpretations
- help facilitate the discovery of patterns in the data

Coding

While you do comparisons, you will be taking notes and coding

- Coding: identifying categories and properties
- Can be done formally or informally

Grounded Theory: Stages in Developing a Grounded Theory (GT)

Three Stages

1. **Open coding** - a procedure for developing categories of information
2. **Axial coding** - a procedure for interconnecting the categories
3. **Selective coding** - a procedure for building a story that connects the categories producing a discursive set of theoretical propositions.

Open Coding

- Examine the text for salient categories
- Applying codes to the text is labeling phenomena.
- Key is to avoid mere description. e.g. “conferring” not “talked to a manager” “Information gathering” not “reading the schedule”. The important thing for the reflective practitioner to remember is not just to describe experiences but to take on the role of trying to understand experience much more and therefore clarity is very important in terms of looking at words and how using words to describe experience
- Use constant comparative approach in an attempt to saturate

Saturation = look for the instances that represent the category and continue looking until new information does not provide further insight into the category

Saturation = look for the instances that represent the category and continue.

Coding

- Stress on ACTION Not what does this represent, but what is the person doing? What are they trying to achieve by doing a particular action? What strategy are they using?
- Code social and psychological processes.
- Coding process is iterative. Builds up gradually, based on early coding.

Axial Coding

- Explore the relationship of categories, making connections between them.
- Then apply a model to this.

Model:

Causal conditions => Central Phenomenon => context => intervening conditions => Action/interaction strategies => Consequences.

Look for

- **Causal conditions:** what influences the central phenomenon, events, incidences, happenings
- **Phenomenon:** the central idea, event, happening, incident about which a set of actions or interactions are directed at managing, handling or to which the set of actions is related.
- **Strategies** for addressing the phenomenon. Purposeful, goal oriented.
- **Context** - locations of events.

Grounded Theory: Stages in Developing a Grounded Theory (GT) 2

Three stages

Selective Coding

The third stage of developing grounded theory is a selective coding this is where the reflective practitioner constructs a story around the data in order not only to explain it but to conceptualize the thinking which underpins the data

Story line: The conceptualization of the story, the core category

Selective coding: Systematically relating the core category to other categories and filling in categories that need further refinement.

Through selective coding grounded theory then emerges over time by that process of constant comparison always checking and re-checking searching for meaning in the data and in this sense it's not a forced process it's an iterative and informal and informative process and therefore theory emerges over time and becomes a something which it grows with experience. It is then in a sense for the individual a prescriptive process and develops categories in terms of trying to prescribe understanding to the data.

In this sense the individual categories coming together and helping the reflective practitioner developed theory are constructed and in this sense we can understand that this whole process is constructivist from a learning perspective. Selective coding then examines how that experience is constructed over time how the individual is working with experience and starting to construct knowledge from that experience.

Coding not a description, rather it gets to the concept/pattern. GT is the study of a concept.

Theoretical Sensitivity

A significant process as for the reflective practitioner to bring to the stages of developing grounded theory essentially about theoretical sensitivity.

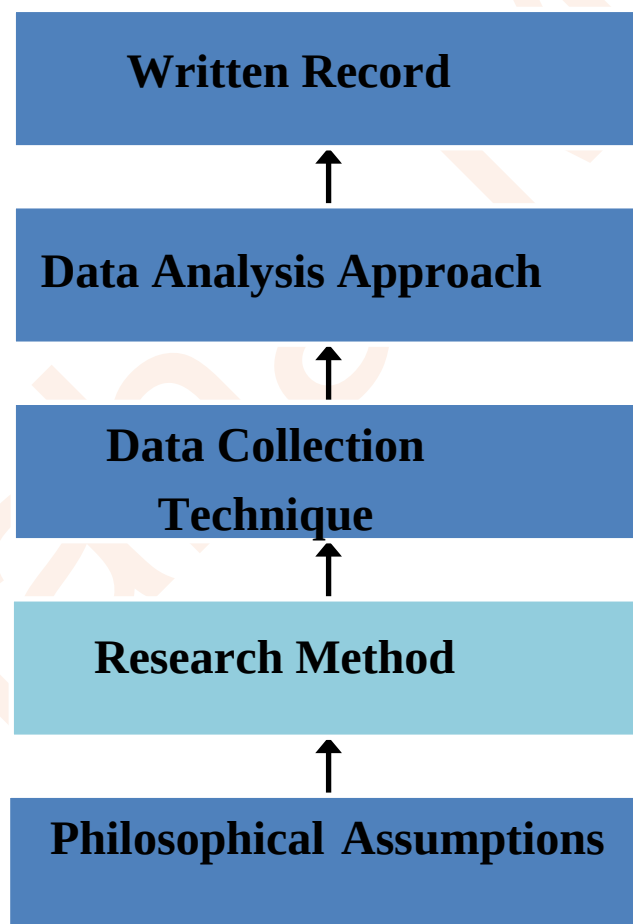
Sources of Theoretical Sensitivity:

- Professional experience
 - Personal experience of an event
-

- Analysis process itself: become sensitive to concepts, meanings and relationships
- Theoretical sensitivity is a good thing in that it helps us connect what we know to what we do not know about what we are studying (awareness of our biases)
- Forces us to step back and make sure what we are truly seeing is FOUND in the data. Think of it as a grounding tool for conducting grounded theory

Grounded Theory

- There is a continuous interplay between data collection and analysis



There are certain philosophical assumptions that we bring to the job of teaching as reflective practitioner our philosophical assumptions not only affect what we do but from the grounded theory perspective affect how we research and practice so our philosophical assumptions affect the research methods that we use and consequently the research methods that we are applying affect the collection of data the strategies that we used to collect data and also our approach to analysis of data and moreover once collection and analysis of data has occurred the way we write about our learning the way record information is affected by the research method and so we can see that our first philosophical assumptions are key in terms of developing grounded theory.

Some Approaches to Grounded theory

Two main variants:

1. Strauss and Corbin (1990) provide a one coding paradigm (context, conditions, interactions, conditions and consequences)
2. Glaser (1978) provides 18 coding _families 'giving many more options Strauss and

Corbin (1990) variant is the most widely used

- **Theoretical coding = The formulation of a theory**
- **The Process and Categories Within the Flow of Research in Grounded Theory for the Reflective Practitioner**

Types of Grounded Theory Design

There are certain types of grounded theory that we can consider as reflective practitioners:

- **Emergent Design:**

This is where grounded theory emerges from the data over time. Grounded theory exists at the most abstract conceptual level rather than the least abstract level as found in visual data presentations such as a coding paradigm. most importantly emergent design helps us understand that theory is strongly grounded in the data and it's not forced into pre-conceived categories the categories emerge from the

data and for emergent design we think of certain categories that may emerge for example the fit of data within the categories and the nature of the categories in relation to particular aspects of the work that we do. We are also considering about the relevance of the categories in relation to the experience and most importantly whether the categories can be modified refined over time.

- **Constructivist Design:**

This is a philosophical position between the positive perspective learning and post-modern ideas about research and in this sense it's very much focused on the feelings and explaining the feelings of individuals in relation to experiences and therefore putting all of this into a very focused context. Constructivist design then helps the reflective practitioner not only study experience but make connections between that experience and their beliefs and values as practitioners and also as researchers and therefore ignores any predetermined categories and develops categories as they become apparent in the data. Narrative of this whole process is more explanatory, discursive, and probing the assumptions and meanings for the individuals in the study.

Types of Grounded Theory Design: Criteria for Evaluating Grounded Theory

Types of grounded theory design mean that we need to consider the criteria for how we actually evaluate the grounded theory which emerges there are certain questions that we can ask for example:

- Is there an obvious connection between the categories and the raw data?
 - Is the theory useful as a conceptual explanation for the process being studied?
 - Does the theory provide a relevant explanation of actual problems and a basic process?
 - Can the theory be modified as conditions change or further data are gathered?
 - Is a theoretical model developed or generated that conceptualizes a process, action, or interaction?
-

This is a good way for us to test the robustness of the theory that's being developed. Another question we can ask:

- Is there a central phenomenon (or core category) specified at the heart of the model?
- Does the model emerge through phases of coding? (e.g., initial codes to more theoretically oriented codes or open coding to axial coding to selective coding)

If we can say that these this is the case then this is a good way for evaluating the quality of grounded theory, another aspect of this theory is:

- Does the teacher attempt to inter-relate categories?
- Does the study show how the teacher validated the evolving theory by comparing it to the data, examining how the theory supports or refutes existing theories in the literature, or checking theory with students' colleagues?

Building Theory From and For Practice: Framework for Organizing Teachers' Learning and Knowledge: Building Theory from and For Practice

We need to develop a framework for organizing our learning and knowledge in order to build practice and there's a simple model that we can use called the knowledge conversion model. The knowledge conversion model focuses primarily on knowledge creation and the transfer of knowledge between implicit and explicit forms and across individual and organizational levels.

There are four knowledge conversion stages (SECI):

- Socialization (S) between individuals using tacit knowledge.
 - Externalizing (E) it in individual reflections in an organizational context that builds collaborative knowledge
 - Combination (C) facilitates bringing tacit individual knowledge into explicit organizational knowledge
-

- Making knowledge reusable for individual learning in internalization (I)

Summary: Socialization is the process between individuals in terms of sharing and using that acquired knowledge from experience and the next phase of the model is the externalizing phase this is where individuals are taking that acquired knowledge that tacit knowledge and exposing it within the organization externalizing it to individuals to others so that we begin to build an organizational perspective on that knowledge and we can start to collaboratively construct and re-construct that knowledge and then this leads to another phase of the model which is known as the combination phase this is where the individual reflective practitioner is linking the acquired knowledge the tacit knowledge with the externalized knowledge the explicit organizational knowledge which is being created synthesizing understanding from those two perspectives and then that leads to the final stage of the model which is known as the internalization stage this is where the individual takes both the tacit and the explicit knowledge and through a process of reflection begins to build new understandings of process and practice in teaching.

Socialization Communication between the members of the community	Externalization Publishing reflections. Comments from community member to peers' reflection
Internalization Monitoring community members reflections and learning from them. Planning own competence development	Combination Collaborative creation of learning resources. Formulating community norms and visions

Building Theory from and For Practice: A Process for Personal Theory Building

Building theory from and for practice for the reflective practitioner is a process of personal theory building the aims of theory building are essentially about explanation and prediction.

The Aims of Theory Building

- Explanation: explaining things which are experienced which are occurring in the platform
-

Examples: what produces bad behavior?

- prediction: making predictions in relation to the teaching that were engaged with if “A” happens, “B” will follow

Theory Building

Theory building for the reflective practitioner is an attempt to construct and also evaluate statements explanatory statements about what we are experiencing and what is going on around us.

Some common-sense examples:

- punishment deters bad behavior
- improved teaching increases student achievement

Theory building operates both at the abstract level of concepts (ideas abstracted from an object) and at the empirical level (experience of reality). These two levels can interact with one another for the reflective practitioner as part of the theory building process.

Issues in developing your personal theory

- People are unlikely to change their beliefs unless they have opportunities to critically reflect upon them.
- The intention to learn springs from problems experienced in practice or the desire to maintain currency in knowledge
- The intention to learn is essential to the recursive process of personal theory building.

Building Theory from and For Practice: A Process for Personal Theory Building

What is Theory?

A coherent set of general propositions used as principles of explanation of the apparent relationships of certain observed phenomena.

What Makes a Good Theory?

- Validity

It fits to the facts.

- Generalization

Makes predictions about future or other events.

- Replication

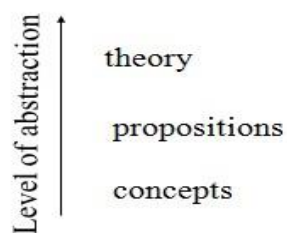
It can be repeated with similar findings

Constructs:

Teachers use concepts (or constructs) as variables. Examples: School leadership; honesty; efficiency.

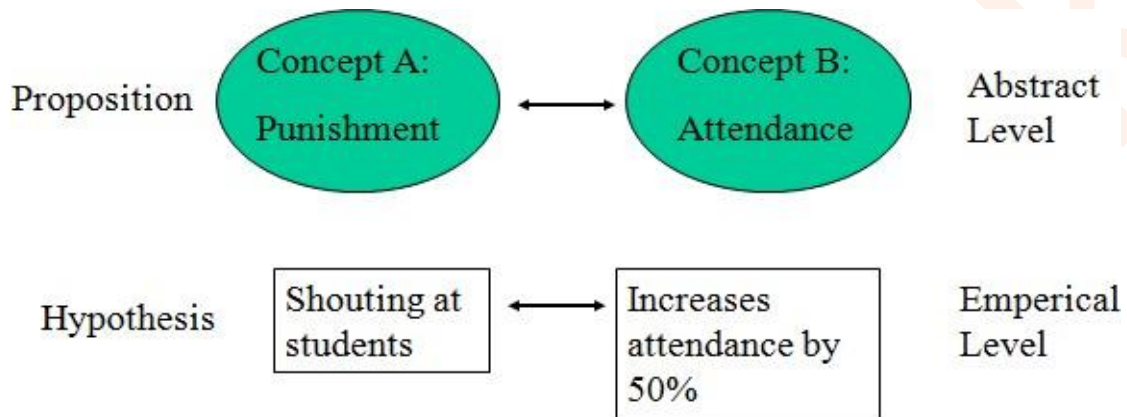
Propositions

- Concepts are the basic building blocks
- Propositions propose the linkages between these concepts



The process of personal theory building has certain propositions. There are concepts which for the individual for the reflective practitioner are the basic building blocks from which theory Springs and propositions are

used by the reflective practitioner to develop linkages between the concepts and ultimate theory and as we move from concept to theory the level of abstraction becomes greater or in other words the level of generalization becomes greater the more we move from concept to theory.



We can look at an example for example concept a punishment is related to attendance the proposition here is that punishment is going to have some impact on attendance and attendance is abstracted in this sense because the type of punishment could affect the amount of attendance and whether attendance is actually linked to punishment is contested and what this means for the reflective practitioner is that at an empirical level an observational experiential level we can look to see changes in attendance through certain forms of punishment so for example a hypothesis would be that by shouting at students we actually increase attendance by some amount. of course this is just an example we are not saying that these things are true but the idea is there that concept through proposition develops theory.

What Makes a Good Hypothesis

- precise
- specifies variables to measure
- specifies relationships between variables

The Double Movement of Reflexive Thought

- Induction occurs when we observe a fact and ask “why”.
- To answer this, we develop a tentative hypothesis as the explanation.
- Deduction is the process we use to test the hypothesis.

Building Theory from and For Practice: Using Evidence

In order to build theory from practice and to build theory for practice though reflective practitioner needs to use evidence and evidence comes in a variety of forms.

- Evidence from own students (formal and informal)
- Evidence of own practice (link to evidence from students)
- Evidence from others’ research to inform practice

Using Evidence:

We use evidence for a number of reasons:

- Beliefs, Knowledge and Skills of Reflective Practitioners

- Inquiry habit of mind
- Evidence as a source of information for teaching and learning (not labels for students)
- Beliefs, Knowledge and Skills of Reflective Practitioners
- Knowledge and skills
- The meaning of the evidence for practice
- Sufficient understanding to make relevant adjustments to practice
- Evidence-informed Conversations



We can see this diagrammatically that evidence-informed conversations rely on three key components. One component is the inquiring habit of mind that an individual has that they bring to the process of reflection. This is in relation to the relevant evidence that is being used to inform practice. And also, the relationships between individuals in an organization that exists, relationships of respect and also challenge of thinking.

Building Theory from and For Practice: Using Evidence

Evidence from Students

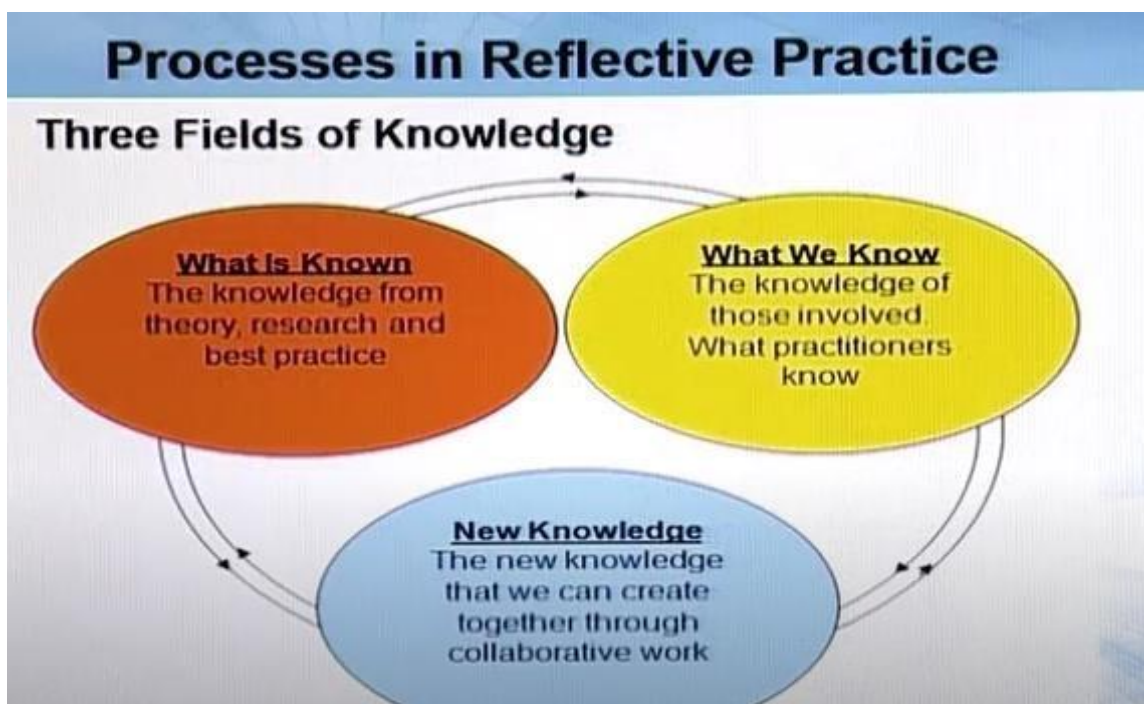
Building theory from practice and building theory for practice as we have seen uses evidence and evidence can come from students there are particular things that we can look for certain things that we can question as reflective practitioners for example:

- What do the students already know?
- How adequate are the sources of evidence we have used?
- What do the students need to learn and do?
- How do we build on what they know?

Evidence of Effectiveness of Own Knowledge and Practice

Evidence is also looked for in terms of our own growing knowledge and our own developing practice and so questions that we can ask in this area include things around knowledge and practice for ourselves for example:

- How we have contributed to existing student outcomes?
- What do we already know that we can use to promote improved outcomes for students?
- What do we need to learn and do to promote these outcomes?
- What sources of evidence / knowledge can we utilize?



The first field of knowledge is what is known the knowledge from theory, the knowledge from research and also the knowledge from best practice which is shared with us by colleagues what is known is a good starting point for the knowledge building process another component is what we know the knowledge of those involved in teaching, what the practitioners know not only the individual but the community of practitioners and another field of knowledge is new knowledge, the knowledge that we can create both individually and collaboratively from work and for work and we can see that these three fields of knowledge work together and inform one another what is known the knowledge from theory and research informs what we know about our practice and both of these can inform new knowledge and conversely the new knowledge that we can create individually or collaboratively with colleagues can inform what we know as practitioners, what we know about what works and what doesn't work and this can actually then be used to inform what is known generally about teaching and learning them and informs theory and research.

The use of evidence for professional learning cannot be a single event: Pervades all aspects of the cycle, it helps us to:

- Identifying what students know and need to learn
- Identifying what teachers know and need to learn
- Deciding what might be most effective
- Checking impact of changes to practice

The three-basic means of human knowledge acquisition are:

- To discover
- To study
- To communicate - obtaining knowledge from others

Significance of Knowledge Management

- Track, measure, share and make use of intangible assets in a school.
- To capture, share and use productive knowledge to enhance learning and improve performance

BASICS of knowledge:

Information; Values; Beliefs; Experiences; Rules and Procedures

Categories of Knowledge

We have to consider certain categories of knowledge,

- **Tacit Knowledge** - we have seen that for the reflective practitioner knowledge starts off as being quite tacit this therefore means the knowledge is very personal based on experiences that we are having in the classroom and therefore personal wisdom which is built up over time in this sense it's very context specific and therefore is very difficult to make explicit

and perhaps difficult to make it meaningful for a society as whole because it is so individual and because it is tacit it makes it difficult to actually quantify all to codify the components of that knowledge.

- Categories of knowledge can be transmitted through social interactions and socialization.
- **Explicit knowledge** - Explicit manner knowledge is what is what ends up being recorded tacit knowledge can be translated into explicit knowledge by being written down by being recorded in some way, easily identified and shared with others through different means.
- Cultural knowledge - Cultural Ethos specific to a school or region or language or religion or nation.

Three particular characteristics of action research are that it:

- Arises from practical questions
- Is participatory in nature
- Its validity is strengthened through peer examination and discussion.

The Objects of Enquiry Are:

- Observable social activities, patterns, structures;
- Intentions motivating those activities;
- Shared, available interpretations of these activities;
- Goal & interest to document, explicate, critique, transform.

Aspects of Action Research

Practical	Participatory
Studying practices involving individual or team-based enquiry	Studying social issues that constrain individual lives
Focusing on teacher development and student learning	Emphasizing equal collaboration
Implementing a plan of action leading to the teacher-as- researcher	Focusing on —lifeenhancing changes Resulting in the emancipated practitioner

The Reflective Practitioner looks at Action Research as a Cycle: Action Research is an “interacting cycle”

Look ↔ Think ↔ Act

Action research engages teachers in a cycle of:

- Experience
- Critical reflection
- Action
- It is a deliberate rather than a purely exploratory entry into a naturally-occurring educational setting. That is, it is a planned and self-consciously focused examination of changing practice.
- It is a solution-oriented investigation aimed explicitly at solving particular problems rather than simply documenting their instances, character or consequences

- It is group or personally owned and conducted. This emphasizes the importance of the practitioner's role as a determinant of the description of the problem, what counts as solutions, and what form the reporting will take.
- It takes the form of a series of iterations on and around the problem, its documentation and theorization, and the analyses that are used to display how it has been redefined and solved.
- These iterations are referred to as spirals but are more commonly known as the Action Research Cycle. This 'cyclic' feature of Action Research is taken to be central to its core emphasis on the documented improvement of practice
- The trying out of ideas is not undertaken solely for the purposes of re-theorizing practice, or adding to knowledge, but is also aimed at improving practice.

Ethical Practice

It is collaborative in nature:

- Provides opportunities for colleagues to share, discuss and debate aspects of their practice with the aim of improvements and development and involves responsible
- sense-making of data collected from within the field of teachers' own practice.

It is transformative in its intent and action:

Practitioner researchers engage in an enterprise which is about contributing to transformation of practice.

This provides opportunities for the reflective practitioner to work with colleagues, to share understandings with colleagues and this draws out the **participatory** nature of action research.

This **participatory** nature helps in meaning-making and sense-making from the information and from the actions which bring about the information that we are using.

Action Research: Reasons to do Action Research

- Help you build a reflective practice based on proven ideas or techniques.

- Allow you to try new ideas and reliably assess their effectiveness.
- It will help you build confidence in your teaching.
- It will contribute to the professional culture of teaching at your school.
- It can create meaningful and lasting change in order to improve student achievement.

Levels of Action Research

- The individual practitioner for classroom
- Group of teachers for department
- Teachers, administrators, and other stakeholders to affect change in the larger school community

How to Get Started – Identify a Problem, Issue or Question

- Decide on a FOCUS

Find your professional self...some guiding questions may be...

- What are your broad interests in teaching/ specific interests?
- What questions are manageable?
- What are you passionate about?
- Is there a problem or question that you would like an answer to as a teacher and how will an answer to your question or idea help you do a better job?

Sources of Information

Studies published in books, journals, periodicals, technical reports, and academic theses and dissertations available either in print or online.

Conducting Action Research Steps

- Identify the question, issue or problem
- Conduct a literature review
- Define a solution
- Apply the solution and collect the data
- Analyze your findings
- Report your findings
- Take ACTION

The Nature of Action Research

- Research is empirical.
- Research is systematic.
- Research should be valid.
- Research should be reliable.
- Research can take on a variety of forms.

Research is empirical

- Action research is characterized as empirical because empiricism is the concept that all knowledge is derived from sense experience.
- Information takes the form of data, which can include test scores, field notes, responses to questionnaire items, etc.

Research is systematic

Based on the scientific method, there are five steps:

1. Identify the problem
2. Review the information
3. Collect data
4. Analyze data
5. Draw conclusions

Research should be valid

- Validity is when something should be based on fact or evidence
- Internal validity is the extent to which results can be interpreted accurately.
- External validity is the extent to which results can be generalized.

Research should be reliable

Reliability of research concerns the replicability and consistency of the methods, conditions, and results.

Action Research can take on a number of forms:

- Basic and applied research
- The primary purpose of basic research is the extension of knowledge.
- The primary purpose of applied research is the solution of an immediate, practical problem.

Action Research for Continuous Improvement

For the reflective practitioner, the process of action research is a process of continuous improvement and there are certain aspects of this continuous improvement which we can look at diagrammatically.

- Successful schools will have learning rather than teaching as a focus. Teachers will work together to analyze student work and consider best practice.
- Instructional decisions will be based on data, emphasizing formative as well as summative data.

Professional Learning Communities

- Collaborative conversations will be a part of the regular school day for teachers.
- There will be a focus on results and staff will hold themselves accountable.
- Professional learning teams will function successfully on a variety of levels leading to improved student achievement
- SMART goals will be understood and used meaningfully.
- Action research or teacher enquiry will inform practice.
- Students who are experiencing difficulty will be supported
- Learning is for all students and teachers

Action Research: Gathering Data

- There are many options for gathering data.
- Action researchers must choose their data gathering methods.
- Choose the techniques that most effectively address the question.

Techniques for Gathering Data

- Reflective Journal
- Portfolio
- Observations
- Interviews
- Questionnaires
- Case studies
- Checklists

Guidelines for analyzing Data (Do)

- Design a system for analyzing your data.
- Look for themes or pattern to emerge from the data.
- Share your findings with a colleague.

Guidelines for analyzing Data (Don't)

- Let your previous assumptions guide your analysis.
- Censor the data you have recorded.
- Look through your data only once.

A Process for Analyzing Qualitative Data

- Write continuously...What are you seeing? What questions emerge? What are you

Learning?

- Look for themes, patterns, and big ideas
- Identify main points that appear most frequently and most powerfully
- Draw information together
- Include support for each of your themes

Action Research is: Process, Collaboration, Improvement, Practice, and Communication

Appreciative Inquiry: An Introduction

Appreciative Inquiry (AI) is the study and exploration of what gives life to human systems when they function at their best. This approach to personal change and organizational change is based on the assumption that questions and dialogue about strengths, successes, values, hopes, and dreams are themselves transformational.

AI simply put....

- If we continue to search for problems, we will continue to find problems.
- If we look for what is best and learn from it, we can magnify and multiply our success.

Problem-Solving vs. Appreciative Inquiry

Problem-solving is:

- Identify problems; Conduct Root Cause Analysis; Brainstorm Solutions & Analyze; Develop Action Plans
- Metaphor: Teaching involves problems to be solved.

And there's a particular metaphor, an expression that we can use to describe this notion of problem solving for the reflective practitioner and that's a **teaching** involves problems which must be solved.

Appreciative Inquiry is:

- Appreciate “What is”; Imagine “What might be”; Determine “What Should Be”; Create “What Will Be”.
- Metaphor: Teaching is a solution/ mystery to be embraced.

Focusing on Being Exceptional**Reflective Practice tends to focus on:**

- Making improvements
- Changing things for the better
- The language of ‘deficit’ - correcting what is wrong

For the Reflective Practitioner, using AI focuses on:

- Positive Attributes

Examples:

- Describe a peak experience or high point in your teaching.
- Identify a time in your experience when you felt most effective and engaged.
- What are three wishes you have to enhance the quality of your teaching?

Underlying Benefits**Appreciative Inquiry unleashes power by:**

- Building relationships.
- Creating opportunities for teachers to be heard.

- Generating opportunities for teachers to dream.
- Allowing teachers to choose how they will contribute.
- Giving teachers the support to act.
- Encouraging and enabling teachers to be positive and affirming.

Appreciative Inquiry as a Process for Reflective Practice

5 Principles of Appreciative Inquiry (AI)

- Constructionist: The way we know is fateful
- Simultaneity: Change begins the moment you ask the question
- Poetic: People in organizations are an open book
- Anticipatory: Deep change = change in active images of the future
- Positive: The more positive the question = greater/longer lasting change

Key Understandings of AI

- Appreciative/value the best of what is
- Envision what might be
- Engage in dialogue about what should be
- Innovate what will be
- A cooperative inquiry
- A collaborative process

- Generate new narratives/perspectives
- The 4D Cycle

The 4D Cycle Expanded

- Discover: The identification of organizational processes that work well
- Dream: The envisioning of processes that would work well in the future
- Design: Planning and prioritizing process that work well
- Destiny: The implementation of the proposed design

Critical Inquiry

- Systematic inquiry that seeks to reveal the operation of wider structures such as power;
- Claims to objective knowledge;
- Claims to ‘truth’ and understanding;
- Can be inclusive and dialogical;
- Includes a vision of a better world;
- It can be argued that it often results in a problem focus with an emphasis on solutions

Comparison of AI to Critical Inquiry and Similarities between AI and Critical Inquiry

	Critical inquiry	Appreciative inquiry
Driver	Logic of analysis Find what’s wrong, broken or missing/find solution to it.	Faith in strengths. Find what’s working, present or right/affirm and expand on it.
Knowledge focus	Negative experiences of power/conventions	Positive and unique experiences.
Epistemology	Social constructivist/realist. More stress on understanding.	Social constructivist. More stress on meaning significance.

Value	Rationality and reason, the intellect 'objective knowledge'	Innovation, affirmation, intuition, imagination, 'constructed knowledge'
Approach	Address the 'negative'; leverage the 'positive'	Amplify the 'positive'; reframe the 'negative'
Space-time dimension	Wide-continuous	Immediate (here/now)
Process	Does not have to be social. Dialogical or reflective criticism?	Narratives; Storytelling. Encouraging. Draws on principles of simultaneity.
Impact	Directive/intolerant resulting in defensiveness. Potentially paralyzing or deficit discourse – maintains status quo. Potentially emancipatory - shared meaning of Justice	Encouraging and inclusive resulting in sense of camaraderie; Potentially emancipatory - way forward. Spirals of 'dysfunctional' practices.

The **Driver** of critical enquiry is very much about the reflective practitioner engaging in a logical process of analyses; breaking components of their practice down in two aspects of the work that they can investigate and find solutions for, but the **Driver** of appreciative inquiry is about realizing the foundation of the strengths and find ways to either confirm those strengths or to build on those strengths.

Critical inquiry has a particular **knowledge focus** and which is based in problem solving, identifying negative experiences and attempting to change those. Whereas the **knowledge focus** for appreciative inquiry is always positive and unique to the individual in terms of their experiences. The **epistemological background** for critical enquiry is very much looking at things from individual perspective and how knowledge is created, constructed over time and there is a greater stress is on **understanding** compared to appreciative inquiry where the stresses is on **meaning** and on significance to the individual.

There is also a **value** component to critical inquiry which is the about **intellect and reason**. Whereas with appreciative inquiry it is very much about **intuition and imagination** and how the transformation **can occur** over time.

Another focus for critical inquiry is the **approach** that **is actually taken**. It is looking at negative aspects and trying to change them into positive components, whereas with appreciative inquiry the approach is actually to build on positive components and rather than looking at things negatively, looking at things from an opportunistic pointed of view.

For critical inquiry there is also a dimension around the context. The **space-time dimension** for critical enquiry is very wide and very long term but for appreciative inquiry, it is very much focused in the immediate work of the practitioner.

For critical enquiry the **process** can be dialogic or reflectively critical but **for** appreciative enquiry, it's very much about creating **a** narrative, telling a story and developing **that** story over time.

The **impact** of critical enquiry is very direct and does not bring itself to emancipation of freedom and developing choice for the reflective practitioner but appreciative inquiry is encouraging, stimulating, promoting freedom of choice and freedom of development for the individual.

Therefore, we can say that there are commonalities between critical inquiry and appreciative enquiry and also **difference** is in the process and the product. Appreciative inquiry is much more meaningful for the reflective practitioner from a personal change perspective and a professional change perspective. **Critical** inquiry is meaningful for an **organizational** change perspective and **also** the professional perspective.

Aspects of transformative inquiry (TI)

	Transformative inquiry
Driver	Social change – Logic and affirmation
Knowledge focus	Power in both negative and unique/shared experience
Epistemology	Postmodern stress on rational meaning. Retains a critical realist orientation.

Value	Reflectivity modulated inquiry. 'Not everything goes'
Space-time dimension	Natural, Modulated choices through social reflection.
Process	Wide-continuous through the immediate
Impact	Collaborative, situated judgments
Impact	Second order learning

Transformative Inquiry (TI)

- Claims to retain the mobilizing appeal of AI with the reason of CI.
- Claims to foster informed positions on change (whether transformative or conservative) conducive to action.
- Can result in the inclusion of new voices.
- Potentially expands the circle of influence.
- Recognizes the power/reality of the whole in the specific.
- More awareness of consequences (practical reason).
- Can result in second order learning.

The 5-I approach

- Provides a more detailed framework for AI
- Based on S.O.A.R
- Provides a strategic framework with an approach that focuses on strengths and seeks to understand the whole system (e.g., school) by including the voices of the relevant stakeholders.
- The '5-I approach' is: Initiate, Inquire, Imagine, Innovate & Inspire to Implement

based on a premise called SOAR. SOAR represents strengths, opportunities, aspirations, and results.

- **Strength:** We use SOAR so that we can identify the strengths of our practice. And from the appreciative inquiry point of view, this is identifying what is positive, and finding ways to build on that.
- **Opportunities:** And then in SOAR, we are looking at opportunities from the strengths, or in other words, what are people asking for, what do they want that we can use as a guiding light to help us develop our practice.
- **Aspirations:** The next component is aspirations, or in other words, as practitioners, as professionals, what do we care about, what do we want to achieve, and what are our goals.
- **Results:** And then, we have results, how do we know when we are actually succeeding in achieving higher levels of practice.

The 5-I approach provides a framework, a very strategic framework for the reflective practitioner to use which helps them understand the process of appreciative inquiry, and gives a strong structure to follow in terms of undertaking appreciative inquiry.

The 5-I approach uses a framework of key words to help us move through the process of inquiry. The first is ‘**initiate**’ how do we actually identify what we want to do, and then inquire the process of collecting data, and investigating. And then ‘**imagine**’, imagine what can be, how we can change things or transform things for the future. And then ‘**innovate**’, and ‘**inspire**’, in other words, being creative, around what we're doing so build on that practice. And we can look at this diagrammatically.

The SOAR Process

- Can be done quickly or over an extended period of time.
 - Depends on purpose/goal
- This is best opportunity to involve various stakeholders

Reflection as Rationality

- John Dewey, saw reflection as a further dimension of thought, and as such in need of education; “while we cannot learn or be taught to think, we do have to learn to think well, especially acquire the general habit of reflection” (Dewey, 1933).

- For Dewey, reflection is a rational and purposeful act, an “active, persistent and careful consideration of any belief or supposed form of knowledge in the light of the grounds that support it, and further conclusions to which it leads...” (Dewey, 1933).
- Emphasized practical ideas in both his philosophical and educational theories, always striving to show how abstract concepts could work in everyday life.
- He emphasized "hands-on" learning, and opposed authoritarian methods in teaching.
- Recognizes the individual’s own experience as the key element in learning – as both the ‘means’ and the ‘end product’.
- In its simplest form, reflection is comprised of direct experience, process and understanding of experience.
- To achieve understanding – to make meaning – the reflective practitioner MUST engage in his or her own inquiry cycle.

Dewey and Reflective Thinking

Reflection as a Meaning-Making Process:

- Moves the learner from one experience to the next with deeper understanding of its relationships with, and connections to, other experiences and ideas.
- The thread that makes continuity of learning possible. It ensures the progress of the individual and, ultimately, society.
- It is a means to essentially moral ends.

Reflection as a Rigorous Way of Thinking:

- Systematic
- Rigorous
- Disciplined
- Roots in scientific inquiry
- Reflection needs to happen “in community”, in interaction with others.

Certainly, reflective practice needs to be:

- very systematic,
- very logical and

- analytical.

Reflection as a Set of Attitudes:

- Reflection requires attitudes that value the personal and intellectual growth of oneself and others.

Six Phases of Reflection:

- An experience
- Spontaneous interpretation of the experience
- Naming the problem(s) or the question(s) that arise out of the experience
- Generating possible explanations for the problem(s) or question(s)
- Constructing the explanations into full-blown hypotheses
- Experimenting or testing the selected hypotheses

Significant attitudes for reflection

- Empathy
- Open-mindedness
- Curiosity
- Self-awareness
- Inter-cultural communication skill
- Patience
- Ability to take risks/ act/ experiment
- Active seeking of feedback and alternative perspectives

Dewey's model of five stage cyclical process

Here we can see that Dewey's model is put into a five-stage cyclical process. Very simply, identifying a process where the reflective practitioner is inquiring into their practice, and developing meaning, and professionalism as they reflect.

Ask

The starting point is to ask a question about practice, asking what could be improved, asking what needs to change in order for things to improve.

Investigate

And through this then investigating, in some sort of detail, how to make those improvements and investigating or to understand the components of those change needs.

Create

From this, the reflective practitioner creates a new approach to teaching, a new technique to try out and puts this into practice in order to make the reflective process meaningful for themselves.

Discuss and reflect

And then to discuss with others, the outcomes of that action that they've engaged with helps the reflection process. Because it's from this deeper level of reflection, that the practitioner can ask further questions, and so engage in this continuous cycle.

Dewey: Pattern of reflective thinking

- Problem Definition/Identification
- Problem analysis
- Solutions
- Criteria
- Implementation

Problem Identification/Definition

- What is the specific question or problem?
- What are the key terms, and what do they mean?
- What are the group's limitations?

Problem Analysis

- What is the nature of the problem?
- What caused the problem?
- Why is it a problem?
- What are your goals?
- What are the obstacles preventing you from attaining your goals?
- How does it affect the persons involved?
- What are the short-range effects?
- What are the long-range effects?

Solutions – Selection

- What are the available solutions?
- What creative solutions can we generate?
- Brainstorming

Solutions - Criteria

- By what criteria will you judge a solution?
- How well does each solution meet these criteria?
- What additional effects will preferred solutions generate?
- What are possible negative side effects?
- What are possible bonus effects?
- What is the best solution or combination of solutions?

Dewey: Routine Action and Reflective Action

- Provides a useful distinction between routine action – in which the grounds for action have not been actively considered and where tradition, external authority and circumstance are guiding factors.
- Reflective action derives, in Dewey's view, from the need to solve a problem and involves 'the active, persistent and careful consideration of any belief or supposed form of knowledge in the light of the grounds that support it'.
- Teachers who are unreflective about their teaching tend to accept the everyday reality in their schools and concentrate their efforts on finding the most effective and efficient means to solve problems that have largely been defined for them.
- It's not that unreflective teachers aren't thinking – rather, their thinking does not allow the possibility of framing problems in more than one way.
- Main feature of Dewey's approach to reflection and reflective thinking are the generation of the process through 'perplexity', a sense of goal-directedness and the notion of testing or evaluation.

- This brings Dewey's approach into the realms of experiential learning. Dewey believes that the process can be improved by having an understanding of, and experimenting with, forms of thinking.

Dewey suggests aspects (phases) of reflective thought:

- Suggestions...where the mind leaps forward to a possible solution.
- Intellectualization...of the difficulty or perplexity that has been directly experienced into a problem to be solved.
- Hypothesis...the use of one idea after another as a leading idea to initiate and guide observation.
- Mental elaboration...which clarifies the idea by overt or imaginative action.
- Testing the hypothesis...Dewey did not believe that there was a strict order to these phases. He described them as being "fluid".

Dewey: Experience, Reflection and Learning

- As the father of the 20th Century progressive movement in education and an eminent philosopher, John Dewey's work is particularly helpful in defining and describing the relationships among experience, reflection, and learning.
- Dewey (1933) states that an experience is an interaction between the individual and the environment.
- An experience first includes more than participation in activities; experience could be reading a book, taking lecture notes, or talking with others.

Secondly, an experience contains what Dewey referred to as continuity, a continuous flow of knowledge from previous experiences.

- Learning, therefore, is a continuous and cumulative process.
- Prior learning becomes the fodder for further understanding and insight.

In his 1933 work, "How We Think", Dewey distinguishes between four different modes of thinking:

- Imagination
- Belief

- Stream of consciousness
- Reflection

Dewey acknowledges that imagination, belief, and stream of consciousness are certainly part of our thinking activities, yet they do not necessarily contribute to learning and even less to lifelong learning.

Reflection however plays a different role.

- Reflection is active. When we reflect, we examine prior beliefs and assumptions and their implications. Reflection is an intentional action.
- A “demand for a solution of a perplexity is the steadying, guiding factor in the entire process of reflection” (Dewey, 1933, p. 14).
- A key point is that informed action follows this reflective thinking process and leads to more ideas and therefore generates more experience on which to reflect. “Reflective thinking impels to inquiry” (Dewey, 1933, p. 7)

Experience

Dewey states that experience is an interaction between the individual and the environment in which they're operating. And an experience includes participation by the individual and by others. And there are activities which the reflective practitioner can engage with in terms of that experience. What the extension to this model defines is that the development of that experience can first start with things like a literature review, or discussion with others or observing other people's practice and taking notes, rather than just the direct experience.

Reflection

- Consequently, learning from reflection is not only a continuous process, but it's also a cumulative process, building up an extending over time. And therefore, prior learning forms a significant part of this experiential process, because prior learning, provides the bedrock, the foundation for new learning.
- And what Dewey was always saying in terms of his model, because of this continuity aspect to it, is that there are certain **modes of thinking**, which are very important for the reflective practitioner. There are certain focus points that we need to think about.

- The reflective practitioner certainly needs to have a good deal of imagination around the teaching learning transaction, to be finding ways to experiment, to develop the skills and knowledge that they have. And along with this, a belief system that each individual has about teaching and learning, about what is good teaching and what is effective learning. And this in terms of continuity, comes together as a process of thinking over time, what do we called a stream of consciousness, where prior learning informs current experience and leads to new experience and a new learning, and this is all part of reflection and how experience, reflection and learning come together.
- Dewey recognizes and acknowledges that **imagination, belief, stream of consciousness and reflection** are important thinking activities for the individual teacher, but they don't necessarily contribute to learning as such. Certainly, he was saying that learning needs to be a thoughtful, active process by the individual in order to make reflection meaningful. Without learning there is no point in reflection.

Learning

Reflection plays a very clear role in terms of facilitating learning for the reflective practitioner. Reflection is that added component which makes the whole process of development work and makes the actual development meaningful.

Reflection needs to be active. It's not a passive process. When we reflect as teachers, we're examining our beliefs and our understandings, and we're looking at the implications of these. And the reflection then becomes an intentional process by the individual rather than a routine action.

Extension to Boud's Representation

- Returning to the experience and attending to feelings.
- The strength of this model is it addresses emotions.
- Returning to the experience and attending to feelings.
- The strength of this model is it addresses emotions.

Returning to the experience – recall and detail of the salient points.

Attending to – connecting with feelings – using helpful feelings and removing or containing obstructive ones.

Evaluating Experience – re-examining the experience in light of one's intent and existing knowledge.

- The Importance of Emotion
- Boud is concerned about the role emotion plays in blocking or facilitating reflective processes.
- In this way, reflection is essentially a private process where emotional influences - such as avoidance of an area of thought - can steer the process of reflection more strongly than any other influence.
- This requires the Reflective Practitioner to return to an event, incident or experience & record it.
- Then consider it in detail at an emotional and cognitive level.
- Then the Reflective Practitioner re-evaluates the event in the light of experience, knowledge & experimentation; seeking to understand the meaning of the experience.
- Then the reflective Practitioner plans for what might change.

And this is because Boud's triangle links together the experience that the reflective practitioner has in the classroom with the emotional response, the feelings that they have generated by that experience. This is very much seen as the strength of this particular model.

- The starting point for this deeper understanding of this model is to think about how to **return to the experience**. The reflective practitioner is using reflection as a tool to not only recall what happened, but also to consider in much greater detail the key points, the key parts of the experience from which to learn.
- And from this, the reflective practitioner is not only **attending to their responses**, but making connections between the experience and the response to the experience. And from a deeper perspective, we can also now consider that the emotional response to the experience can actually have barriers which need to be overcome.
- It is this whole process of attending to feelings and attending to the barriers to the feelings, which are added to the **evaluation of the experience**. And this is an important part of the re-

examining of the whole process as part of reflection. This is how the reflective practitioner is developing their own knowledge and also developing the knowledge of the profession.

- And so, what we can see is the most important, the most significant component of Boud's triangle is the **emotional response** of the practitioner. At this deeper understanding, what Boud is most concerned with as part of the reflection process are the actual barriers, the emotions which are barriers, and the emotions with which are facilitators of the reflection process.
- So, the **representation** in this model requires that the reflective practitioner in a way **revisits the experience**, is **looking at the incident in detail** and then **recording** it. Then considering it not only at a **cognitive level**, but also at an **emotional level**. It is these two things coming together, where the model becomes very powerful.
- Then the reflective practitioner **evaluates the experience**, and uses this to construct knowledge and then to add this to the experimentation, the practice in the classroom, in order to understand the experience in more detail and their process within the experience.
- This whole action then for the reflective practitioner leads to the **potential for change**. And it's this whole process, especially the emotional response, where change can actually occur.

Extension to Boud's Representation: Understanding the Three Stages of Boud's Model

Boud's Triangular Representation of Reflective Learning is one of the most popular and frequently cited models of RP.

Key components of Boud's Model of reflective practice

We also consider this as Boud's triangle. The three components are /There are three stages of reflection:

- Experience
 - Reflection
 - Learning
-
- In the three-stage model, Boud recommends that the Reflective Practitioner first reflect on an experience by mentally replaying the experience and describing it in a descriptive, non-judgmental way.

- The second stage involves attending to feelings – both positive and negative – triggered by the experience, ‘discharging’ any negative feelings which may obstruct the reflection.

After attending to feelings, the teacher is then ready to re-evaluate the experience by progressing through four sub-stages:

- Association (relating new data to what is already known);
- Integration (seeking new relationships between the data);
- Validation (determining the authenticity of the new ideas and looking for inconsistencies or contradictions);
- Appropriation (making the new knowledge/attitudes one’s own).

Extension to Boud’s Representation-Issues

Issues in Boud’s Model

- Boud’s Triangular Representation of Reflective Learning is one of the most popular and frequently cited models of RP. One problem with this model is that it tends to confine reflection to a retrospective role: Reflection-on-action rather reflection-in-action.
- Also, the focus stays on individuals’ mental activity; practitioners are not encouraged to engage in reflective dialogue in a wider social arena.
- Boud has countered such criticism by highlighting the complexity of the reflective process given our understanding about the way emotions and cognition interact.
- For example, if Reflective Practitioners feel more positive about themselves, they will be more likely to persist with reflective activities.
- Ideas like these have since been applied in teachers’ professional education with the use of mentors and supervisors who understand the importance of giving teacher (Reflective Practitioners) external validation and positive feedback about their reflections.

Extension to Boud’s Representation-Naming Barriers to Reflection

- Boud’s model puts the process of reflection into context.
- When formulating the model in 1985 he was not aware of barriers which hindered the process of reflection.
- In his 1993 book he became more concerned with critical reflection and barriers.

- So finally, in 1993 we see the emergence of barriers as a separate entity within the process of experiential learning and reflection in the Boud model.
- This largely came about due to Boud's experience of being 'blocked'.
- Boud classifies barriers as internal and external based on their origins in relation to the practitioner;

Internal barriers come from within the learner, such as:

- Previous negative experiences
- Accepted presuppositions about what the learner can do
- What learning can take place

Internal barriers come from within the learner, such as:

- A lack of awareness of one's assumptions
- The emotional state of the teacher
- Established patterns of behavior

External barriers can come from:

- People
- The learning environment
- The larger personal situation and context of the teacher
- Social forces such as stereotyping, cultural expectations, classism and so on.

The internal barriers:

- Are the most significant because they come with the reflective practitioner,
- They are internal, they are part of the emotional response.
- can come from any area, any arena for the reflective practitioner

The external barriers include:

- the work environment,
- the learning environment,
- the wider community environment
- and how that impacts on the school and on the individual.

Extension to Boud's Representation-Naming Barriers to Reflection

Boud specifically focuses on emotions and feelings as a barrier to reflection.

- In Boud's model of reflection he talks about Stage 2 of the model - Attending to Feelings and stresses that in reflecting it is important to work with any feelings which we may have.
- However much valuable learning occurs in circumstances which we would never choose to experience, if we knew what the end point would be, and if we were aware of what we would need to experience so as to get to the end point!
- The significance of this is that the Reflective Practitioner may not want to engage fully with the affective elements of reflection which can lead to anxiety, pain and discomfort.

Personal awareness as a barrier to reflection

- This is the most important barrier in reflecting on experience. If we are not personally aware that a barrier exists, then how can we possibly seek to overcome it?
- The Reflective Practitioner's learning can be seriously impeded in that s/he does not see the benefit of formally reflecting:
- 'It wasn't in my nature' or 'I'm too practical for things like that' can be typical thoughts.
- Also coupled with this, not knowing 'how' to reflect comes the feelings of not being 'able' or 'good' enough to undertake critical reflection = 'impostership'.

The environment as a barrier to reflection.

Any environment can be disturbing to careful reflection if it is not comfortable for the Reflective Practitioner.

The keeping of a journal as a barrier to reflection

- A journal is a recognized method of evaluating personal experience by reflecting on it.
- It is not easy to pick up a pen and to start writing!
- Writing about personal experience can be profoundly difficult.
- Boud suggests a possible reason for this in that the culture of academic and professional writing has always devalued personal experience in the 'quest for objectivity and generality'.
- So, we can see two instant barriers that restrict personal writing, namely previous experience and the traditional nature of academic writing.
- Boud refers to the fact that the real battleground for working with barriers is the teacher.

Overcoming Barriers to Reflection: Overcoming Barriers by Oneself**Overcoming barriers by oneself**

- Boud identifies a process for overcoming barriers starting with acknowledging that they exist.
- An important landmark in overcoming barriers is called 'naming' - the more clearly, we can understand them, the more easily we can work with them.

Overcoming barriers with the help of a Group

- Reflective Practitioners are able to learn from a group, since their experiences of using reflection in practice are invaluable.
- Teachers working together can motivate each other and help sustain interest in the exercise.
- The Reflective Practitioner can commit to the group because the group becomes an invaluable part of the reflective process, because we need, as learners, appropriate support, trust and challenge from others.

Overcoming barriers with the help of a facilitator

- Boud refers to the importance of effective facilitation.
- But the facilitator should create conditions in which authentic dialogue and communicative discourse can occur.
- Boud reminds us that the facilitator should resist the temptation of running mindlessly giving answers and solving problems.

Extension to Gibb's model: Revisiting the six Phases of Reflection Using Gibb's Model

- **Gibbs' reflective cycle, as we saw previously, is a popular model for reflection.**
- **The model includes 6 stages of reflection:**
 - Description
 - Feelings
 - Evaluation
 - Analysis
 - Conclusion
 - Action Plan

- Gibbs' discussed the use of structured debriefing to facilitate the reflection involved in Kolb's 'experiential learning cycle'.
- **He presents the stages of a full structured debriefing as follows:**
 - Describe = Initial experience
 - Description = What happened? Don't make judgments at this point or try to draw conclusions, simply describe
 - Feelings = What were your reactions and feelings? Don't move too quickly to analysis.
 - Evaluation = What was good or bad about the experience? Make value judgments.
 - Analysis = What sense can you make of the situation? Bring in ideas from outside the experience to help you. What was really going on? Were different people's experience similar or different from yours in important ways?
 - Conclusions (general) = What can be concluded, in a general sense, from these experiences and the analysis you have undertaken?
 - Conclusions (Specific) = What can be concluded about your own specific, unique, personal situation or way of working?
 - Personal Action Plans = What are you going to do differently in this type of situation next time? What steps are you going to take on the basis of what you have learned?

Extension to Gibb's model: Describing the Phases of Reflection Using Gibb's Model

Stages of Gibb's Reflective Cycle

- Description
- Feelings
- Evaluation
- Analysis
- Conclusion
- Action Plan

Description

It is important to remember to keep the information provided relevant and to-the point. Don't focus on details that aren't required.

Feelings

- Discuss your feelings and thoughts about the experience.
- Consider questions such as: How did I feel at the time? What did I think at the time? What did I think about the incident afterwards?
- You can discuss your emotions honestly.

Evaluation

- For your evaluation, discuss how well you think things went. Perhaps think about: How did you react to the situation, and how did other people react?
- What was good and what was bad about the experience?
- If you are reflecting on a difficult incident, did you feel that the situation was resolved afterwards? Why/why not?
- This phase is a good place to include the theory – remember it is important to discuss the theory and not just describe it.

Extension to Gibb's Model: Describing the Phases of Reflection Using Gibb's Model

The **fourth and fifth stage of Gibbs reflective cycle** are the **analysis** and **conclusion** phase. And we can see that the analysis and conclusion phase, follow one after the evaluation phase. Just to remind ourselves the analysis phase is where the reflective practitioner is making sense of the experience in the classroom. And the conclusion phase is where the reflective practitioner is considering what else could have been done in relation to the experience.

Analysis

- In your analysis, consider what might have helped or hindered the event.
- You also have the opportunity here to compare your experience with the literature you have read.
- This phase is very important, particularly for higher level reflection.

- As a reflective practitioner you need to bring the theory and experience together.

Conclusion

- In your conclusion, it is important to acknowledge: Whether you could have done anything else; what you have learned from the experience; consider whether you could have responded in a different way.
- If you are talking about a positive experience discuss whether you would do the same again to ensure a positive outcome.
- Also consider if there is anything you could change to improve things even further.
- If the incident was negative, explore how you could have avoided it happening and also how you could make sure it doesn't happen again.

Extension to Gibb's Model: Action Plan

The sixth and final stage of Gibbs reflective cycle is the action planning stage. And we see the action planning stage in the cycle between the conclusion of a previous experience, and as part of leading to a new experience which needs to be described. And the action plan is where we consider the experience that we have had, and how we need to deal with it, what we would do in order to change it to improve it.

Action plan

- Action plans sum up anything you need to know and do to improve for next time.
- Perhaps you feel that you need to learn about something or attend some training. What can you do which means you will be better equipped to cope with a similar event?

Action plan- An Example

- Following is an example of an action plan.
- It demonstrates a number of options (aimed at support and activity) within the reflective thinking process for consideration as ways forward for the reflective practitioner.

Action Plan-An Example

- In future, I will ensure that I build up a relationship with colleagues. I am working alongside several different teachers and I intend to speak to each of them about my worries about students' behaviour.
- I have already had a useful conversation with one teacher and together we have developed a programme of team-teaching for the next few weeks so that I do not feel so pressurized.
- I plan to do this with the other class teachers, as it will help them to understand how I feel.
- I also need to speak to colleagues more often about how they feel, as I think I will be able to learn from them.
- In terms of training, I have booked onto a behaviour management workshop.

Extension to Gibb's model: Using Gibb's Reflective Cycle for Deeper Reflection

Gibb's Cycle for Deeper Reflection

Gibb's Model helps the Reflective Practitioner develop the type of thinking associated with deep thought; reflection which is aimed at achieving better understanding. It contains a mixture of elements:

1. Making sense of experience

- We don't always learn from experiences.
- Reflection is where we analyze experience, actively attempting to 'make sense' or find the meaning in it.

2. Standing back

It can be hard to reflect when we are caught up in an activity. 'Standing back' gives a better view or perspective on an experience, issue or action.

3. Repetition

Reflection involves 'going over' something, often several times, in order to get a broad view and check nothing is missed.

4. Deeper honesty

Reflection is associated with ‘striving after truth’. Through reflection, we can acknowledge things that we find difficult to admit in the normal course of events.

5. Weighing up

Reflection involves being even-handed, or balanced in judgement. This means taking everything into account, not just the most obvious.

6. Clarity

Reflection can bring greater clarity, like seeing events reflected in a mirror. This can help at any stage of planning, carrying out and reviewing activities.

7. Understanding

Reflection is about learning and understanding on a deeper level. This includes gaining valuable insights that cannot be just ‘taught’.

8. Making judgments

Reflection involves an element of drawing conclusions in order to move on, change or develop an approach, strategy or activity.

Extension to Gibbs’ model: Trans-disciplinary skills in Gibbs’ model

Trans-disciplinary skills in Gibbs’ model

Gibbs model helps the reflective practitioner develop a range of trans disciplinary skills.

- Social skills
- Communication skills
- Thinking skills
- Research skills
- Self-management skills

Social skills

Social skills include skills for:

- Accepting responsibility
- Respecting others
- Cooperating

- Group decision making
- Adopting a variety of roles

Communication skills

Communication skills include skills for:

- Reading
- Writing
- Listening
- Speaking
- Non-verbal communication

Thinking skills

Thinking skills include skills for:

- Acquisition of knowledge
- Comprehension
- Application
- Analysis
- Synthesis
- Evaluation
- Dialectical thought
- Metacognition

Research skills

Research skills include skills for:

- Formulating questions
- Observing
- Planning collecting data
- Organizing data
- Interpreting data

Self-management skills

Self-management skills include skills for:

- Time management
- Codes of behavior
- Informed choices
- Ethics

Extension to John's model of Structured Reflection: Describing the Stages of Structured Reflection

- John's model of structured reflection is an example of a 'staged model' of reflection.
- Another popular model used by reflective practitioners, it should be used to assist you in moving beyond a descriptive account of an experience to one that involves analysis, learning and plans of action.

Stage 1: Describe the event/experience

- What happened?
- Who was involved?
- What part did you/others play?
- What was the result?

Stage 2: Thinking and feeling

- What was significant about this experience to me?
- What was I thinking and feeling during the experience?
- What was I trying to achieve?
- How do I feel about the outcome of the event?

Stage 3: Evaluation

- What was good and bad about the experience?
- What were the consequences of my action/actions of others?

Stage 4: Analysis

- What sense can I make of the situation?

- What factors (e.g., values, assumptions, meaning perspective, experiences) influenced my feelings, thoughts, and actions?
- What sources of knowledge influenced or should have influenced my actions?
- How did others feel and how do I know?
- What could I have done differently?
- What would be the consequences of those other actions?

Stage 5: Conclusion and action plan

- How do I now feel about the experience?
- What have I learned about my practice/myself/my organizations?
- What would I do now in a similar situation?
- What factors might get in the way of me applying my learning from the experience?

Extension to John's Model of Structured Reflection: Reflecting on Cue Questions

1. Description questions

- ✚ Phenomenon questions
- ✚ Causal questions
- ✚ Context questions
- ✚ Clarifying questions

2. Reflection questions

3. Influencing factors

4. Could I have dealt with the situation better?

5. Learning

Extension to John's Model of Structured Reflection: Using John's Model

- This would be useful for more complex decision making and analysis.
- Johns supports the need for the reflective practitioner to work with a supervisor throughout their learning experiences.
- He refers to this as guided reflection, and recommends that teachers use a structured diary.
- Johns considered that through sharing reflections on learning experiences, greater understanding of those experiences could be achieved than by reflection as a lone exercise.

Carper's four patterns of knowing

John use additional frameworks, for example, Carper's (1978) four patterns of knowing in relation to each stage in the model.

- Aesthetics
- Personal
- Ethics
- Empirics
- Reflexivity

Epistemological base

- This is a strength of the model as it is one of the few models of reflection that refers to the development of an epistemological base to reflections.
- If you use this model for a situation that is ongoing, you could adapt the reflexive section using cues from another model or develop your own set of cues.

Using John's Model Looking in- Thoughts and Emotions**Looking inward**

- Find a space to focus on self

- Pay attention to your thoughts and emotions
- Write down those thoughts and emotions that seem significant in realizing desirable work.

Looking out

- Write a description of the situation surrounding your thoughts and feelings.
- What issues seem significant?

Aesthetic

In terms of looking out, we can apply those additional focus questions to the stage model, we can ask questions around the aesthetics of describing the experience, questions like,

- What was the point of what I did?
- What was I trying to achieve with it?
- Why did I respond in a particular way to that experience when I could have responded in a different way?
- What were the consequences of that response?
- What were the consequences to me as the teacher also to the students, or even to others in the teaching situation?
- How other people were affected?
- How, what were their feelings?
- What were their emotions, about the experience?

Personal

In terms of the personal attribute, questions,

- What the reflective practitioner is doing is asking questions about why they felt in a particular way,
- Why certain emotions were generated and trying to understand the reasons for that.

Ethics

And in terms of the ethical considerations, the questions that the reflective practitioner can use to look outward and to describe the situation, questions around understanding includes,

- Did I act for the best? (ethical mapping)
- What factors (either embodied with me or embedded within the environment) were influencing me?

In a sense, this is about creating a cognitive map of the ethics, which bound us as professionals. Some people call this ethical mapping. And we are looking at the sort of at the factors which are embodied both within us and within others, which influence everyone and influence the environment.

Empirics

In terms of the empirical questions that we can ask, we are looking at

- What particular knowledge do we have?
- Did we generate which informs our practice?
- What is the experience that we are using?
- What is the knowledge of the theories or the literature saying to us, which we can bring to the experience of reflection?

Reflexivity

- Can I support myself and others better as a consequence?
- How available am I to work with students/families and staff to help them meet their needs?

Considering the Cue:

- What internal factors were influencing me?
- Consider the following framework

Topic243

Extensions to Models		
Expectations from self: · obligation/duty · conscience · beliefs/values Normal practice - felt I had to conform to a certain action. Fear of sanction?	Negative attitude towards The student/family? What factors influenced my actions? Time/priorities?	Expectations from others: · in what way? Loyalty to staff versus loyalty to student/family? Anxious about ensuing conflict?

- Considering this cue helps the reflective practitioner to give equal weight to the internal perspective of reflection as much as
- Adding 'reflexivity' means that the danger of 'navel-gazing' (thinking with no point) will be avoided and along with looking in provides us the reflective practitioner with the opportunity for 'deep learning'.

Using John's Model: Writing Reflexively and Writing Reflectively/ John's Model provides a structured approach to reflexive writing and reflective writing.

- What is the difference?
- Develop style of writing that uses 'I' and personal experience

- Danger of being too personal
- A personal response to events/ experiences
- Immediate/ surface considerations
- Aiming at cataloguing – may be subjective – but this is OK!
- Provides foundations for the professional response
- Might feel strange at first. You may not be used to writing about your feelings or actions from an impersonal perspective
- Will take practice.
- Experiment with different models of reflection.
- It is still academic.
- It is not a diary entry, blog or email to a friend.
- It is not simply a description of events. Reflection is in the analysis of those events.
- It is the considered exploration of your own role in the experience.
- It should not be chatty (informal) in style.
- It should still contain a clear introduction, a main body, and a conclusion.
- It may even include evidence and references.
- It should be clearly linked to theory.
- It should show what you have learned from the process.
- It should consider other perspectives

John's Model of Structured Reflection is an example of a 'staged model' of Reflection

Stage 1: Describe the event/ experience

- What happened?
- Who was involved?
- What part did you/others play?
- What was the result?

Stage 2: Thinking and feeling

- What was significant about this experience to me?
- What was I thinking and feeling during the experience?
- What was I trying to achieve?
- How do I feel about the outcome of the event?

Stage 3: Evaluation

- What was good and bad about the experience?
- What were the consequences of my action/actions of others?

Stage 4: Analysis

- What sense can I make of the situation?
- What factors (e.g., values, assumptions, meaning, perspective, experiences) influenced my feelings, thought, and actions?
- What sources of knowledge influenced or should have influenced my actions?
- How did others feel and how do I know?
- What could I have done differently?
- What would be the consequences of those other actions?

Stage 5: Conclusion and Action Plan

- How do I now feel about the experience?
- What have I learned about my practice/self/my organizations?

Extension to John's Model of Structured Reflection: Reflecting on Cue Questions

- John's model for structured reflection can be used as a guide for analysis of a critical incident or general reflection on experience.
- This would be useful for more complex decision making and analysis.

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- He refers this as a guided reflection, and recommends that teachers use a structured diary.
- Johns considered that through sharing reflections on learning experiences, greater understanding of those experiences could be achieved than by reflection as a lone exercise.

Johns also uses Carper's (1978) four patterns of knowing:

- Aesthetic
- Personal
- Ethics
- Empirics, adding a fifth pattern, reflexivity.
- This is a strength of the model as it is one of the few models of reflection that refers to the development of an epistemological base to reflections.
- If you use this model for a situation that is ongoing, you could adapt the reflexive section using cues from another model or develop your own set of cues.

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- Write down those thoughts and emotions that seem significant in realizing desirable work.
- Write a description of situation surrounding your thoughts and feelings.
- What issues seems significant?

Aesthetics

What was I trying to achieve?

Why did I respond as I did?

What were the consequences of that for the student/others/myself?

How were others feeling?

Personal

- Why did I feel the way I did within this situation?

Ethics

- Did I act for the best? (Ethical mapping)
- What factors (either embodied within me or embedded within the environment) were influencing me?

Empirics

- What knowledge did or could have informed me?
- Does this situation connect with previous experiences?
- How could I handle this situation better?

Reflexivity

- What would be the consequences of alternative actions for the student/others/myself?
- How do I feel about this experience?
- Can I support myself and others better as a consequence?
- How available am I to work with students/families and staff to help them meet their needs?

Using John's Model: Writing Reflexively and Writing Reflectively

- John's Model provides a structured approach to reflexive writing.
- What is the difference?

Reflexive writing

- Different to other forms of academic writing. Switch from 3rd to 1st person for example.

- Develop style of writing that uses 'I' and personal experience.
- Danger of being too personal.

Taking Reflective Practice Forward:

Reflection investigates pedagogy and the content of teaching, in a conscious on-going review and evaluation of theory, policy and practice.

Different levels have been identified, for example:

- Technical (focusing on teaching strategies only e.g., how to teach vocabulary)
- Contextual (relationships between problems and teacher actions)
- Critical (deep) thinking, seeking to get at the heart of practice while taking account of contextual and technical factors).
- The quality of reflection is also something to be borne in mind. Reflection has been seen as always beneficial among teachers.
- However, some reflection may just lead to stagnation, with some teachers just going round in circles
- In addition, power is a key issue; teachers without power cannot perhaps use their reflection to best advantage.
- In addition, power is a key issue: teachers without power cannot perhaps use their reflection to best advantage.

Taking Reflective Practice Forward: Professional Practice

These two domains are by no means separate, since the main objective of the former is to facilitate the later!

The reflective practitioner needs to embrace the diversity of available definition, including:

- Evaluating the effectiveness of one's teaching practice.
- Examining teaching from the perspective of the learner
- Conscious and self-aware

- Deliberation on professional practice (sometimes called *reflection on action*, after Schon)
- Intuitive and implicit application of professional knowledge to specific teaching and learning settings (called *reflection in action* after Schon)
- Deepening one's understanding of one's role as a professional teacher in the light of experience (again based on Kolb's cycle of experiential learning) basing professional decision upon feedback (e.g., from learners and/or colleagues).
- Theorizing from experience that is, constructing abstract models or analytical frames based on practical experience of teaching

Taking Reflective Practice Forward: A Clean Approach to Reflective Practitioner

A Clean Approach to Reflective Practitioner

A clean approach to RP aims to facilitate Reflective Practitioners to improve their practice by:

- Enhancing the effectiveness of their reflection
- Deepening their understanding of their process of reflection and its application to their practice (i.e. self-modelling).

The Lawley and Tompkins Model of Reflective Practice involves two parallel processes (each with two aspects):

- External behaviour (event)
- Verbal and non-verbal
- Internal behaviour (experience)
- State and strategy

The Lawley and Tompkins Model has 5 components:

1. Reflection
2. Desired Outcome

3. Plan

4. Practice

5. Feedback

Taking Reflective Practice Forward: Comparing Models

Comparing Models

The Disney Strategy for Reflective Practice is described in terms of roles the practitioner takes on:

- The Dreamer
- The Realist
- The Critic
- With all models it is possible to find points of comparison.

Look at the following, which compares three different models:

Lawley and Tompkins	Kolb Equivalent
1a What happened? (External) 1b What was experienced? (Internal)	Active Experimentation Concrete Experience
1c What meaning is given to 1a/ 1b? 1d How is that arrived at?	Reflective Observation
1e What is concluded/ learned? 1f How are 1a and 1b evaluated?	Abstract Conceptualisation



Lawley and Tompkins	Disney Strategy
2a What outcome is desired in the future?	
2b What evidence (feedback) will be used to monitor improvement?	Dreamer
3a what is the plan?	
3b how and when will it happen?	Realist
3c what might prevent the plan from working/	
3d what can be done about that in advance?	Critic

Taking Reflective Practice Forward: Self-Directed Learning -What is it?

- The process of learning in which the learner assumes primary responsibility for planning, implementing and evaluating learning.
- The learner chooses what to learn and how to learn, and also decides when to continue and when to end

Goals for Reflective Practice

- It enhances the ability of teachers to be more self-directed in learning (humanistic approach)
- Fosters transformational learning
- Promotes social action

Enhanced Abilities

- Reflective Practitioners can use SDL to develop both skills and attributes as learners which support lifelong development
- Better plan, carry out and evaluate their own learning
- The Reflective Practitioner who is a self-directed learner can participate fully and freely in the dialogue through which we test our interests and perspectives against those of others and accordingly modify them and our learning goals

Self-Directed Learning

- Is listed as a key component of 21st Century skills.
- It is intricately inked to lifelong learning
- Listed as a demand for modern societies (UNESCO, OECD)

For the Reflective Practitioner, self-directed learning is:

- A learning process
- A personality aspect
- Ownership of learning
- Self-management
- Self-monitoring
- Extension of learning

Taking Reflective Practice Forward: Self-Directed Learning 2**Ownership of Learning**

- The Reflective Practitioner 's characteristics or personal attributes are important to SDL
- Teachers who take personal responsibility in learning have ownership of their learning

Self Management

SDL, as an instructional process of the individual teacher assessing their needs, identifying learning resources, implementing learning activities and evaluating learning outcomes.

Self-Monitoring

This focuses the Reflective Practitioner on both cognitive and meta-cognitive aspects of learning, which are internal to the teacher (thinking, making meaning of information and integrating new knowledge into existing knowledge structures).

Extension of Learning

The Reflective Practitioner has total control about the choice of what to learn, how to learn and how to evaluate learning.

Some possible behavioural indicators

- Teacher identifies/ determines and articulates own learning goals
- Teacher identifies learning tasks to achieve the goals and charts learning progress
- Teacher challenges self for achievement of learning goal
- Teacher formulates a question and generates relevant inquiries
- Teacher explores a range of possibilities and makes decisions
- Teacher self-plans and self-manages time
- Teacher critically reflects on learning and initiates gathering of feedback
- Teacher applies learning in new contexts

Higher Order Thinking for a Unified Curriculum, Instruction and Learning:**Three Dimensions of Critical Thinking****Focus on the three dimensions of critical thinking**

- Analysis of thinking by focusing on the parts
- Analysis of thinking by focusing on teaching quality (Standards)
- Improvement of thinking by using what you learned

Education, as a concept, defines a set of higher order goals, but actual school learning typically culminates in a set of lower order results.

- How can we narrow the gap between goals and results?
- How can we make higher order goals a practical reality?
 - ...so that in math classes students learn to think mathematically,
 - ...so that in history classes students learn to think historically,
 - ...so that in science classes students learn to think scientifically,
- So that in general –Students begin to think critically in a disciplined, self-directed way
- The obstacle is that many teachers make assumptions about instruction, knowledge, and learning that are incompatible with HOT

Reflective Practice provides a new set of assumptions:

We need long-term commitment to Reflective Practice because of the deep-seated nature of the changes needed and the depth of resistance that can be expected.

Higher Order Thinking for a Unified Curriculum, Instruction and Learning
Conceptualizing Higher Order-Thinking

- The fundamental problems in schooling today at all levels are fragmentation and lower order learning.
- There is too little connection and depth.
- Fragmented lists dominate curricula
- Fragmented teaching dominates instruction
- Fragmented recall dominates learning
- What is missing is coherence, connection, and depth of understanding.
- The bottom line, as we all well know, is not what is taught but what is learned.
- Students are learning something very different from what we think we are teaching them.
 - “All too often we focus on a narrow collection of well-defined tasks and train students to execute those tasks in a routine, if not algorithmic fashion.” Alan Schoenfeld

“Then we test the students on tasks that are very close to the ones they have been taught. If they succeed on those problems, we and they congratulate each other on the fact that they have learned some powerful mathematical techniques.” Alan Schoenfeld

Reflective Practice and Higher-order Thinking

- Reflective practice is a cure for lower-order learning which is an increasingly common mode of learning in every subject area.
- In other words, though education by its very nature comprises a set of higher order goals, actual school learning, given established practice, culminates in a set of lower order results.

The issue that emerges from these harsh realities is unambiguous for the Reflective

- Reflective practitioners can work to improve student performance only by improving student thinking. We can improve student thinking only by creating opportunities and incentives for them to think.
- But we can only provide students with these opportunities and with these incentives if and only if we as teachers as reflective practitioners have time to think about what we're teaching think about and thoughtfully redesign what we do and what we do is how we teach.
- We can give teachers time to thoughtfully redesign their instruction only if they do not feel compelled to cover huge amounts of subject matter.
- We can reduce the obsession to cover huge amounts of subject matter only if the curriculum is restructured to focus on basic concepts, understandings and abilities.
- We can restructure the curriculum to focus on basic concepts, understandings and abilities only if we understand why such a focus is essential to higher order learning.

Assumptions of Teaching

- The reflective practitioner understands why such a focus is essential to higher order learning only if teachers clearly understand the profound differences between didactic models of education.
- These confuse acquiring knowledge with memorization and the critical model of education which recognizes that acquiring knowledge intrinsically and necessarily depends higher order critical thoughts.

What lies behind uncritically held assumptions?

- That students learn how to think when they know what to think.
- That knowledge can be given directly to students without their having to think it through for themselves

21st Teaching Assumptions

- The Reflective Practitioner understands and values education focused on higher order learning as this holds a very different set of assumptions, namely:
- That students learn what to think only as they learn how to think
- That one gains knowledge only through thinking
- That the process of education is the process of each student gathering, analyzing, synthesizing, applying, and assessing information
- That classes with much student talk, focused on live issues, is a better sign of learning than quiet classes focused on a passive acceptance of what the teacher says

**Higher Order Thinking for a Unified Curriculum, Instruction and Learning:
The Paradigm Shift**

- The Reflective Practitioner will make a paradigm shift from a didactic to a critical model of education to make higher order thinking a classroom reality
- What are the basic changes that must be made to affect this shift?

What are these changes that we need to make in order to realize this paradigm shift in thinking from lower order to higher order?

- Re-conceive the curriculum
- Curricula play a significant role in school life. Instruction arises from goals and objectives stated in them.
- The redesign of instruction
- Teachers feel they have no time to focus on higher order learning and therefore the most basic ideas and issues within a content area can be neglected.
- The shift from a lecture-drill-recall paradigm to one focused upon engaged deep processing can only be achieved through long-term evolution.
- The Reflective Practitioner has the opportunity to place a major emphasis on a detailed formulation of philosophy, highlighting the essential role of thinking in the acquisition of knowledge, and contrasts lower order with higher order learning.

How does this translate for the Reflective Practitioner?

- Higher order learning multiplies comprehension and insight
- Lower order rote memorisation and performance multiply misunderstanding and prejudice.
- Higher order learning stimulates and empowers
- Lower order discourages and limits the learner.
- Good teaching focuses on high content, basic ideas and issues taught in ways which actively engage student reflection and thought.

The Future of Reflective Practice

- Reflective practice is something that was invented in the 60s, 70s, and 80s.
- It has been used worldwide for the past ten years. Many things have changed after 1994

We can begin to see some of these things:

- The concept of wikis, where many people collaborate to construct a knowledge base, an evolving encyclopedia.
- **Search engines are changing the way we access information. This will change our professional world.**
 - The Internet – the wisdom of crowds, combining people ‘s knowledge to make decisions.
 - The concept of collective intelligence, and similarly, communities of practice, which are small groups

We can begin to see some of these things:

- Constant renewal - Any profession will face the challenge of needing to adapt. The way I do my profession will need to be reinvented, and in some cases I will need to create new approaches, new beliefs and new understandings.
- My assumption is that many ideas of reflective practice are being used by authors today, and they are finding it very powerful. Its importance is growing in this Century.
- Are those authors citing Schon? If you analyse how they present their ideas, you can see similarities. The idea of Schon is basically how to improve the ways we think in action.

The Future of Reflective Practice: Perspective of RP in the New Professional Environment**Perspectives of RP in the New Professional Environment**

- Although a product mostly of the 60s, 70s and 80s, one name recurs through the years:
- Donald Schon, Displacement of Concepts, 1963
- Chris Argyris and Donald Schon Theory in Practice, 1974
- Donald Schon, The Reflective Practitioner, 1983
- Donald Schon, Educating the Reflective Practitioner, 1987
- Donald Schon and Martin Rein, Frame Reflection, 1994

- Many things have happened to quicken the pace of reflective practice, and these will continue to strongly influence the ways that Reflective Practitioners reflect on practice

The Web World Wide was invented and spread throughout the world.

- A new communicational platform was implanted, new collaborative software was developed and new business processes emerged.
- Cell phones have spread worldwide and internet communication (e.g. Skype and so on) are now spreading even faster.
- China and India have entered into the global market with highly dynamic economies.

The Future of Reflective Practice: Emerging New Ways for Collaborating in Professional Work

New Ways for Collaborating in Professional Work are emerging

- Wiki, or the gradual construction of a knowledge base from many people
- Search Engines, reaching out to the whole pool of knowledge worldwide.
- Collective Intelligence, combining intelligence of many people around shared interests.
- Communities of Practice, stable spaces for exploring and learning together.

Innovation is Being Distributed

- Democratising Innovation, teachers, researchers and educationists develop new ideas of teaching, learning and education.
- Social Innovation, many teachers working in diverse contexts can come together because of common interests and innovative initiatives.
- Research Networks, articulate capacities worldwide around a common question or inquiry

The Art of Conceptual Innovation is the Driver

- Innovation now is achieved in new concepts of the way professionals work.
- Artistry will be more important than before in the exercise of professions.
- The capacity of integrating technologies is key for creating new solutions and tap into the pool of knowledge of humanity
- When millions of people are innovating, the only way of keeping pace with change is through the creation of new concepts.
- Artistry will be more important than before in the exercise of professions.

Reflective Practice Will Evolve Continually: Traditional Teaching Skills

Reflective Practice Will Evolve Continually

- The diversity of situations and pace of change will require the capacity of:
- Updating
- Extending
- Adapting
- Reinventing the practice of professions, and
- Reinvention of the professions or the creation of new ones
- How can we fit the ideas of Reflective Practice into this emerging professional environment?
- These first 6 teaching skills are not new, but their importance has increased significantly for the modern teacher

Commitment:

It is essential that teachers are committed to their work and to the education of young people. The responsibility that lies with a teacher is huge, so a modern

Traditional Teaching Skills

Preparation

- There used to be a time when the right temperament enabled you to become a teacher. Nowadays it is impossible to find a teacher without formal academic training.
- This requirement is increasing as education levels improve in society.
- The better prepared you are as a teacher, the more effective you will be, so you should pursue your studies with this ethos in mind

Organization

Good organization and the planning of a course/ lesson in advance are key factors for success. It is very important that a teacher organizes the lesson properly and allocates the time to cover it in its entirety.

Tolerance

- In an increasingly diverse and multicultural society, it is necessary for teachers to manage any prejudices they may have and to treat all their students equally without showing favoritism.
- It is a very important teaching skill not to impose your world view on your students, instead you should openly discuss topics and let students decide for themselves

Story Telling

One of the best ways to teach and transfer ideas is through stories. The best teachers have used this method in their classes for centuries

Open to Questions

- Having discussions and collaborating in class are essential for encouraging students and implementing new teaching techniques
- Teachers must be open to answering their students' questions.

- Modern teachers truly listen to their students' questions and answer them honestly, not just with a cursory or textbook response.

Reflective Practice Will Evolve Continually: New Teaching Skills

New Teaching Skills

These new teaching skills complement the more traditional ones. These skills are associated with new technologies. Incorporating these into your teaching repertoire will ensure you become a modern teacher.

Innovative

- The modern teacher must be willing to innovate and try new things, both teaching skills and educational apps, ICT tools and electronic devices.
- The modern teacher must be an —early adopter

Tech Enthusiast

The modern teacher must not only be innovative but also be willing to explore new technologies. Whether it is iPads, apps or personal learning environments, modern teachers should be in constant search of new ICT solutions to implement.

Social

One of the traditional teaching skills was to be open to questions. The modern teacher should lead the conversation to social networks to explore possibilities outside of the class itself. Try using Twitter in the Classroom

Geek

- The internet is the greatest source of knowledge that humanity has ever known, so to be a modern teacher you must be a curious person and incorporate this resource at every available option. Your students are going to do it if you don't!
- You need to be someone who is always researching and looking for new information to challenge your students and engage them in a dialogue both in class and online.

Reflective Practice Will Evolve Continually: Better Teaching

Better Teaching

- The 21st Century reflective practitioner will favor student-centered methods— for example, problem-based learning and project-based learning
- Problem-based Learning and Project-based Learning allow students to collaborate, work on authentic problems, and engage with the learning community in school.
- Teachers know about them and believe they're effective. And yet, teachers don't use them. Recent data show that most instructional time is composed of whole class instruction led by the teacher.
- Even when class sizes are reduced, teachers do not change their teaching strategies or use these student-centered methods
- When students collaborate, one expects a certain amount of noise in the room, which could devolve into chaos in less-than-expert hands.
- These methods demand that teachers be knowledgeable about a broad range of topics and are prepared to make in-the-moment decisions as the lesson plan progresses
- Part of the 21st Century Reflective Practitioner skills relates to greater collaboration among teachers and learning from knowledge acquired from classroom experience